

SEO LONDON · LAW · MASTERCLASS · MONDAY 2 NOVEMBER 2026

Mayer Brown

The complete preparation pack: the firm from the inside, the role, the industry, live news, the process, a 43-question bank, 39 scenario cards and a one-page cheat sheet.

Event: 2pm to 6pm, London (address to selected candidates) · Business smart · 60 SEO candidates

Apply to SEO by: 26 October 2026, 11:59pm (may close early) · **Then:** Mayer Brown vacation schemes close 4 December 2026

Built: 8 October 2026 from public sources only. Every claim is source-marked and confidence-tagged.

Confirmed = primary source or two outlets · Reported = single credible source · Inferred = the author's reasoning

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PART 0

How to use this pack

Read the ten-minute version now. Then follow the reading plan. Everything else is reference you can dip into.

The 10-minute emergency version

1 · WHAT THE EVENT IS

A four-hour SEO London masterclass at Mayer Brown, Monday 2 November 2026, for 60 candidates: firm overview, trainee panel, practice deep dive, applications overview, networking. Apply to SEO by 26 October [S340]. It sits a month before Mayer Brown's vacation scheme deadline of **4 December 2026**, and vacation schemes are "the main pipeline" for training contracts [S1][S17].

2 · THE FIRM IN FOUR LINES

Founded Chicago 1881; London is the old Rowe & Maw practice (1895), merged in 2002 [S70]. 2025: revenue \$2.17bn, profit per equity partner \$3.196m; London revenue a record \$268.2m, up 20.5% [S220][S302]. Strategy: "go deeper with fewer clients", grow by hiring teams, not by merging [S220]. New London Managing Partner Chris Harvey from 1 October 2026 [S222].

3 · WHAT IT IS BEST AT IN LONDON

Legal 500 top tier: asset-based lending, derivatives and structured products (new this year), trade finance, commercial property for occupiers, construction disputes [S139]. Securitisation and pensions are tier 2 [S141][S145].

4 · THE TRAINEE DEAL

About 15 a year; four six-month seats (at least one transactional, at most two contentious); £56k then £61k; NQ £150k; SQE at BPP with a £20k grant; 80% retention [S2][S16].

5 · YOUR 30-SECOND "WHY"

"The work: top tier in London for derivatives and asset-based lending. The shape: about fifteen trainees, so real work. The moment: London grew 20% by going deeper with fewer clients, and Basel 3.1 in January will drive risk transfer work the firm is known for." (Part 12)

6 · NEVER SAY

Brown & Wood (that's Sidley); "Van Gorp is managing partner" (he's Chair); "leads London securitisation" (tier 2); "pays US rates" (no); pay as your motive.

7 · ONE QUESTION TO ASK

"Derivatives reached the Legal 500 top tier this year. How much of that work is transatlantic, and where do trainees fit in?"

Reading plan

When	Read	Why
Before the SEO form (by 26 Oct)	Parts 0, 1, 12	The form needs a specific "why".
Week of 26 Oct	Parts 2, 4, 5, 7	Fluency on the firm, rivals, the industry and the news.
Weekend before 2 Nov	Parts 6, 8, 10, 11	Depth for the deep dive; opinions; who's in the room; frame-holding.
Morning of 2 Nov	Part 13 (cheat sheet)	One page.
After 2 Nov, before 4 Dec	Parts 3, 9	The vacation scheme application and assessment.

How the pack works

KEY TERM

Plain-English definitions at first use.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

Lines you can use as written.

DON'T SAY THIS

Errors and overclaims to avoid.

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

A defensible view to adapt.

SOURCE UNCERTAIN

Where evidence is thin or conflicting.

CONFIDENCE TAGS

Confirmed primary source or two outlets · **Reported** one credible source · **Inferred** the author's reasoning.

Sources. Every non-obvious fact carries a marker like [s220] that resolves to Part 15: outlet, title, date, URL, access date and whether it was read in full. Mayer Brown is a private partnership, so most of its figures are self-reported to the legal press; the English LLP's audited Companies House accounts are the main independent check.

ASSUMPTIONS

The request did not include the candidate's degree, year, CV or prior knowledge of law. This pack assumes a beginner (0 out of 10 on law) who may be law or non-law, penultimate or final year, and who is eligible for SEO. Scenarios and the CV grill are generic; adapt them to your own experience.

PART 1

The role, decoded, and the team mapped

The "job description" here is two things: the SEO event page you are applying to, and the Mayer Brown London training contract the event feeds. Both are decoded line by line, then the London office is reconstructed from public records.

What this event really is

SEO London (Sponsors for Educational Opportunity) is a charity "on a mission to prepare students from underrepresented backgrounds for career success" [S8]. Corporate law is one of its seven industries [S10]. The event page calls Mayer Brown "our sponsor firm" and offers 60 places at a four-hour masterclass on Monday 2 November 2026 [S340] **Confirmed**. Mayer Brown lists SEO London among its diversity access partners [S61] **Reported**.



Figure 1. The process funnel, with your position marked (orange). The masterclass sits about one month before the vacation scheme deadline; the firm calls vacation schemes "the main pipeline" for training contracts [S17]. **Confirmed** dates from the firm [S1][S2] and the event page [S340]; numbers **Reported**.

The timing is the most important fact in this pack. Mayer Brown's vacation scheme applications opened on 1 September 2026 and close on **4 December 2026** [S1], about a month after the masterclass. The firm describes vacation schemes as "the main pipeline for our training contracts each year" [S17]. The masterclass is therefore a pre-application event: go in with a draft application, and leave with two or three specific things you heard that make it better.

KEY TERMS

Vacation scheme: a paid two-week placement (£650 a week at Mayer Brown [S1]) that doubles as an extended interview. **Training contract (TC):** the two-year paid programme after which you qualify. **Seat:** a six-month placement in one practice group. **NQ:** newly qualified solicitor.

The event page, line by line

Line	What it really involves	What "good" looks like	What it reveals
"Predicted or achieved 2:1 ... mitigating circumstances will be considered"	A screen, not a ranking. SEO reads the whole form.	State grades plainly; one line on any mitigation; evidence of recovery.	Mayer Brown's own TC needs a 2:1 with no A-level minimum [S13].
"Priority for penultimate (law) & final year & recent graduates"	The event targets people who can apply for 2027 vacation schemes now.	Show you know the next deadline (4 Dec).	Non-law finalists are welcome; the firm says "Legal experience is not required" [S1].
Introduction / housekeeping	Names, timings, who is in the room.	Write down every speaker's name and role.	Who the firm chose to send.
Firm overview	A pitch, likely from graduate recruitment or a partner; the training principal is Miriam Bruce [S62].	Note two facts you can reuse in "why Mayer Brown".	Which practices they push. Expect finance, London's growth, the small cohort.
Trainee panel	Current trainees on seats, hours, applications.	One researched question (Part 9).	Real hours; how many came via the vac scheme.
Practice deep dive	A partner or associate walks through a deal or case.	Follow the client's problem and what the lawyer does at each step.	Which practice the firm wants you drawn to. Prepare for finance (Parts 5, 6).
Applications overview	The process: form, Immersive Assessment, assessment centre [S1][S2].	Ask only what the website doesn't say.	Any hint on what the form is looking for.
Networking	The informal assessment.	Two or three real conversations; a specific follow-up.	Names to mention later, with permission.
"Business Smart"; travel up to £150	Suit or equivalent; keep receipts.	Arrive 15 minutes early.	The firm is paying for you to be there.

The training contract, line by line

Mayer Brown's own page says: "Over two years, London trainees will complete four different seats", with "a client or international secondment including our New York and Paris offices" [S2] **Confirmed**. Each line below becomes three practice scenarios in Part 11 (cards T1 to T7).

Duty	What it involves day to day	Counterparties	What "good" looks like / tools
T1 Research	Short legal questions; notes of the answer with sources.	Associate; knowledge lawyer	Answer first; flagged uncertainty. Databases, firm know-how, AI tools with checking.
T2 Drafting	"NDAs, powers of attorney, director and shareholder resolutions, and notices of security" [S18]; first drafts; turning comments.	Associate; other side's trainee	From precedent; square brackets for doubts; version control.
T3 Diligence	Reviewing contracts or leases for risks; reports. The firm's Forage programme models it [S7].	Associate; client data room	Consistent tables; gaps and red flags raised early.
T4 Running a deal	Updating conditions precedent (CP) checklists; "liaising with local counsel on fee quotes and local law issues" [S18]; signing and closing.	Local counsel; client; agent bank	A daily list of what is outstanding and who owes it.
T5 Disputes support	Disclosure review and redaction; chronologies; bundles [S16].	Court; counsel (barristers); experts	Court rules followed; privilege respected.
T6 Communication	Client calls and notes; status updates; meetings.	Clients; partners; other offices	Fast, honest, short.
T7 Knowledge, BD, pro bono	Client alerts; pitch research; "Got20" pro bono (20+ hours a year) [S16].	BD team; charities	Same standard as fee-earning work.

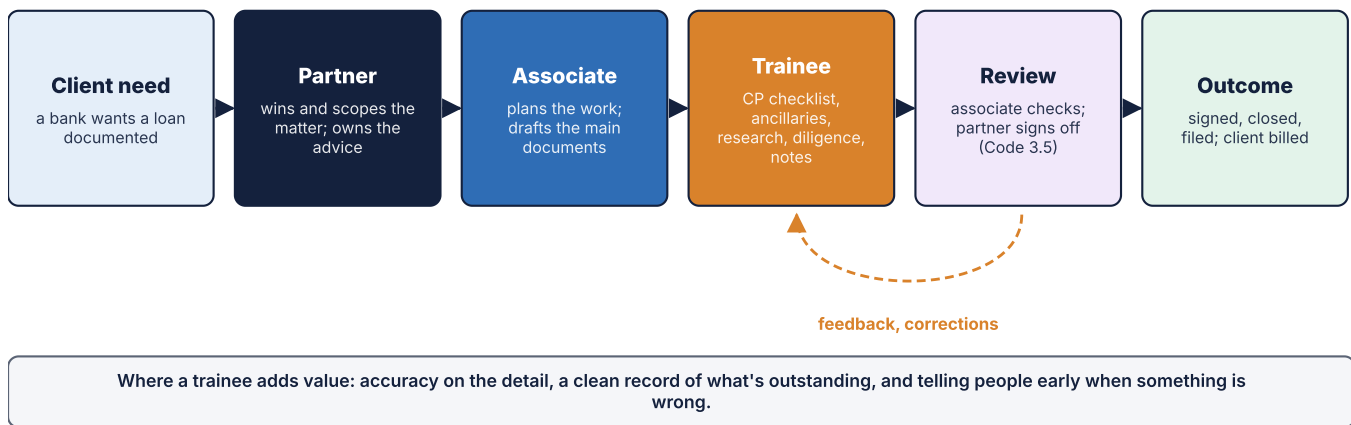


Figure 2. The role's value chain: from a client's need to a closed deal, and where the trainee sits. Trainee tasks from a Mayer Brown finance trainee's account [S18] and Chambers Student [S16] **Reported**; supervision rule from the SRA Code para 3.5 [S12].

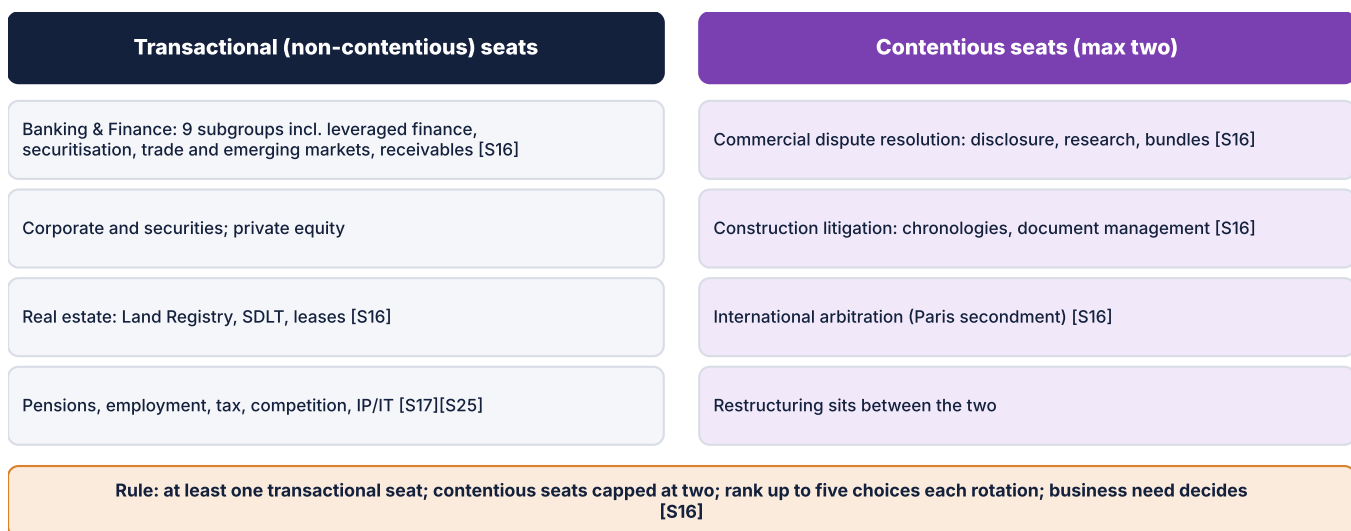


Figure 3. The two channels through which a trainee's work is done, and the seat rules. **Sources:** Chambers Student 2027 review [S16]; LawCareers.Net [S17]; Bright Network [S25] **Reported**.

The numbers that frame the seat

Item	Figure	Source
Training contracts a year	About 15 (34 trainees in total, per Chambers)	[S16][S17][S18] Reported
Applications a year	About 3,500, so roughly one TC per 230 applications (inferred)	[S18]
Vacation scheme places	30 a year across spring and summer	[S17]
Pay	£56,000 then £61,000; NQ £150,000	[S13][S14][S16]
Retention	80% latest	[S13][S16]
SQE funding	BPP; £20,000 SQE grant; £15,000 PGDL grant; optional £5,000 loan	[S2] Confirmed
Hours	Average 9:26am to 8:20pm; about 7.2 recorded hours a day; no billable target	[S15][S16]
Secondments	New York, Paris, clients; Legal Cheek puts each at 9%	[S2][S13]
TC deadline (2028/2029 intakes)	31 March 2027 (Legal Cheek's 31 January conflicts; the firm's date wins)	[S2][S13]

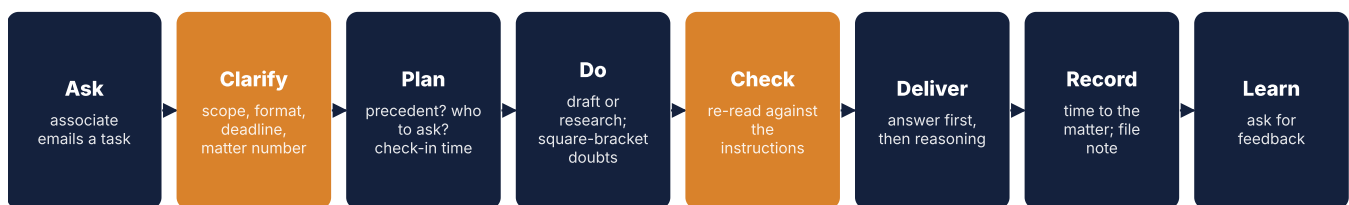
A worked day in the seat

8:30	●	Emails on the phone before arriving; arrive about 9am [S18]
9:30	●	Update CP checklists on live deals; chase signatories and local counsel [S18]
11:00	●	Training session; early in a seat "you are almost always training every day" [S16]
12:30	●	Lunch; office attendance 60% with anchor days [S16]
14:00	●	Draft ancillaries: NDAs, powers of attorney, resolutions, notices of security [S18]
16:00	●	Client call: take the note, circulate within the hour [S16]
17:30	●	Review associate's comments; turn the draft [S16]
18:30-19:30	●	Leave; "often logs back on from home" [S18]; survey average finish 8:20pm [S15]

Figure 4. A worked day in a Banking & Finance seat. Built from one Mayer Brown trainee's published account [S18], Chambers Student [S16] and Legal Cheek's 2026 hours survey (average 9:26am to 8:20pm) [S15] **Reported**; the hour-by-hour layout is [Inferred]. Around a signing or closing it runs much later.

Trainees describe the culture as "non-hierarchical"; one said, "People are actually people here" [S16]. Legal Cheek's trainee survey grades training, peer support and partner approachability A*, work/life balance B and legal tech C [S13] **Reported**. Know the C for legal tech: it sits awkwardly next to the firm's 2026 AI push (Part 8).

How a task moves through you



Orange steps are where most trainee errors are prevented. The GM case (Part 2) is what happens when nobody checks what a document actually does.

Time recording: trainees log about 7.2 hours a day with no billable target [S16].

Figure 5. The life of a request through a trainee. Steps are standard good practice [Inferred]; time-recording norm from Chambers Student [S16] **Reported**.

The scarce resource and the walls

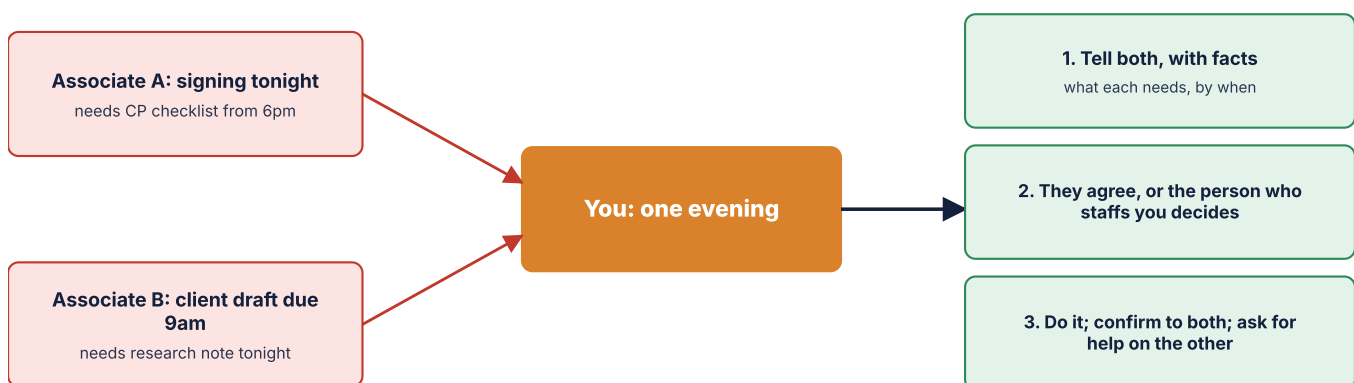


Figure 6. The scarce-resource collision in a trainee seat: your time. Allocation by transparency and escalation, not by saying yes twice. Method is [Inferred]; see composure scenario 1 in Part 11.



Figure 7. The walls around a trainee and what may cross each. **Sources:** SRA Code of Conduct for Firms 6.5 [S110]; Code for Solicitors 1.4 and 6.3 [S342]; Criminal Justice Act 1993 Part V [S343]; UK MAR [S344] **Confirmed**.

The compliance dimension: what to be able to say unprompted

- **Confidentiality.** "You keep the affairs of current and former clients confidential" (SRA Code 6.3) [S342]. No deal talk outside the team.
- **Conflicts.** The firm does not act where there is a conflict of interest (6.2). That's why every matter is checked before it opens [S12][S110].
- **Supervision.** Supervisors stay accountable for the work they supervise (3.5), which is why your work is always checked [S12].
- **Honesty.** Never mislead clients, the court or others (1.4); be open when things go wrong (7.11) [S342].
- **Inside information.** Insider dealing is a crime (Criminal Justice Act 1993, Part V) [S343].

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"A good trainee is careful with three things: the client's information, the detail of every document, and telling people early. The GM filing error shows what happens when nobody checks what a document actually does." (Part 2)

A realistic career path

Trainee (two years), NQ, associate, senior associate, counsel, partner. Mayer Brown uses a formal counsel rank: in November 2025 it promoted 36 partners and 21 counsel worldwide, effective 1 January 2026, including four partners and four counsel in London [S5] **Confirmed**. Miriam Bruce, the training principal, joined as a trainee in 2005, qualified in 2007 and became a partner in January 2020 [S63]. That is about 13 years from qualification to partner in one well-documented case. No firm-wide timescale is published; do not quote one.

The team, mapped: Mayer Brown London

The entity. The London practice is Mayer Brown International LLP, company OC303359, incorporated 13 November 2002 and called Mayer, Brown, Rowe & Maw LLP until 2007, registered at 201 Bishopsgate, London EC2M 3AF [S40], SRA number 369822 [S44] **Confirmed**. The same LLP also runs the Tokyo office [S43].

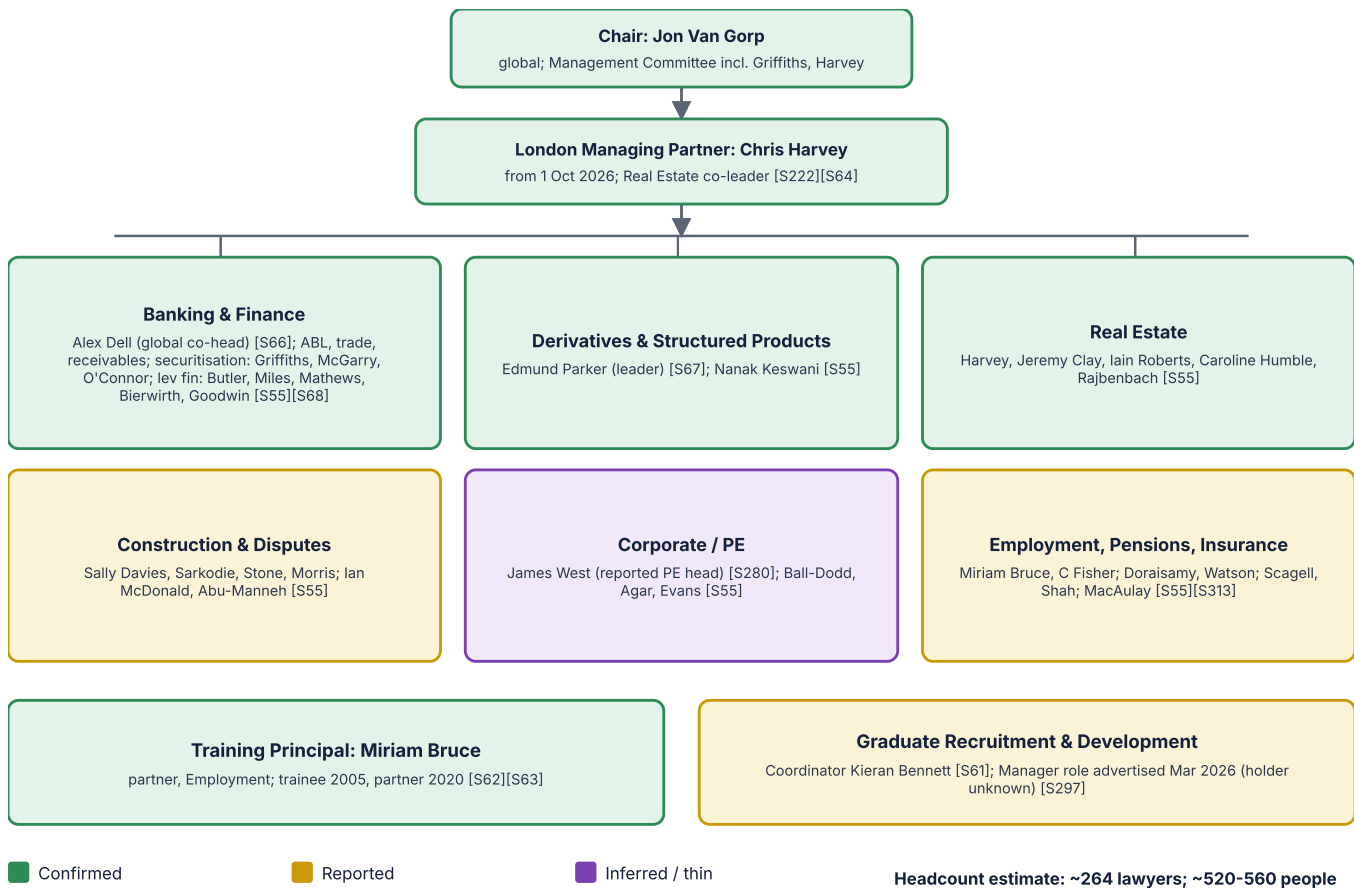


Figure 8. The reconstructed London org chart, colour-coded by confidence. No official chart is published. Built from Legal 500 UK 2027 individual rankings [S55], firm releases and bios [S62]-[S68][S222], Companies House [S41] and directories [S61]. Practice "lead" labels are confirmed only for Harvey, Dell, Parker and Griffiths; the rest are inferred from rankings.

Headcount: method shown

Measure	Figure	Source and method
London lawyers	About 264	American Lawyer data reprinted by the firm [S220]
Members (partners), average	92 (year to Apr 2025)	LLP accounts note 6 [S78]; 103 active members on the register on 8 Oct 2026, including Tokyo [S41]
Employees, average	429: 202 professional, 227 office and management	LLP accounts note 5 [S78]
Total people	Estimate 520 to 560	429 + 92 = 521; directory says "550 staff" [S61] Inferred
Lawyers per partner	Estimate 2 to 2.5	About 264 lawyers against about 90 to 100 London partners Inferred

How the work splits

The LLP refuses to break down its turnover because doing so "would be seriously prejudicial to the interests of the group" [S78]. Indicators: London's 2025 growth was driven by private equity and finance, with 96 deals done jointly by London and New York lawyers [S302]; the Legal 500 top-tier rankings sit in finance, real estate and construction [S139]. A rough estimate: finance and capital markets 35-45% of London activity, real estate 15-20%, disputes and construction 20-25%, the rest corporate, employment, pensions, tax and regulatory **Inferred, low confidence**.

Hiring as an org chart in disguise



Figure 9. Named hires: leveraged finance: Butler and Miles (Dechert, 2025), Goodwin (Kirkland, 2026), Mathews, Becker and Bierwirth (Baker McKenzie, 2026), Clarke (Baker McKenzie, 2026); PE: Agar (Goodwin, 2025), Evans (Dechert, 2025); real estate: Rajbenbach and Butcher (2026); insurance: MacAulay (from L&G, 2024). What the firm is hiring for: London lateral partner arrivals named in press releases, 2024 to Sep 2026, by practice. **Sources:** [S68][S69][S280][S282][S313][S226][S227][S228][S229] cross-checked with Companies House [S42] **Reported**. Firm-wide, 56 lateral partners joined in 2025 [S84]. The count is of named hires found, not a complete list.

From mid-2025 the firm has been hiring hard into leveraged finance and private capital, from Dechert, Baker McKenzie, Kirkland and Goodwin, and into real estate. In 2024 to early 2025 the Companies House register shows more partners leaving than joining, which looks like a pruning phase; some senior construction and competition partners have left the LLP register in 2026 [S42] **Inferred**. Leaving the register does not prove someone joined a rival.

Benchmark against peers in London

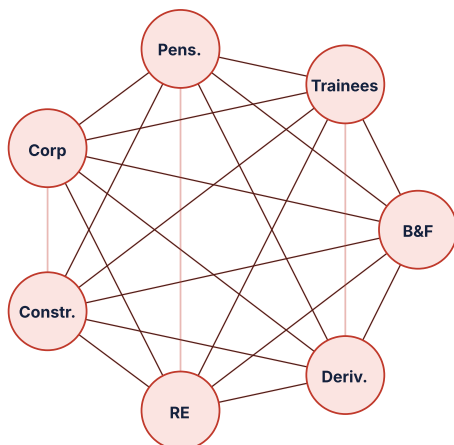
Firm	London revenue	London size	TCs a year	NQ pay
Mayer Brown	\$268.2m (2025)	~264 lawyers	~15	£150k
Sidley Austin	\$299m	~200 lawyers	19	£175k
White & Case	\$584m	n/a	~50	£175k
Latham & Watkins	Over \$1bn (reported)	n/a	32	£173k

Sources: [S302][S129][S132][S130][S287][S288][S290][S120]. **Reported**. Mayer Brown London is a mid-sized US firm in London: roughly Sidley-sized, about half White & Case.

Will the interviewers be on this team?

The speakers are not published. The most likely partner speaker is the training principal, Miriam Bruce. The new London managing partner, Chris Harvey, may open; a finance partner is likely for the deep dive given the firm's mix. Part 10 profiles them. Expect trainees and graduate recruitment staff, who are practitioners of the process rather than of the law, and pitch accordingly **Inferred**.

Without a centre: every partner chases trainees



Mid-seat meetings with graduate recruitment; trainees rank up to five seats; business need decides [S16]

With graduate recruitment as the hub

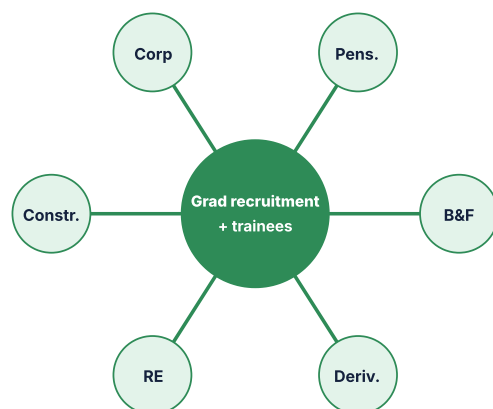


Figure 10. Why a central function exists: about 15 trainees a year across many practice groups. Without a hub, every group negotiates with every trainee; with one, preferences and business need meet in one place. Mechanism from Chambers Student [S16]; diagram is [Inferred].

PART 2

The firm as a business, from the inside

Where Mayer Brown came from, how the money flows, what each group gives and gets, how risk is controlled, what has grown, what leadership says comes next, and the skeletons, told straight.

DON'T SAY THIS: FOUR COMMON ERRORS

1. "Mayer Brown merged with Brown & Wood." **False.** Brown & Wood merged with Sidley in 2001 [S92][S339]; Mayer Brown's own history doesn't mention it [S70].
2. "Jon Van Gorp is managing partner." He is **Chair**. The firm's leadership page lists Jeremy Clay as Managing Partner [S74].
3. "Mayer Brown is the biggest international firm in Hong Kong." **Out of date.** Johnson Stokes & Master became independent again in 2024; Mayer Brown Hong Kong had 21 lawyers in the 2026 data [S70][S220].
4. "It's a one-firm global partnership." The firm calls itself "a global legal services provider comprising associated legal practices that are separate entities" [S75]. Say "integrated transatlantic platform", the firm's own phrase [S327].

A. The founding insight

In 1881 "Adolf Kraus and Levy Mayer form a partnership in Chicago" [S70] **Confirmed**. The firm became Mayer, Meyer, Austrian & Platt in 1909 and Mayer, Brown & Platt in 1970. Separately, in 1895, Rowe & Maw was founded in London [S70]. In 2002 the two combined as Mayer, Brown, Rowe & Maw, shortened to Mayer Brown in 2007 [S70].

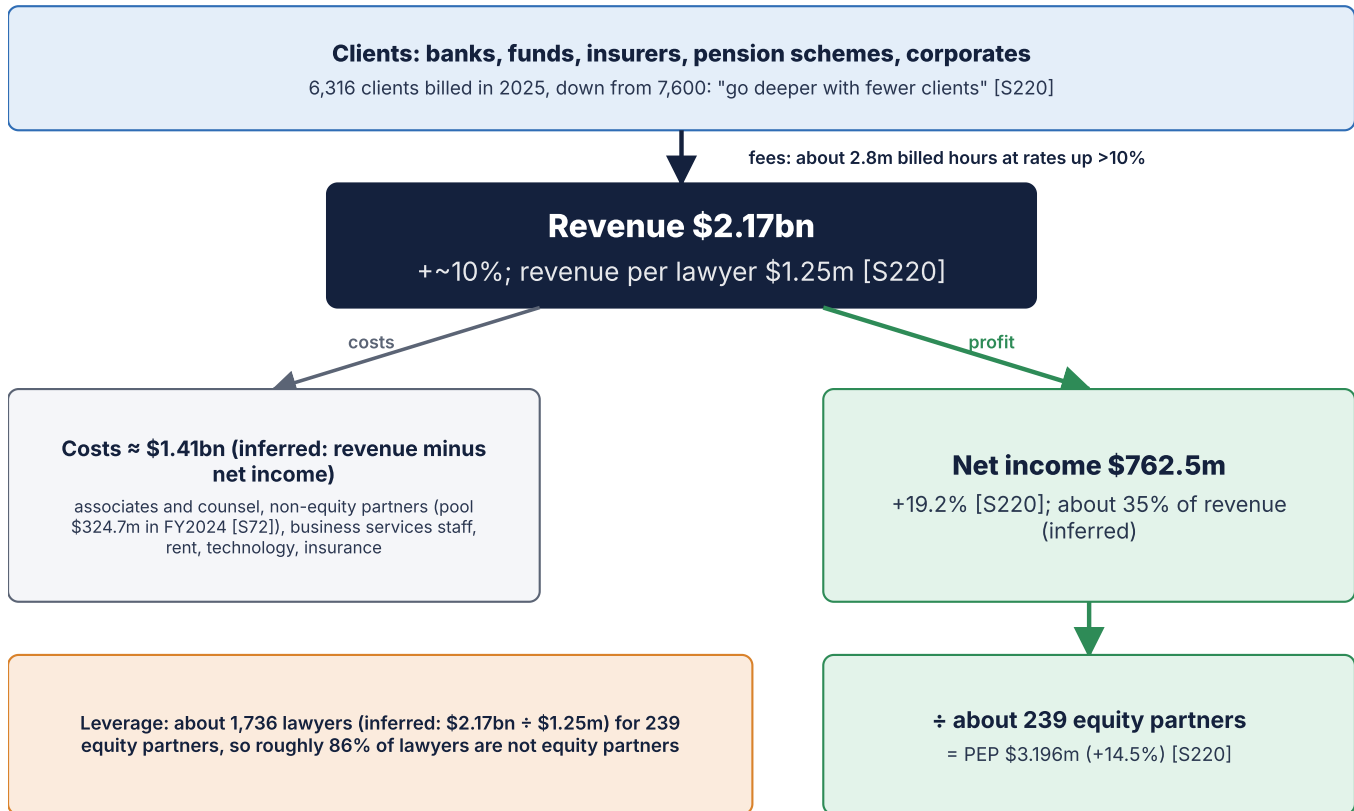
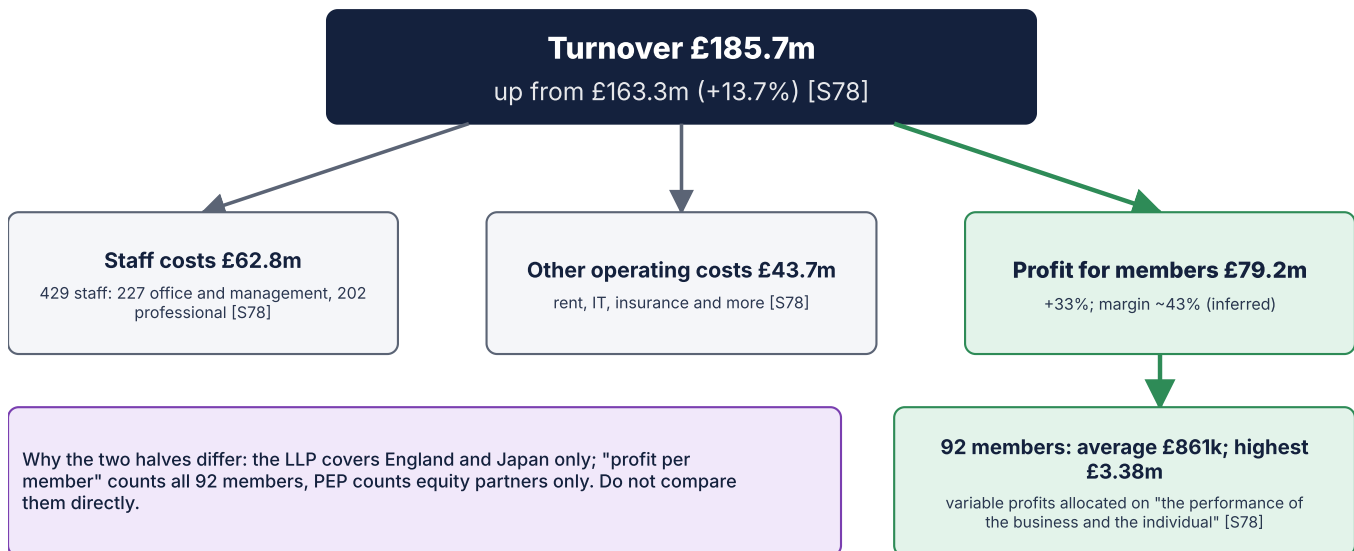
The insight for you: **London is not a US outpost bolted on in 2002. It is a 130-year-old English practice that a Chicago firm merged into.** The firm marked "its 130th anniversary in the City of London" in 2025 [S222]. The London head in April 2026 framed it the same way: Legal Business headlined his interview "We are not an outpost" [S303] (paywalled; headline read only).

The firm's own description of its purpose: "The world's most sophisticated major corporations, funds, and financial institutions rely on Mayer Brown ... to represent them in their most important and complex transactions and disputes" [S79]. It publishes client-service principles rather than a mission statement, including "Collaborating across offices to deliver the best of our knowledge, wherever in the world it's needed" [S79].

- 1881 ● Adolf Kraus and Levy Mayer form a partnership in Chicago [S70]
- 1895 ● Rowe & Maw founded in London: the root of today's London office [S70]
- 1909 ● Mayer, Meyer, Austrian & Platt [S70]
- 1970 ● Mayer, Brown & Platt; Washington DC office opens [S70]
- 1998 ● Merger with Blanchfield Cordle & Moore (Charlotte, North Carolina) [S70]
- 2001 ● Mergers with Lambert & Lee (Paris) and Gaedertz (Germany) [S70]
- 2002 ● Mayer, Brown & Platt combines with Rowe & Maw: Mayer, Brown, Rowe & Maw [S70]
- 2007 ● Name shortened to Mayer Brown [S70]
- 2008 ● Combination with Johnson Stokes & Master, Hong Kong (about 260 lawyers) [S87]
- 2009 ● Association with Tauil & Chequer, Brazil [S70]
- 2021 ● Jon Van Gorp becomes Chair (re-elected June 2024) [S73]
- 2024 ● Mexico City closes (Oct); JSM becomes independent again (around Dec) [S70][S72]
- 2025 ● Revenue \$2.17bn; London revenue +20.5% to a record; 56 lateral partners [S220][S84]
- Apr 2026 ● Firmwide GenAI curriculum [S230]
- 1 Oct 2026 ● Chris Harvey becomes London Managing Partner [S222]

Figure 11. Growth of the firm over time: the mergers that made Mayer Brown, and the 2024 to 2026 repositioning. **Source:** the firm's own history page [S70] and dated releases **Confirmed**. Note: Brown & Wood merged with Sidley in 2001, not with Mayer Brown [S92][S339].

B. How the firm makes money

Global firm, calendar 2025 (American Lawyer figures, reprinted by the firm)**The English entity: Mayer Brown International LLP, year to 30 April 2025 (audited accounts at Companies House)**

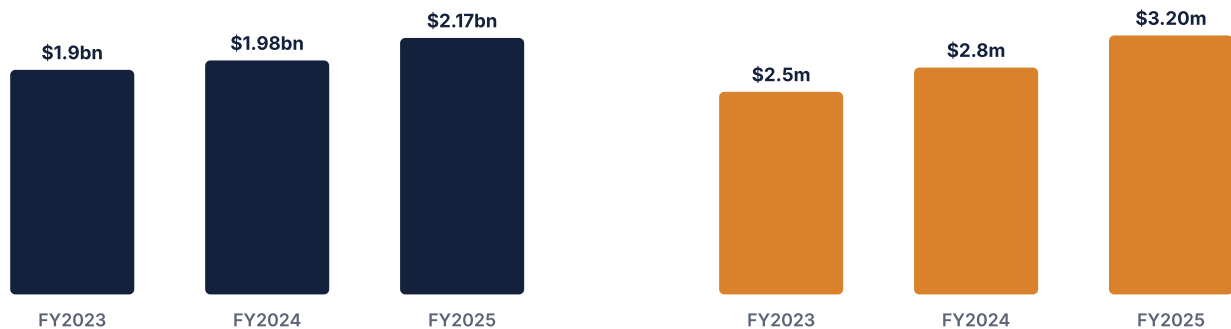
Estimates on this page: costs, margin, implied lawyer count and leverage are arithmetic from the sourced totals, labelled (inferred). American Lawyer figures are self-reported by the firm and not audited; the LLP accounts are audited by RSM UK Audit LLP [S78].

Figure 12. How money flows through Mayer Brown: the global firm (top) and its English LLP (bottom). **Sources:** American Lawyer via mayerbrown.com, 25 Mar 2026 [S220]; Mayer Brown International LLP accounts to 30 Apr 2025, filed 16 Jan 2026 [S78]. **Confirmed** totals; derived figures marked (inferred).

Growth in 2025 came from price and mix, not volume. Billed hours fell about 4%, revenue rose about 10%, billing rates rose more than 10%, and the number of clients billed fell 17% [S220] **Confirmed** (percentages inferred). Chair Jon Van Gorp: "We're sustaining demand, but also repositioning the platform" [S220].

Revenue (\$bn)

Profit per equity partner (\$m)



FY2023 figures are the firm's rounded "\$1.9 billion" and "nearly \$2.5 million" [S73]; FY2024 [S72]; FY2025 [S220].

Figure 13. Three years of results: revenue up about 14%, PEP up about 28% (inferred from the figures shown), while billed hours fell. **Sources:** [S73][S72] [S220] **Confirmed** (self-reported to the American Lawyer).

Context: the 2026 Am Law 100 average PEP was reported at \$3.59m [S118], so Mayer Brown's \$3.196m is below the US average but well above the Magic Circle (Part 4). Bloomberg Law described the firm as likely among the 30 largest US firms [S86] **Reported**.

KEY TERM: WIP AND LOCK-UP

Work in progress (WIP) is time recorded but not yet billed. Lock-up is the time between doing the work and getting paid. The London LLP credited its 2025 turnover rise partly to "an increased focus on WIP management and lock-up" [S78]. For a trainee, that means recording time accurately and promptly.

C. The contracts the business is made of

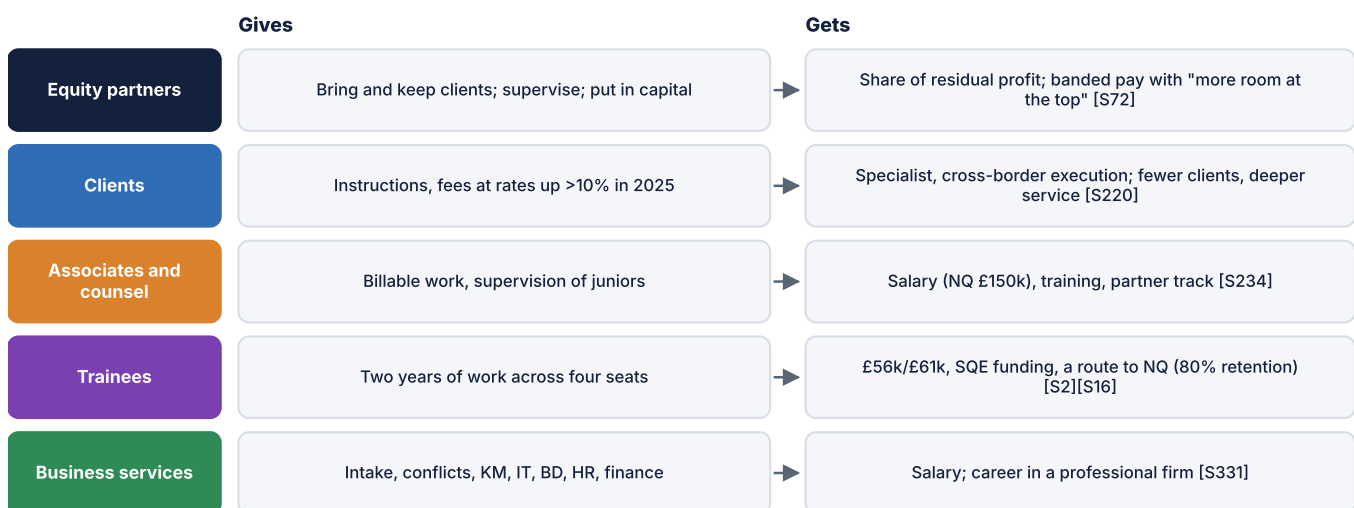


Figure 14. The "contracts" the business is made of: what each group gives and gets. Each cell sourced as marked; the framing is the author's [Inferred].

Partners. About 239 equity partners in 2025 [S220]. Pay is not pure lockstep at the top: Van Gorp said "The compensation for equity partners was expanded with more room at the top to pay our top performers" [S72]. In the English LLP, "Allocation of variable profits to members is made on a calendar year basis, taking into account the performance of the business and the individual", and "Capital is treated as debt and is repaid in full on retirement" [S78] **Confirmed**. No source names the system; say "banded, with a performance element" and no more.

Clients. Banks, funds, insurers, corporates. Bloomberg Law names JPMorgan Chase and Citibank as major clients [S86]; Legal 500 lists ISDA, Barclays, BNP Paribas and others for London derivatives [S316].

Lateral partners. 26 joined in 2024 and 56 in 2025, aimed at leveraged finance and private credit, insurance, energy, infrastructure, capital markets and white collar work. Van Gorp: "We just became very deliberate this year about wanting to expand the firm through lateral hiring" [S84] **Reported**.

D. The risk and control architecture

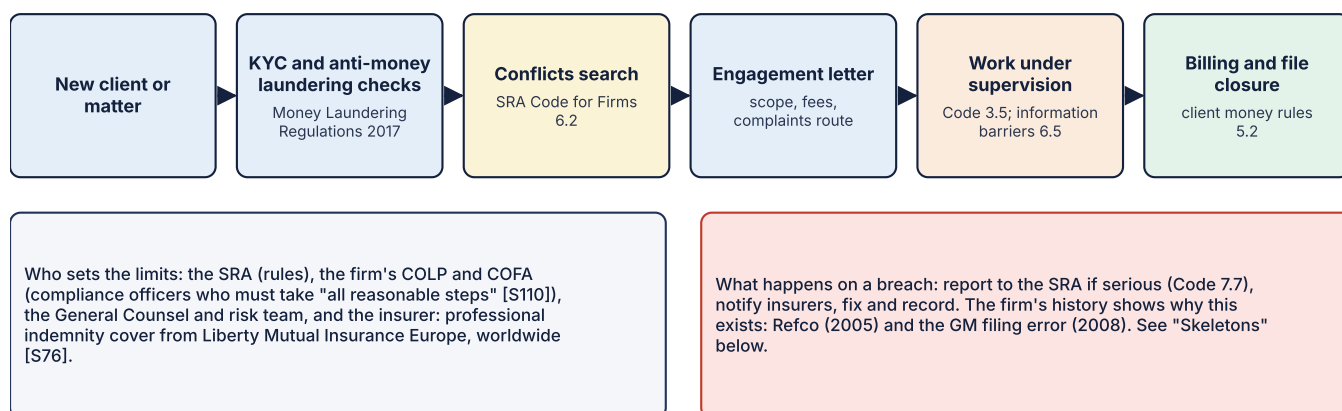


Figure 15. The risk and control architecture of a law firm: the life of a matter through the controls. Rules from the SRA Code of Conduct for Firms [S110] and for Solicitors [S342]; insurer from the firm's legal notices [S76] **Confirmed**. Sequence is standard practice [Inferred].

Why this produces the firm's characteristic result: in a law firm the product is trust. A firm that acts in a conflict, leaks information or files the wrong document can lose a client and its insurance, and can face regulatory sanctions. The controls are slow by design. A trainee is the person most likely to see the detail that goes wrong, which is why the controls lean on trainees doing checklists properly.

E. Practice mix and what has grown

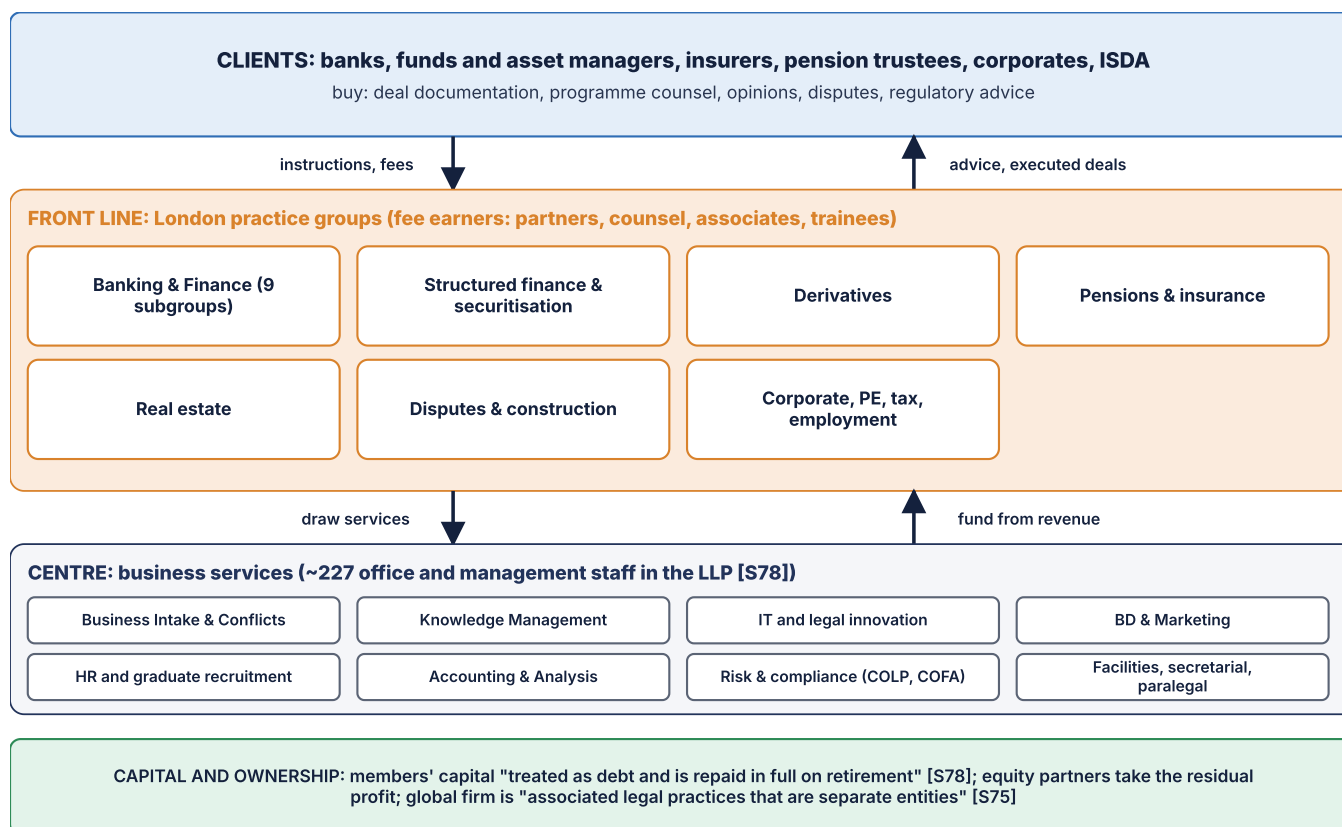


Figure 16. The operating model as layers: clients, the front line, the centre, and capital. Practice list from the firm and Chambers Student [S79][S16]; business services departments from the firm's careers page [S331]; capital terms from the LLP accounts [S78] **Confirmed**. The arrows are the author's simplification [Inferred].

Firm-wide growth areas named by leadership: in 2024, "insurance transactions, energy, data privacy and cybersecurity" [S72]; in 2025, finance, energy, infrastructure and insurance, with Asia "a very big bright spot for us" [S220]. London's 20.5% growth came from "client demand for private capital capabilities and greater sector and product specialisation" (paraphrased) [S222]. Van Gorp's own background is structured finance and mortgage-backed securities [S73].

F. Private partnership: what that means for research

Mayer Brown has no shareholders, annual report or earnings calls. There are three windows: figures self-reported to the American Lawyer (unaudited; the firm reprints them), the English LLP's audited accounts at Companies House, and press releases (positive by design) **Inferred**. The Companies House accounts are the single best primary source, and almost no applicant reads them.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"I looked at the LLP's accounts at Companies House. Turnover went from £163m to £186m in the year to April 2025, and the members' report credits better WIP management and lock-up. I'd like to understand how that shows up for a trainee: time recording, billing narratives?"

G. Leadership's view of the future, and what hiring suggests

- **Stated:** fewer, deeper client relationships [S220]; deliberate lateral growth in areas "we thought we were underweight" [S84]; London "central to our international platform" [S222]; AI that amplifies "lawyer capabilities and judgement, not replacing them" [S230].
- **Inferred from hiring:** London is building a sponsor-side (private equity) finance capability to sit alongside its bank-side strength; Asia has shifted from Hong Kong to Tokyo and Singapore; headcount is held roughly flat while revenue per lawyer rises **Inferred**.
- **Not doing:** merging. While rivals combined, the chair said "Right now, we're pretty focused on executing our strategy" [S220].

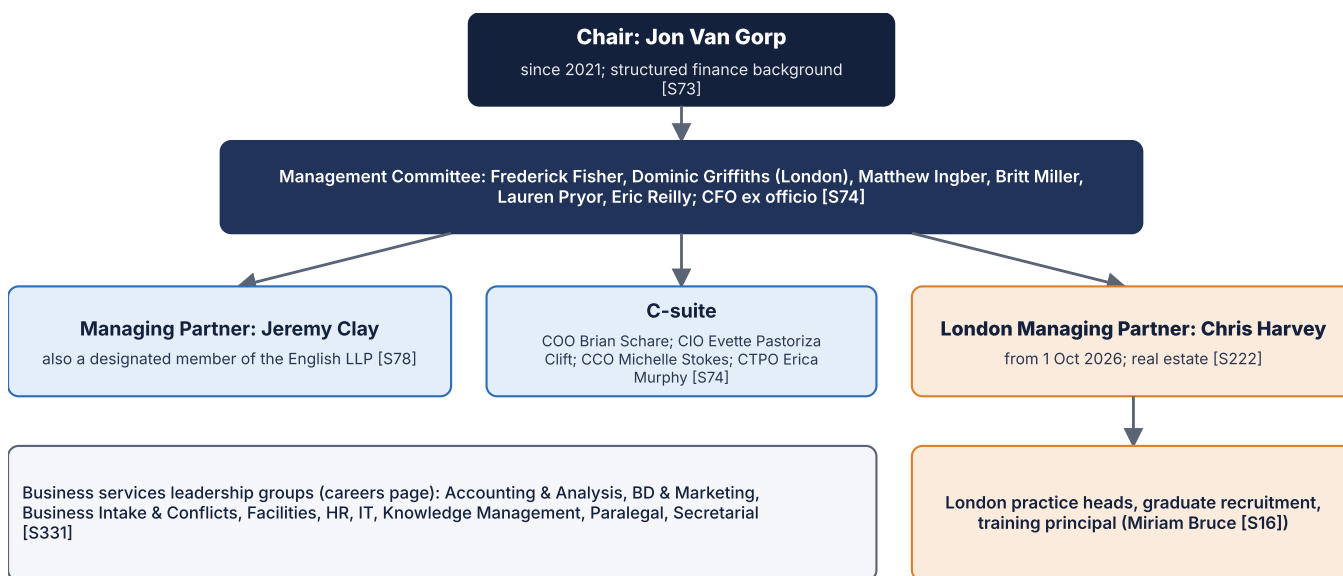


Figure 17. The centre as the firm publishes it: leadership and business services groupings, as at 8 Oct 2026. **Sources:** firm leadership page [S74], careers page [S331], release of 28 Sep 2026 [S222] **Confirmed**.

H. Recent moves, last 24 months

Date	Event	Source
End Oct 2024	Mexico City office closes; team forms its own firm	[S72][S89]
Around Dec 2024	Johnson Stokes & Master becomes independent; Mayer Brown Hong Kong continues with about 20-26 lawyers	[S70][S72][S88]
Jul 2025	London NQ pay to £150k	[S234]

Date	Event	Source
Sep 2025	Leveraged finance co-heads Philip Butler and David Miles join from Dechert	[S280]
Oct 2025	Advises Ford pension trustees on £4.6bn buy-in with Legal & General	[S310]
25 Mar 2026	FY2025 results: \$2.17bn, PEP \$3.196m	[S220]
14 Apr 2026	Firmwide GenAI curriculum (Harvey, Copilot)	[S230]
Apr 2026	Sarah Goodwin joins from Kirkland (leveraged finance)	[S327]
Aug 2026	Documents sent in error to an impostor; firm says no systems access	[S105]
1 Sep 2026	Three-partner high yield and leveraged finance team from Baker McKenzie	[S226]
30 Sep 2026	Legal 500 UK 2027: 47 areas, five top tiers incl. new derivatives top tier	[S139]
1 Oct 2026	Chris Harvey becomes London Managing Partner	[S222]

I. The skeletons, told straight

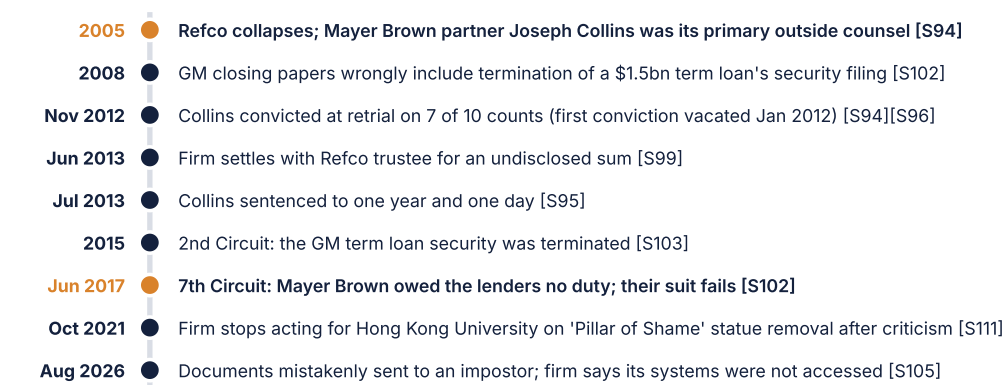


Figure 18. The skeletons, told straight. **Sources:** US Department of Justice releases [S94][S95]; court rulings [S102][S103]; press [S96][S99][S105][S111]. **Confirmed** for court and DOJ facts; others **Reported**.

Refco (the serious one). Refco, a commodities broker, collapsed in October 2005, two months after its stock market listing, when it emerged that the chief executive had hidden a receivable of more than \$1bn owed by a company he controlled. Joseph Collins, a Mayer Brown partner, was Refco's "primary outside counsel" [S94]. Prosecutors said lawyers under his direction drafted documents for loans that hid the debt. His 2009 conviction was overturned in 2012 because the judge had spoken privately with a juror; he was convicted again at retrial in November 2012 and sentenced in July 2013 to one year and one day [S94][S95][S96] **Confirmed**. The firm settled the Refco trustee's claims for an undisclosed sum in 2013 [S99]. One investor case against the firm, *Pacific Investment Management v Mayer Brown* (2nd Cir. 2010), is now a leading US case limiting advisers' liability for statements not attributed to them [S98] **Reported**.

GM (the trainee lesson). In 2008, closing papers that Mayer Brown prepared for General Motors, to pay off one loan, also terminated the security filing for a separate \$1.5bn term loan. JPMorgan and its lawyers approved them. In 2015 the Second Circuit held the security really was terminated [S103]. The lenders then sued Mayer Brown, and lost: in 2017 the Seventh Circuit held "Mayer Brown did not owe a duty to plaintiffs" [S102] **Confirmed**. No settlement was found.

Hong Kong, 2021. Acting for the University of Hong Kong, the firm wrote to the custodians of the "Pillar of Shame" Tiananmen memorial about its removal; after criticism, it stopped acting on the matter [S111] **Reported**.

August 2026. The firm said "one of its personnel mistakenly sent a small number of documents to an unauthorised third party" who had misrepresented their identity, and that the third party "did not access our systems" [S105]. Do not call it a hack.

No SRA or Solicitors Disciplinary Tribunal sanction against the London LLP was found, but the register itself could not be checked **Gap**.

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

If asked about Refco, don't defend or attack. "It's why law firms have client-inception checks and escalation for unusual transactions. A trainee's job is to ask when something doesn't make sense." If asked about GM: "It's the clearest case for why checklists matter. The firm won on duty, but the lesson is the same for everyone who touches a closing set."

PART 3

Why the firm is built this way

Four questions, answered with evidence: why this structure; how the teams actually work together; what clients are really buying; and what the non-fee-earning side looks like and how it is wired to the lawyers.

1. Why is the business structured this way?

The structure. A group of "associated legal practices that are separate entities" [S75]: a US LLP, the English LLP (which also runs Tokyo), Hong Kong, a Singapore joint venture and an association in Brazil. In London, the practice mix is weighted to finance products sold to institutions (asset-based lending, derivatives, trade finance, securitisation), plus real estate and construction disputes [S139][S140].

Mayer Brown London: finance-product depth	Alternative: PE / M&A-led US model (e.g. Kirkland)
Core client banks, lenders, insurers, issuers, ISDA [S316]	Core client private equity sponsors [S131]
Top rankings Tier 1: ABL, derivatives, trade finance, real estate occupiers, construction [S139]	Top rankings M&A, private equity, leveraged finance (sponsor side)
Growth move buy in PE / lev fin teams; organic finance [S226][S327]	Growth move organic plus aggressive laterals
Cohort ~15 trainees, Magic Circle pay [S16][S234]	Cohort up to 15 trainees, US pay £175k NQ [S131][S120]
Revenue \$2.17bn global; London \$268.2m [S220][S302]	Revenue \$10.6bn global [S125]

Figure 19. The two models side by side. Mayer Brown London leads in asset-focused finance and is buying into PE; a PE-led firm starts from the sponsor. Sources as marked; Kirkland rankings characterised from public reputation [Inferred] and its Legal Cheek profile [S131].

The theory: what the structure buys

- Depth in asset-focused finance.** Top tier in London for asset-based lending (13th consecutive year), derivatives and structured products (new this year) and trade finance [S139]. These are repeat products for repeat bank clients, which fits "go deeper with fewer clients" [S220].
- Products that need several teams at once.** A pension buy-in needs pensions, insurance, derivatives and finance lawyers together (figure below). A firm with only one of those can't run it alone.
- Credible transatlantic execution.** English-law and New York-law finance from one platform: "a fully integrated platform for New York and English law debt and equity solutions" [S328]; 96 London-New York deals in 2025 [S302].
- A small cohort.** About 15 trainees a year. The training principal: "One of the advantages of a training contract at Mayer Brown is that it is a small cohort ... we can develop a bespoke programme" [S16].

What the structure costs

- Less brand in private equity and M&A.** Legal 500 ranks London premium M&A in tier 6 and mid-market PE in tier 3 [S146]. The firm is importing sponsor-side talent rather than having grown it [S327].
- Fewer NQ jobs per practice** because the intake is small.
- A smaller Asia platform** since 2024 [S70][S220].
- Lower London profitability than the global headline.** Average profit per LLP member was £861,333 in the year to April 2025 [S78], a different measure from the \$3.196m global PEP; treat the gap as directional only.

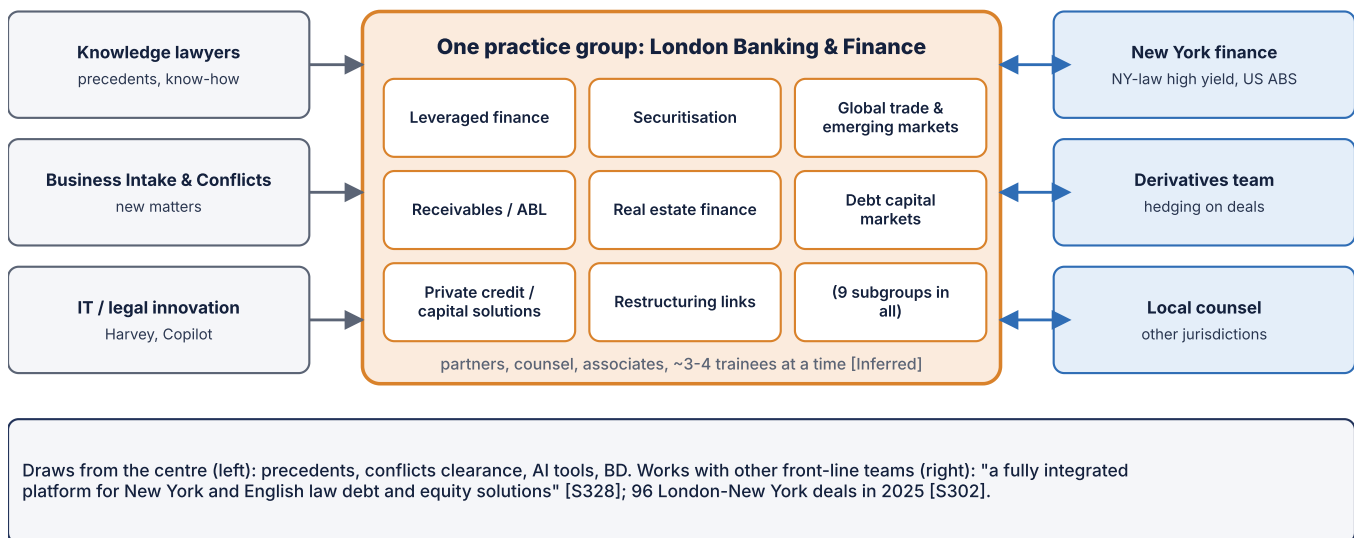


Figure 20. Anatomy of one front-line unit and what it draws from the centre. Subgroups: Chambers Student says nine, including leveraged finance, securitisation, global trade & emerging markets, and receivables [S16]; others from a trainee's account [S18] **Reported**; private credit and restructuring boxes, and the links, are [Inferred] except where cited.

2. How do the teams work together, and where does collaboration actually live?

Read the firm's own words precisely. Its principles say "Collaborating across offices to deliver the best of our knowledge, wherever in the world it's needed" and "Building diverse teams of lawyers from our market-leading practices to help achieve our clients' goals" [S79]. Those are about *teams on a client's matter*, not about a shared pool of ideas. Collaboration lives in three concrete places:

- **Cross-practice products.** The Pensions Finance practice combines pensions with "finance, financial services, insurance, and derivatives lawyers" as a "one-stop shop" [S314].
- **Cross-office deal teams.** The Zankore AI financing was led from Singapore with London on hedging and Washington and Dubai on sanctions and export controls [S231]. Former London head Dominic Griffiths: "We set out to build something distinctive - a platform where the best lawyers collaborate across borders" [S301].
- **Industry groups** that cut across practices: Financial Services, Insurance, Global Energy, Projects & Infrastructure, Funds, Technology, Data Centers, Chemicals [S79].



Figure 21. Why the structure works: a product that needs four teams at once. Ford Pension Schemes £4.6bn buy-in with Legal & General, the largest UK pension risk transfer deal announced in 2025 [S310]; Royal London deals [S223][S312]; practice description [S314]. **Confirmed** (firm sources).

The Ford deal shows the mechanism. The £4.6bn buy-in, the largest UK pension risk transfer announced in 2025, was led by Tom MacAulay of the Global Insurance Industry Group, with Andrew Block of the Pensions Group as relationship partner [S310]. MacAulay had been hired from Legal & General in 2024 to "bring cross-office and practice expertise across

corporate, finance and pensions" [S313] **Confirmed**. A pensions relationship opened the door; an insurance specialist ran the deal.

Shared freely across practices and offices	Never shared (or only through controls)
Precedents and know-how (Knowledge Management) [S331]	Confidential information of one client with a team acting against them (barrier, Code for Firms 6.5) [S110]
Client relationships: a pensions partner can bring in insurance colleagues [S310]	Inside information, to anyone outside the deal team [S343][S344]
Cross-office teams on one deal: London, New York, Singapore, Dubai [S231]	Matters with a conflict of interest (Code 6.2) [S110]
Training, AI tools and prompt libraries [S230]	Personal data beyond what the matter needs

Figure 22. The boundary between teams: what is shared, what is never shared, and why. Rules from the SRA Code for Firms [S110] and insider dealing law [S343][S344] **Confirmed**; examples from firm releases.

3. What do clients actually buy, and why do they pay?

Client	What they buy	Named clients (Legal 500 UK 2027 / firm)
Bank (derivatives)	ISDA netting opinions; risk participation; SRT notes	ANZ, Barclays, BNP Paribas, JP Morgan, ISDA... [S316]
Lender (asset-based lending)	cross-border ABL across England, US, Germany	Santander, Barclays, Citigroup, Wells Fargo... [S318]
Issuer / arranger (securitisation)	master trust and auto ABS; CLO platforms	Standard Chartered (with Apollo) [S325]; Capital on Tap deals [S317]
Insurer / trustee (pensions)	buy-ins and buy-outs	Royal London; Ford trustees [S310][S312]
Contractor (construction)	cladding and fire-safety disputes	Shepherd, Wates, Tamdown [S319]

Figure 23. The client's view: who buys what from Mayer Brown London. Named clients are as listed on the Legal 500 UK 2027 pages [S316]-[S319] and firm releases [S310][S312][S325] **Confirmed**. These clients also instruct rivals; the relationships are not exclusive.

What they buy. Precise, repeatable execution on complex finance products: ISDA netting opinions, significant risk transfer notes, cross-border asset-based lending, securitisation programmes, buy-ins [S316][S317][S318]. And, increasingly, judgement: Thomson Reuters finds UK buyers treat expertise as "the price of entry" [S167].

Why they pay. Firm-curated directory comments on its derivatives team: "has its finger on the pulse with ISDA and transatlantic regulatory work"; "military-style turnaround, good value and a deep bench" [S323]

Reported, undated and selected by the firm. The current Legal 500 pages carry no client testimonials, only editorial text [S315]-[S319].



Figure 24. London's 2024 to 2026 stability and growth in six numbers. **Sources:** Non-Billable 27 Apr 2026 [S302] and Solicitors Journal 8 May 2026 [S301], both relaying firm figures **Reported**; Companies House [S78] and American Lawyer [S220] **Confirmed**.

The counter-case, with numbers

- Many named clients (Barclays, BNP Paribas, JP Morgan, Deutsche Bank) also use the Magic Circle and US rivals; these are not exclusive relationships **Inferred**.
- Clients billed fell 17% (7,600 to 6,316). That is either deliberate focus or attrition; the firm says focus [S220].
- In London securitisation and pensions the firm is tier 2, not tier 1 [S141][S145].
- Acting for both trustees (Ford) and insurers (Royal London) shows breadth, but it limits who the firm can act for on any one deal **Inferred**.

4. What does the non-fee-earning side look like?

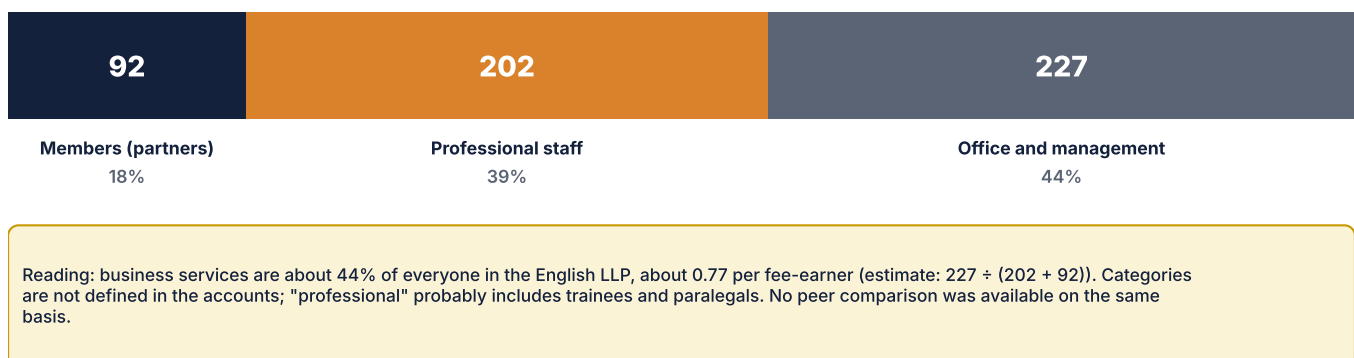


Figure 25. Size of the non-fee-earning side: average headcount in Mayer Brown International LLP, year to 30 April 2025. **Source:** audited accounts, notes 5 and 6 [S78] **Confirmed**; percentages and ratio are estimates (labelled).

How it is organised. The firm's careers page lists business services groups: "Accounting & Analysis, Business Development & Marketing, Business Intake & Conflicts, Facilities, Human Resources, Information Technology, Knowledge Management, Paralegal, and Secretarial" [S331] **Confirmed**. London names a Director of Administration and a Senior Director of Commercial Strategy & Growth [S49]. No offshore shared-services centre was found.

AI and innovation. Global CIO Evette Pastoriza Clift joined from Fried Frank in September 2024; training is compulsory before anyone gets Harvey or Copilot; the firm takes a hybrid "buy v build" approach. "The AI literacy piece is really fundamental to everything" [S330] **Reported**. The GenAI programme was Highly Commended at the FT Innovative Lawyers Europe 2025 awards [S325].



Figure 26. How a front-line unit is wired into the centre: embedded, connective, utility and control roles. Department names from the firm's business services careers page [S331] and GenAI release [S230] **Confirmed**; the four-way classification is [Inferred]. No offshore shared-services centre was found.

SAY THIS AT NETWORKING

To a business services person: "How does your team work with the lawyers day to day? Are you embedded in a practice, or firm-wide?" It shows you understand that a law firm is more than its lawyers, and almost nobody else will ask.

Diversity, social mobility and pro bono: what is on record

- **Social Mobility Employer Index 2025:** 32nd (joint) in the Top 75 [S335] **Confirmed**. Linklaters (6), A&O (7), Slaughter and May (19), Freshfields (22) and Hogan Lovells (24) ranked higher; Clifford Chance (35) and White & Case (65) lower.
- **Mansfield certification** for 2023-24 in the UK ("Trendsetter") and US [S311] **Reported**; nothing found for later years.
- **Pro bono:** signatory to the UK Joint Protocol; 2025 LawWorks Pro Bono Connect Award; European Pro Bono Counsel Mehreen Malik in London [S336]. Trainees' "Got20" scheme [S16].
- **Outreach:** moved recruitment marketing away from Oxbridge and redbrick universities [S16]; won "Most Inclusive Assessment Process" at the AllAboutLaw Awards 2022 [S284].
- **Gender pay gap (April 2025):** mean 21.1%, median 41.8%; the firm attributes it to more women in business services and secretarial roles [S46][S47] **Confirmed**. Don't raise it; know it.

PART 4

How the firm stands out

Mayer Brown against nine rivals on size, pay, intake and strengths; the design axes where it sits at one end; six claims no rival in the set can make; and, just as important, where it does not lead.

The peer table

Firm	Global revenue	PEP	London TCs / yr	Trainee pay	NQ	Retention	London strengths (Legal 500)
Mayer Brown	\$2.17bn	\$3.196m	~15	£56k/£61k	£150k	80%	T1 ABL, derivatives, trade finance; T2 securitisation, pensions
Sidley Austin	\$3.74bn	£4.46m	19	£60k/£65k	£175k	n/d	T1 securitisation; T2 derivatives
Latham & Watkins	\$8.3bn	~\$8.7m	32	£60k/£65k	£173k	96%	T1 securitisation; T4 derivatives
Kirkland & Ellis	\$10.56bn	\$11.1m	up to 15	£70k/£75k	£175k	87%	PE and M&A led
White & Case	~\$3.6bn	\$4.4m	50	£62k/£67k	£175k	100%	T2 derivatives, securitisation, trade finance
Hogan Lovells Cadwalader	>\$3.6bn (combined)	£2.67m (HL, pre-merger)	45	£56k/£61k	£145k	67%	T1 pensions, trade finance; T2 securitisation
Clifford Chance	£2.6bn (~\$3.5bn)	£2.3m	100	£56k/£61k	£150k	78%	T1 derivatives, securitisation
A&O Shearman	\$3.7bn	£2.2m	70	£56k/£61k	£150k	77%	T1 derivatives, securitisation, pensions
Norton Rose Fulbright	>\$2.8bn	\$2m	~50	£56k/£61k	£140k	95%	T1 trade finance; T2 ABL
Baker McKenzie	\$3.6bn	£1.8m	40	£56k/£61k	£150k	67%	T3 derivatives, securitisation

Sources: Legal Cheek profiles and NQ table, Sep 2026 [S120][S121][S129]-[S137]; American Lawyer data [S122][S125]; HLC merger [S126]; Legal 500 London tier pages [S141]-[S146]. **Reported**. Mixed currencies are as published; conversions differ by outlet. n/d = not disclosed.

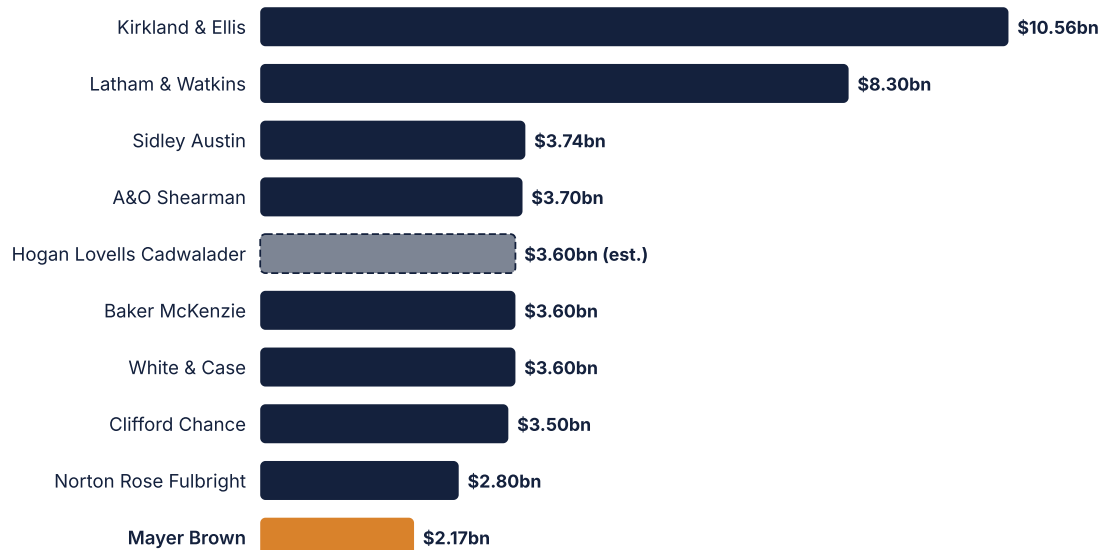


Figure 27. Global revenue, latest year (mostly FY2025). Mayer Brown is the smallest in this peer set. Hogan Lovells Cadwalader is a combined figure ("over \$3.6bn") shown dashed as an estimate. **Sources:** [S122][S125][S126][S129]-[S137] **Reported**; currency conversions by the outlets.

The design choices: where Mayer Brown sits at one end

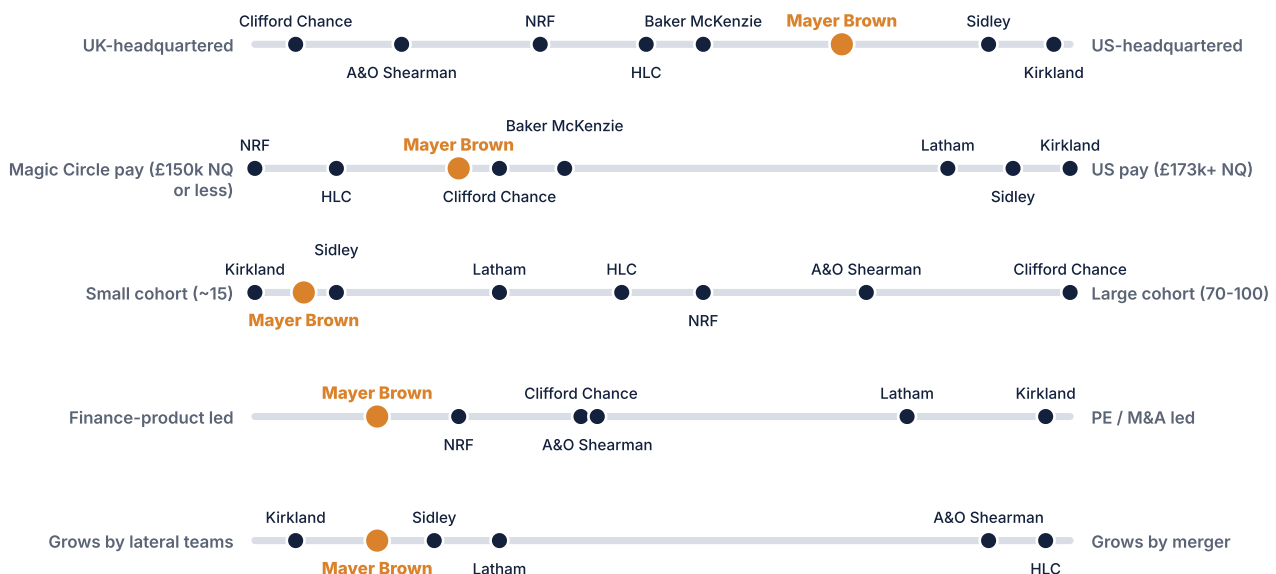


Figure 28. The competitive spectrum: five design axes and where each rival sits. Pay and cohort from Legal Cheek profiles and NQ table [S120][S129]-[S137]; merger facts [S126][S174]; finance vs PE positioning from Legal 500 tiers [S141]-[S146]. Firms on the same pay or cohort are spread slightly for legibility. Positions on the finance/PE axis are the author's judgement **Inferred**.

On three axes Mayer Brown sits near an end: **pay** (Magic Circle level, not US level), **cohort size** (one of the two smallest) and **finance-product focus** (asset-based lending, derivatives and trade finance rather than sponsor-side M&A). On **growth method** it sits at the "lateral teams, not mergers" end, alongside Kirkland and against A&O Shearman and Hogan Lovells Cadwalader [S220][S240].

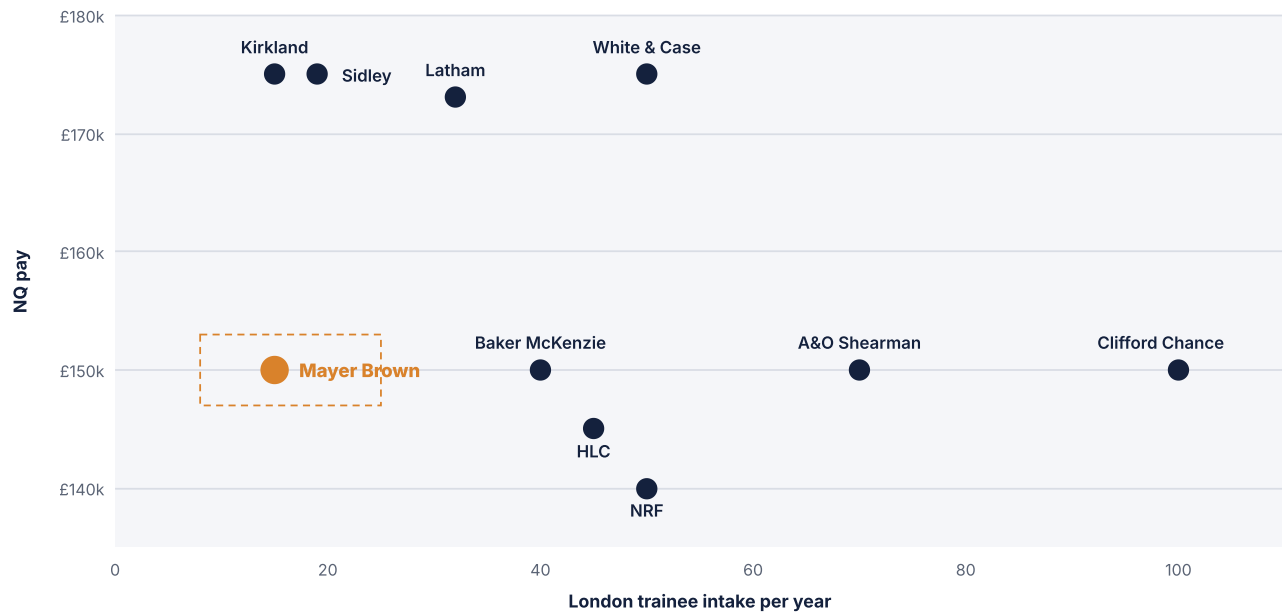


Figure 29. Size against staffing: trainee intake against NQ pay for Mayer Brown and nine peers. Mayer Brown is alone in the small-cohort, Magic Circle-pay corner. **Sources:** Legal Cheek profiles and NQ table, Sep 2026 [S120][S121][S129]-[S137]; Chambers Student [S149] **Reported**. HLC = Hogan Lovells Cadwalader.

Six things only Mayer Brown can claim

- 1 **Only firm in the peer set top tier in London for both derivatives and asset-based lending**
Legal 500 UK 2027 [S142][S144]
- 2 **Only US-founded firm in the London derivatives top tier**
[S142]
- 3 **Six years running GlobalCapital US ABS Law Firm of the Year, plus SRT Law Firm of the Year 2026**
[S148]
- 4 **Magic Circle pay with a cohort of about 15**
[S120][S16]
- 5 **A pensions-insurance-derivatives "one-stop shop" that ran the largest UK buy-in of 2025**
[S310][S314]
- 6 **A 130-year-old English practice inside a Chicago firm; construction negligence top tier 19 years**
[S70][S140]

Figure 30. What Mayer Brown can claim that no rival in the peer set can. Each claim is limited to the nine-firm peer set and sources read on 8 Oct 2026. Claim 6 is "unusual for a US firm", not proven unique.

#	Claim and evidence	Why it matters to you
1	Legal 500 London top tier in both derivatives and asset-based lending; the ABL top tier is just Addleshaw Goddard and Mayer Brown [S142][S144]	A finance seat here means work on products where the firm is the market reference, not a follower.
2	Only US-founded firm in the London derivatives top tier (others: Ashurst Perkins Coie, Clifford Chance, Linklaters, A&O Shearman) [S142]	English-law derivatives depth plus a New York platform. ISDA is a client [S316].

#	Claim and evidence	Why it matters to you
3	GlobalCapital US ABS Law Firm of the Year six years running, and SRT Law Firm of the Year, May 2026; "more than 150 structured finance lawyers" [S148]	Basel 3.1 (1 Jan 2027) drives risk transfer deals; this is where that work goes.
4	Magic Circle pay with a cohort of about 15 [S120][S16]	More responsibility per trainee, same pay as firms taking 70-100.
5	A pensions-insurance-derivatives "one-stop shop" that ran the largest UK buy-in announced in 2025 [S310][S314]	A distinctive London seat combining contract, regulation and finance.
6	A 130-year-old English practice inside a Chicago firm; construction professional negligence top band for 19 consecutive years [S70][S140]	Unusual for a US firm; a strong contentious seat if you want one. (Peers not checked one by one: say "unusual", not "unique".)

Where Mayer Brown does not lead: never overclaim

DON'T SAY THIS

- "Mayer Brown leads London securitisation." It is **tier 2**; Clifford Chance, Latham, Linklaters, Sidley and A&O Shearman are tier 1 [S141]. The US ABS awards are a US claim.
- "It's a top pensions firm." London pensions is **tier 2**; HLC, A&O Shearman, Linklaters, Sackers and others are tier 1 [S145].
- "It's number one US securitisation counsel." In 2025 Hunton ranked first as issuer counsel by deal count (159 deals); Mayer Brown was second (146 deals) but led on dollar volume [S124][S147].
- "It pays like a US firm." No: £150k NQ against £175k at Sidley, Kirkland and White & Case [S120].
- "It's an M&A powerhouse." London premium M&A is tier 6 [S146].
- "It has the highest PEP" or "the best retention". Neither [S121][S129]-[S137].

One line against each rival

If asked "why not..."	Answer pattern
Sidley	"Sidley is stronger in London securitisation and pays more. I'm drawn to the broader structured products side: Mayer Brown is top tier in derivatives, ABL and trade finance in London, where Sidley isn't."
Kirkland or Latham	"If I wanted sponsor-side private equity, I'd look there. I want finance products for institutions, which is where Mayer Brown leads, with a 15-person cohort."
Clifford Chance or A&O Shearman	"Same pay and same top tier in derivatives, but a cohort of 15 against 70 to 100, and a US platform for transatlantic work."
Hogan Lovells Cadwalader	"HLC leads in pensions and now has Cadwalader's structured finance. Mayer Brown is higher in London derivatives and chose to grow without a merger. I'd rather join a firm that isn't integrating a merger."
Norton Rose Fulbright or Baker McKenzie	"Both are strong in trade finance, but bigger and more spread out. Mayer Brown is more concentrated."

PART 5

The industry from zero

What a commercial law firm sells, who buys it, how firms make money, how the different kinds of firm differ, and the forces changing all of it. Read this first if you have never studied law.

What a commercial law firm sells

A commercial law firm sells two things to businesses, banks, funds, insurers, pension schemes and governments. First, **advice**: what the law says, what the risk is, what to do. Second, **execution**: getting a deal or a case done. That means drafting and negotiating documents, running the process, and making sure nothing is missed. Typical work is buying and selling companies (M&A), lending and borrowing (finance), turning loans into bonds (securitisation), contracts that move financial risk (derivatives), disputes (litigation and arbitration), and regulation.

KEY TERM: SOLICITOR

A lawyer regulated by the Solicitors Regulation Authority (SRA) who advises clients directly. Barristers are mostly advocates in court and are usually instructed by solicitors. A training contract is how you become a solicitor at a firm.

The client is usually a company's in-house legal team. Thomson Reuters' 2026 UK report puts it bluntly: for UK buyers, "legal expertise is now the price of entry, not the point of differentiation". Clients choose firms for commercial judgement and practical guidance [S167] **Confirmed**. The same report says UK buyers are "more cautious about external legal spend than they have been at any point in the last five years" [S167].

How big the market is

TheCityUK puts UK legal services revenue at **£52.3bn in 2024**, up 11%. The top 100 firms took £37bn. The sector employs 364,000 people and ran an £8.9bn trade surplus. The UK is the largest legal market in Europe and second in the world after the US. More than 200 foreign firms from over 40 jurisdictions practise in London [S164] **Confirmed**. The Law Society uses a narrower measure and reports £34bn [S165] **Reported**. If you quote a number, say which one.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"London is one of the two big centres for international legal work, partly because English law is chosen for so many cross-border contracts. That's why a Chicago-founded firm has had a London office for over two decades."

How a law firm makes money

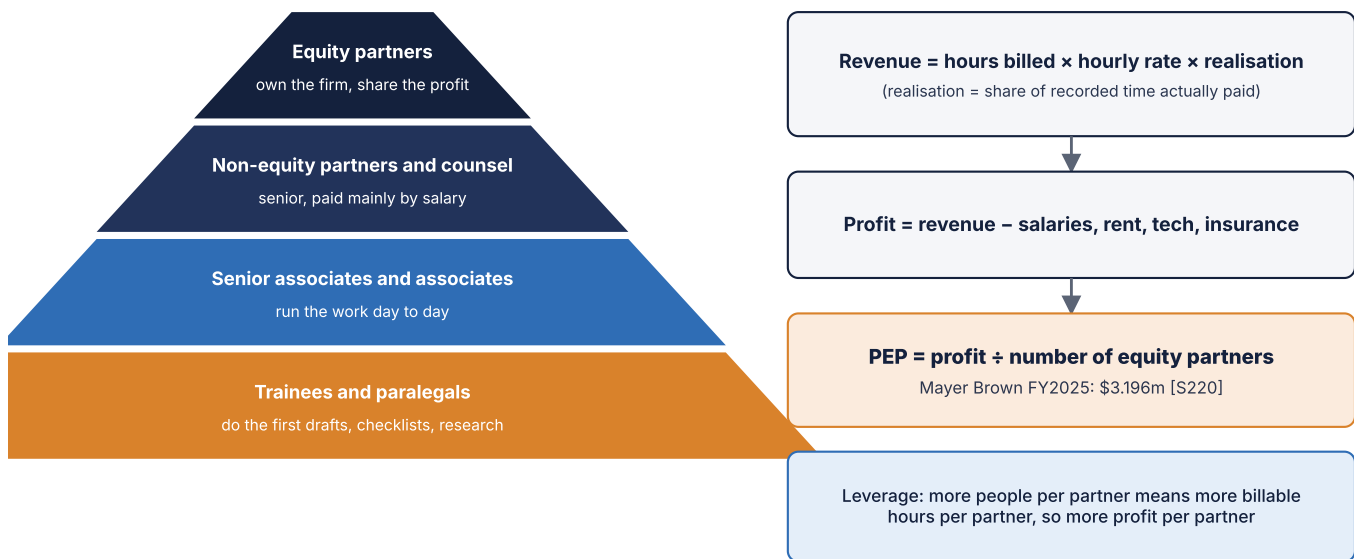


Figure 31. How a law firm makes money: the pyramid and the profit chain. Mayer Brown FY2025 figures from the American Lawyer as reprinted by the firm [S220] **Confirmed**; the formulas are standard definitions [S212] **Reported**.

A firm bills time. Revenue is hours billed multiplied by the hourly rate, less what clients refuse to pay. Profit is what is left after salaries, rent, technology and insurance. The owners, the **equity partners**, share the profit. **Profit per equity partner (PEP)** is the profit divided by the number of equity partners. It is how the market compares firms, but it is not anyone's actual pay [S212].

Leverage is the number of lawyers per partner. One partner supervises several associates and trainees, so the firm bills many more hours than the partner could alone. This is why AI matters: it attacks the hours at the bottom of the pyramid.

KEY TERMS

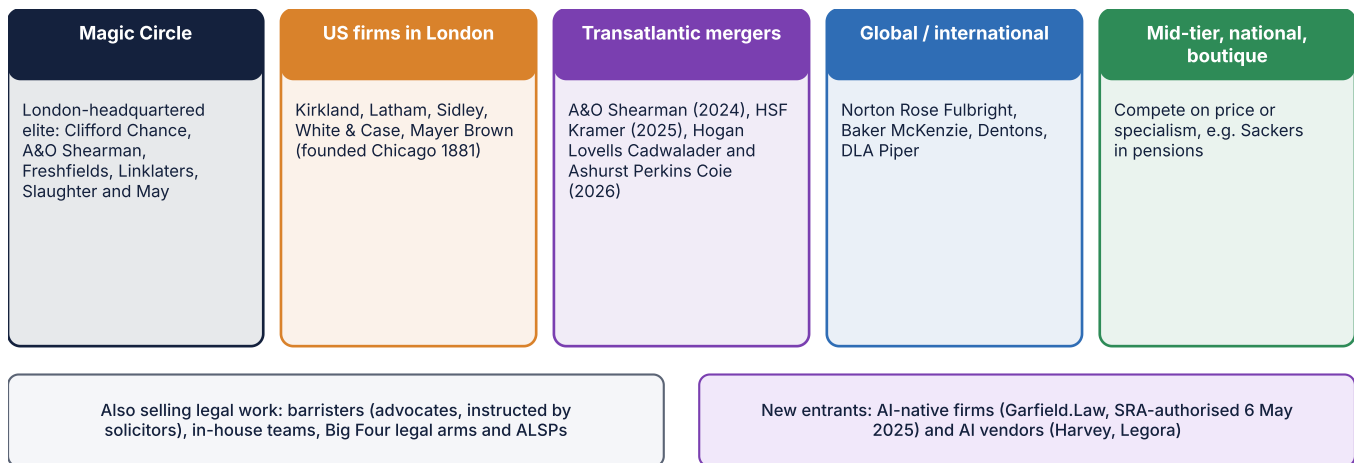
Billable hour: time recorded against a client matter. **Utilisation:** share of available time that is billed. **Realisation:** share of recorded time that is actually paid. **Lockstep:** partners paid by seniority. **Eat what you kill:** partners paid by what they bring in. **Non-equity partner:** partner title, mainly salaried [S212][S213].

Mayer Brown's 2025 numbers show the pyramid at work: revenue \$2.17bn, net income \$762.5m, PEP \$3.196m, revenue per lawyer \$1.25m. It billed fewer hours (about 2.8m against 2.91m) and fewer clients, but raised rates by more than 10% [S220] **Confirmed**.

SOURCE UNCERTAIN

No public source read for this pack describes how Mayer Brown splits profit between its partners (lockstep, merit or a mix). Do not claim either.

The kinds of firm, and where Mayer Brown fits



Mayer Brown sits in the US-firm column, but its London office comes from a UK firm (Rowe & Maw, 2002) and its NQ pay matches the Magic Circle.

Figure 32. Who sells commercial legal services in London. Categories are industry convention [Inferred]; examples and dates from [S164][S168][S159][S240] **Reported**.

The Magic Circle are the five London-headquartered elite firms. Clifford Chance's revenue rose 9% to £2.6bn in the year to April 2026, and Linklaters' rose to £2.5bn [S168]. **US firms in London** have grown faster: among London's top 50, US firms grew revenue 14.7% against 7.1% for UK firms, and 14 of the 18 London firms with revenue per lawyer above £1m are American [S168] **Reported**. **Transatlantic mergers** join a UK and a US firm (Part 7, story 8). **Global firms** such as Norton Rose Fulbright and Baker McKenzie have very large office networks. **Mid-tier and boutique firms** compete on price or a speciality.

Mayer Brown is a US firm, founded in Chicago in 1881, whose London office came from merging with the UK firm Rowe & Maw in 2002 [S138]. It pays London trainees and NQs at Magic Circle level, not at the top US level (below).

The forces changing the industry now

Force	What it does to law firms	What it means at Mayer Brown
Generative AI	→ Fewer junior hours on first drafts and review; clients expect firms to use it [S167]	→ GenAI curriculum for ~1,800 lawyers, Harvey and Copilot [S230]
Transatlantic mergers	→ Bigger platforms; rivals gain scale [S240]	→ Grows by lateral teams, not merger [S220]
US firms' London growth	→ US firms grew London revenue 14.7% vs 7.1% for UK firms [S168]	→ London revenue up 20.5% in 2025 [S222]
Pay war	→ NQ pay £140k-£189k; costs rise [S120]	→ £150k NQ, Magic Circle level [S234]
Private credit boom	→ Lending moves from banks to funds; regulators watch [S208]	→ Private credit cited as a London growth driver [S220]
Bank capital rules	→ Basel 3.1 from 1 Jan 2027 [S190]	→ Risk transfer and securitisation work [S148]
Pensions endgame	→ Record buy-ins; Pension Schemes Act 2026 [S200][S201]	→ Insurer-side buy-in work [S223]
Clients buy judgement	→ "Expertise is the price of entry" [S167]	→ "Go deeper with fewer clients" [S220]

Figure 33. The industry shift map: eight forces, what they do to law firms, and Mayer Brown's position on each. Each cell is sourced; the links between columns are the author's reasoning [Inferred].

1. Generative AI

On 6 May 2025 the SRA authorised **Garfield.Law**, the first law firm in England and Wales to deliver regulated services through AI. It helps recover small unpaid debts; named solicitors remain accountable. SRA chief executive Paul Philip called it "a landmark moment" [S159] **Confirmed**. Legal AI vendors have raised money at high valuations: Harvey at \$11bn and Legora at \$5.55bn, both reported in March 2026 [S180][S181] **Reported**. Clients are adopting faster than firms: 53% of UK corporate legal respondents report organisation-wide AI use, against about 35% of law firm respondents [S167]. Mayer Brown's own response is a mandatory GenAI curriculum (Part 7, story 5).

2. The pay war

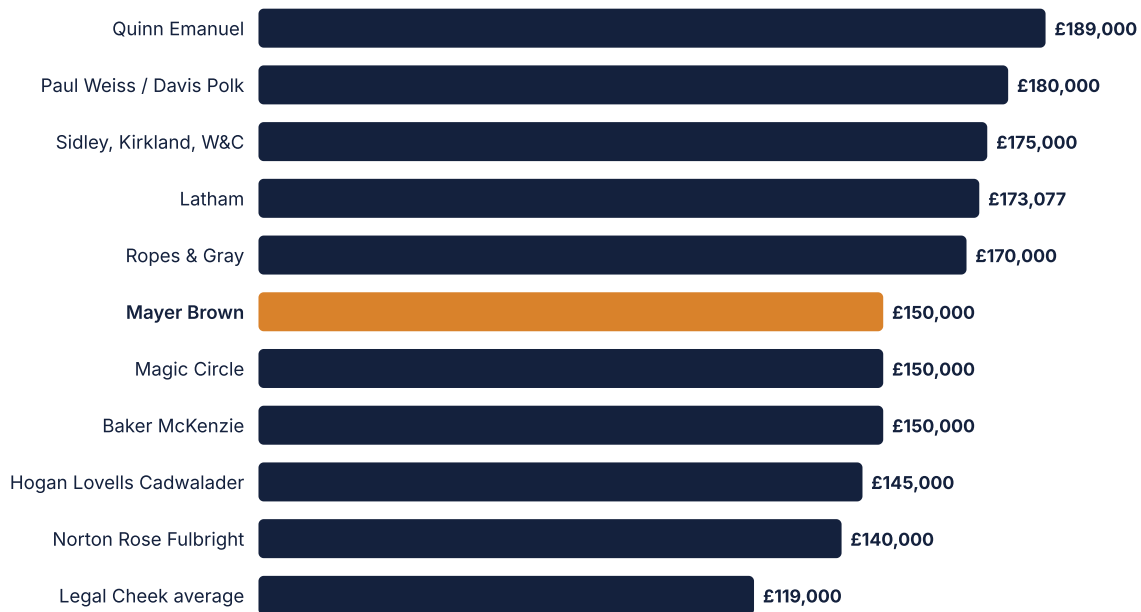


Figure 34. London newly qualified (NQ) solicitor salaries, latest reported, mid to late 2026. **Sources:** Legal Cheek NQ table, Sep 2026 [S120]; Legal Cheek 21 Jul 2026 [S235]; Paul Weiss/Davis Polk/Ropes figures [S168][S171] **Reported**. Pay changes often; re-check before quoting.

Newly qualified (NQ) pay in the City now runs from about £140k to £189k at the firms in this chart. The Magic Circle pays £150k; Mayer Brown moved to £150k in July 2025 [S234]. Legal Cheek's September 2026 table puts the average across the firms it tracks at about £119,000 [S120] **Reported**.

3. Consolidation

A&O Shearman went live on 1 May 2024 with about 4,000 lawyers [S174]; Herbert Smith Freehills Kramer on about 1 June 2025 [S175]; McDermott Will & Schulte on 1 August 2025 [S176]; Hogan Lovells Cadwalader on 1 July 2026 [S240]; Ashurst Perkins Coie around mid-2026 [S178][S239] **Reported**. The logic: bigger platforms, US reach for UK firms, and more cross-selling.

4. Outside capital

Since the Legal Services Act 2007, non-lawyers can own UK law firms through "alternative business structures" (ABSs); 13% of firms in England and Wales are ABSs [S164]. In 2025, 19 of 62 UK law firm M&A deals (31%) involved private equity, mostly at the consumer and mid-market end [S166] **Reported**. In the US, investors use "management services organisation" structures because most US states bar non-lawyers from sharing legal fees; Arizona abolished that rule from 1 January 2021 [S186][S188].

5. Clients buying judgement, not hours

Thomson Reuters finds UK buyers value commercial judgement and practical guidance, and want AI to improve quality before it cuts cost [S167]. Commentators expect hybrid fees (caps, blended rates, portfolio pricing) rather than the end of the billable hour [S185] **Reported**.

Where the industry goes in three to five years: competing views

View	Argument	What it means for a 2029 trainee
Radical disruption (Richard Susskind, Sep 2026)	AI will be "reliable for most practical purposes" by the early 2030s; human judgement will not protect lawyers; elite firms use AI "as a way of boosting their profits under the old pyramidal structure" [S183].	Fewer trainee hours on routine work; firms that redesign workflows win.
Client-led, gradual change (Thomson Reuters Institute, May 2026)	Demand steady, spend cautious; clients move faster than firms on AI and expect them to use it; value shifts to commercial judgement [S167].	The same pyramid, but juniors judged more on judgement and client understanding.
Scale wins (market structure)	Transatlantic mergers and the US-firm revenue gap in London point to an elite tier of very large firms pulling away [S168][S240].	More pressure on mid-sized independent firms like Mayer Brown to grow or merge.

View	Argument	What it means for a 2029 trainee
Sceptical counterweight (Remus and Levy, 2016)	"Predictions of imminent and widespread displacement of lawyers are premature" because advising and unstructured work resist automation [S184]. Pre-dates GenAI.	Training still matters; the apprenticeship model survives.
Pyramid to diamond (commentary, 2026)	AI shrinks the bottom of the pyramid; the shape becomes a diamond with more mid-level lawyers [S185] Reported .	Smaller trainee intakes, faster responsibility.

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

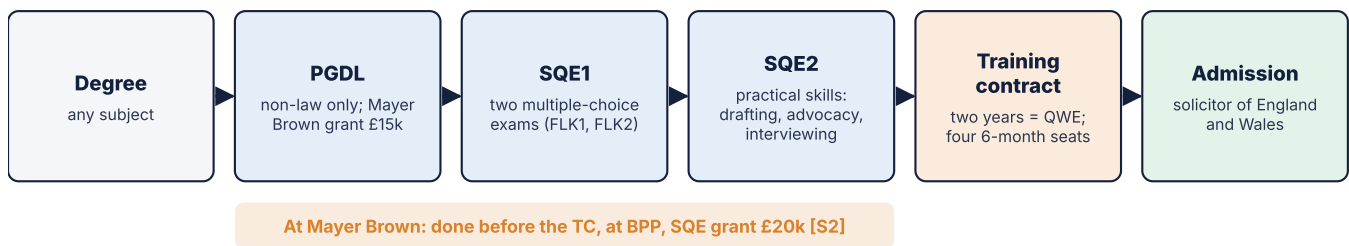
Pick one view and defend it with one fact. A defensible middle: "I think AI changes what trainees do faster than how many trainees firms hire, because firms still need to grow future partners. Mayer Brown's choice to make human review of every AI output mandatory suggests it sees the same thing." [S230]

PART 6

The role's own industry and its regulation

Two layers. First, the rules for becoming and being a solicitor, which bind you from your first day. Second, the regulation that creates the work in Mayer Brown London's core practices. Dates and instrument names are exact; this is where precision earns most.

Layer 1: how you become a solicitor



Key dates: SQE introduced 1 Sep 2021 [S152]. LPC-route candidates must apply for admission by 31 Dec 2032 [S150].

July 2026 SQE1 pass rate: 42% overall, 47% first time [S155]. 2026/27 fees: SQE1 £2,006, SQE2 £3,086 [S158].

QWE: two years full-time equivalent, confirmed by a solicitor [S151]. Character and suitability checks also apply.

Figure 35. How you qualify as a solicitor in England and Wales today, and where Mayer Brown fits in. **Confirmed** for SRA dates [S150][S151][S152]; firm funding from the firm's training contract page [S2]; pass rate and fees **Reported** [S155][S158].

Since **1 September 2021**, the route to qualifying as a solicitor in England and Wales is the **Solicitors Qualifying Examination (SQE)** [S152] **Confirmed**. It has four parts: a degree or equivalent; SQE1, two multiple-choice exams on "functioning legal knowledge" (FLK1 and FLK2); SQE2, practical skills such as drafting, interviewing and advocacy; and two years of **qualifying work experience (QWE)**, confirmed by a solicitor [S151]. You must also pass character and suitability checks. People who started on the old Legal Practice Course (LPC) route before September 2021 have "until 31 December 2032 to apply for admission" [S150] **Confirmed**.

A "training contract" is now a firm's two-year programme that also counts as QWE. Mayer Brown's future trainees take SQE1 and SQE2 with BPP University before starting; non-law graduates do the Postgraduate Diploma in Law (PGDL) first. The firm gives a £20,000 grant for the SQE year and £15,000 for the PGDL, and trainees can ask for an extra £5,000 interest-free loan [S2] **Confirmed**.

The exams are hard. In July 2026, 42% of the 6,315 candidates who sat both parts of SQE1 passed; first-time takers did better at 47% [S155]. In January 2026 the pass rate was 53%, with large gaps between ethnic groups (White 67%, Asian 47%, Black 38%) [S156] **Reported**. From September 2026 the fees are £2,006 for SQE1 and £3,086 for SQE2 [S158].

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"I know the SQE pass rate fell to 42% in July. I'd treat the firm's preparation year like a job, because failing would delay the training contract for everyone, not just me."

The rules you live by from day one

The SRA's **Standards and Regulations** replaced the old SRA Handbook on 25 November 2019 [S154]. Two documents matter most:

- **The SRA Principles** (current version in force from 11 April 2025). You act in a way that upholds the rule of law and public trust, with independence, honesty and integrity, encouraging equality, diversity and inclusion, and in the best interests of each client. Where Principles conflict, those protecting the wider public interest "take precedence over an individual client's interests" [S341] **Confirmed**.

- **The Code of Conduct for Solicitors.** Paragraph 1.4: "You do not mislead or attempt to mislead your clients, the court or others". 6.2: no acting where there is a conflict of interest. 6.3: "You keep the affairs of current and former clients confidential unless disclosure is required or permitted". 7.11: you are honest and open with clients if things go wrong [S342][S12] **Confirmed**.

Outside the SRA rules, the criminal law also applies to you. Insider dealing is a crime under Part V of the Criminal Justice Act 1993, and UK MAR prohibits passing on inside information [S343][S344]. Finance trainees regularly hold price-sensitive information about listed companies. That is why deals have codenames, and why you never discuss work on the train.

WHY THE SRA IS CHANGING THINGS

After the Axiom Ince collapse in October 2023, when about £60m of client money went missing, the Legal Services Board found the SRA had not acted adequately. Since then the SRA has consulted on accountants' reports (Dec 2025 to Feb 2026) and on firms notifying it before mergers or before starting to hold client money (summer 2026)

[S161][S247] **Reported**.

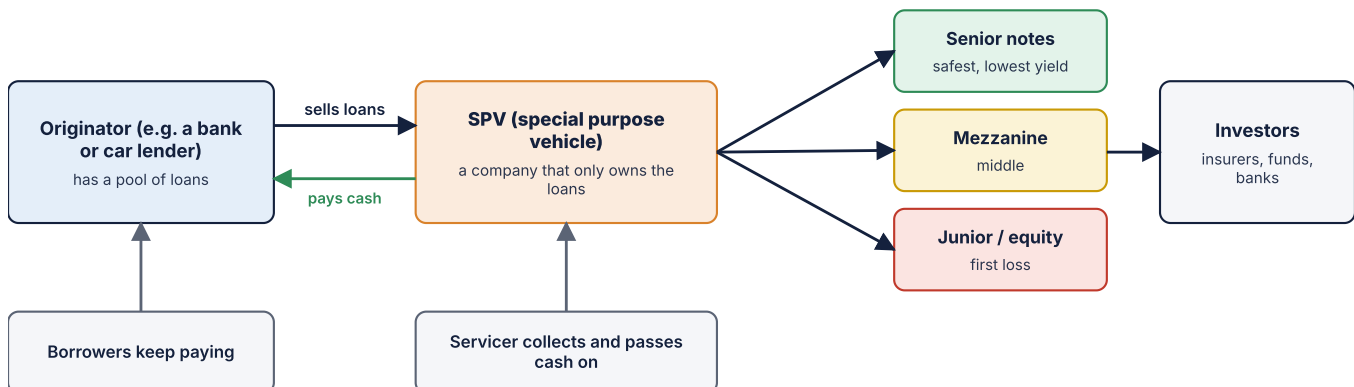
The regulation timeline

- 25 Nov 2019 ● SRA Standards and Regulations replace the SRA Handbook [S154]
- 1 Sep 2021 ● SQE introduced; first SQE1 sat Nov 2021 [S152]
- 26 Oct 2023 ● Economic Crime and Corporate Transparency Act 2023: Royal Assent [S205]
- 29 Jan 2024 ● Securitisation Regulations 2024 (SI 2024/102) made [S192]
- Jul 2024 ● Virgin Media v NTL [2024] EWCA Civ 843: pension amendments void without actuarial confirmation [S214]
- 30 Sep 2024 ● UK EMIR Refit reporting live; final synthetic USD LIBOR published, LIBOR ends [S196][S197]
- 1 Nov 2024 ● New UK securitisation regime in force [S192][S193]
- 6 May 2025 ● SRA authorises Garfield.Law, first AI-driven law firm [S159]
- 1 Sep 2025 ● Failure to prevent fraud offence in force [S203]
- 4 Dec 2025 ● Bank of England launches private markets stress exercise [S208]
- 20 Jan 2026 ● PRA PS1/26: Basel 3.1 final rules [S190]
- 17 Feb 2026 ● FCA CP26/6 and PRA CP2/26: securitisation reform consultation (closed 18 May) [S194]
- 29 Apr 2026 ● Pension Schemes Act 2026: Royal Assent; Virgin Media fix in force [S200]
- H2 2026 ● FCA final securitisation rules expected (not confirmed published by 8 Oct) [S194]
- 1 Jan 2027 ● Basel 3.1 takes effect [S190]
- Q2 2027 ● PRA securitisation changes anticipated [S194]
- 1 Jan 2028 ● Market risk internal models (FRTB-IMA) take effect [S190]
- 2028 ● Permanent DB superfund regime expected [S200]
- 31 Dec 2032 ● Last date to apply for admission via the LPC route [S150]

Figure 36. The regulation timeline for a trainee at Mayer Brown London: how solicitors qualify, and the rules shaping the firm's core finance and pensions work. Highlighted rows matter most. **Confirmed** where the source is primary; see Part 15.

Layer 2: the rules that create Mayer Brown London's work

Securitisation and structured finance



What the lawyers do: check the sale is a true sale (the loans are safe if the originator goes bust), draft the transaction documents, apply the UK Securitisation Regulations 2024 (5% risk retention, due diligence, transparency), get ratings and listing right. Regulators consulted on loosening these rules on 17 Feb 2026 [S194].

Figure 37. How a securitisation works, from zero. Mechanics are standard market structure [Inferred]; UK rules from SI 2024/102 [S192] and the 2026 reform consultation as summarised by Mayer Brown [S194] **Confirmed**.

The UK left the EU's securitisation rules behind in stages. The **Securitisation Regulations 2024 (SI 2024/102)** were made on 29 January 2024 under powers in the Financial Services and Markets Act 2023 [S192] **Confirmed**. The new regime, made up of that statutory instrument plus FCA and PRA rules, took effect on **1 November 2024** [S193] **Reported**.

Fifteen months later the regulators proposed loosening it. On **17 February 2026** the FCA (CP26/6) and the PRA (CP2/26) consulted on principles-based investor due diligence, dropping prescribed reporting templates for most asset classes, a new "L-shaped" option for the 5% risk retention, and two exemptions from the ban on resecuritisation. Consultation closed on 18 May 2026. FCA final rules were expected in the second half of 2026, with PRA changes around the second quarter of 2027 [S194][S195] **Confirmed**. Mayer Brown's own note says the regulators concluded "the current rules have led to excessive complexity and high compliance costs" [S194].

KEY TERMS

Risk retention: the originator must keep at least 5% of the risk, so it has "skin in the game". **STS:** "simple, transparent and standardised" securitisations that get lighter capital treatment. **SRT:** "significant risk transfer", where a bank uses a securitisation to move credit risk and free up capital. **CLO:** a securitisation of leveraged loans.

SOURCE UNCERTAIN

Whether the FCA had published its final securitisation rules by 8 October 2026 could not be confirmed. Check the FCA's policy statements page before 2 November.

Bank capital: Basel 3.1

The PRA's policy statement **PS1/26** (20 January 2026) confirms that the Basel 3.1 rules "will take effect on Friday 1 January 2027", with internal models for market risk following on 1 January 2028 [S190] **Confirmed**. The date had already slipped twice; the January 2025 delay cited uncertainty over US implementation [S191].

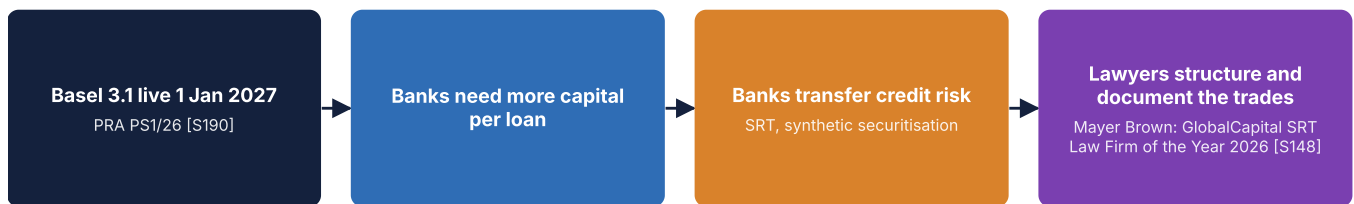


Figure 38. From a bank capital rule to legal work: why Basel 3.1 matters to Mayer Brown. Chain of reasoning is the author's [Inferred]; dates and award from [S190][S148].

Derivatives

A derivative is a contract whose value depends on something else, such as an interest rate. Banks and companies use them to hedge risk, usually on standard ISDA documents. Two recent milestones: UK EMIR Refit reporting went live on 30 September 2024, and LIBOR, the old benchmark interest rate, ended the same day with the final synthetic US dollar settings [S196][S197] **Reported**. Mayer Brown London is now in the Legal 500's top tier for derivatives and structured products [S139].

Pensions

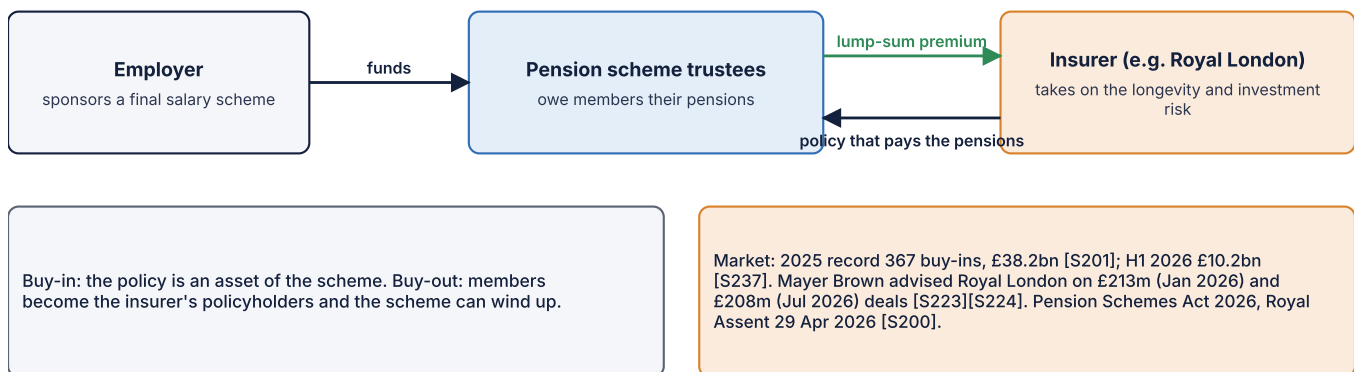


Figure 39. How a pension buy-in works, and why it is London work for Mayer Brown. Market figures from LCP [S201] and Hymans Robertson via Pensions Age [S237] **Confirmed**; Mayer Brown deals from firm releases.

In *Virgin Media v NTL Pension Trustees II* [2024] EWCA Civ 843, the Court of Appeal held that some changes to contracted-out pension benefits made between 1997 and 2016 were void because the required actuarial confirmation was missing [S214]. It threatened the validity of many schemes' past amendments. The **Pension Schemes Act 2026** received Royal Assent on **29 April 2026**. The Virgin Media fix took effect immediately, allowing retrospective actuarial confirmation unless the point was already in court proceedings by 5 June 2025 [S200] **Confirmed**. The Act also creates a power to release scheme surplus and a permanent regime for "superfunds" (expected 2028) [S199][S200].

Economic crime

The Economic Crime and Corporate Transparency Act 2023 created a "failure to prevent fraud" offence, in force from **1 September 2025**. It applies to large organisations (two of: over 250 staff, over £36m turnover, over £18m assets), whose only defence is reasonable fraud prevention procedures [S203][S204] **Confirmed**.

Private credit

Private credit is lending by funds rather than banks. The Bank of England says global private equity and private credit grew from about \$3tn to about \$11tn in a decade, and launched a system-wide stress exercise on private markets on 4 December 2025, with a final report due in early 2027 [S208] **Confirmed**. The FCA reviewed private market valuations in March 2025 [S210]. Mayer Brown says private credit drove part of London's 2025 growth [S220].

Who competes for this work

In London securitisation and structured finance, the Legal 500 top tier is Clifford Chance, Latham, Linklaters, Sidley and A&O Shearman; Mayer Brown is in tier 2 with Hogan Lovells Cadwalader, White & Case, Norton Rose Fulbright and others

[S141] **Confirmed**. In derivatives Mayer Brown is top tier alongside Ashurst Perkins Coie, Clifford Chance, Linklaters and A&O Shearman [S142]. In pensions the top tier is mostly UK firms and the specialist Sackers; Mayer Brown is tier 2 [S145]. New competition also comes from AI vendors and AI-native firms [S159].

What internal and external clients value today

- **Judgement over raw knowledge.** More than a third of UK buyers cite business savviness [S167].
- **AI used for quality first.** Buyers want better work before cheaper work [S167].
- **Service.** Mayer Brown is reported as a newcomer to the BTI Client Service 30 in 2026 [S189] **Reported, position unverified**.
- **Inside the firm,** the "clients" of a trainee are the associates and partners who staff them. They value accuracy, honest status updates and no surprises (Part 11).

PART 7

What is happening right now

Twelve stories from roughly April to October 2026, each explained from zero, linked to Mayer Brown and to a trainee, with one question you could actually ask on 2 November. Re-check the fast-moving ones (rates, energy, mergers) in the week before the event.

The twelve stories on one page

Mayer Brown itself	Legal sector	Markets
1 New London MP, 1 Oct 2026	7 NQ pay: £150k benchmark	10 Securitisation reform; private credit
2 FY2025: \$2.17bn, PEP \$3.196m	8 Transatlantic mergers	11 Bank Rate 3.75%, 6-3
3 Lateral team hires	9 SQE1 pass rate 42%	12 Basel 3.1; London IPOs
4 Royal London buy-ins	The common thread Finance-led growth (stories 2, 3, 10, 12), a firm choosing focus over merger (2, 8), and AI changing junior work (5, 9). Rates and energy (11) touch every practice. Re-check 7, 8, 10, 11 in the week before 2 Nov.	
5 GenAI curriculum		
6 Nigeria ports; AI loan		

Figure 40. Twelve stories, April to October 2026, grouped. Details and sources on the cards that follow [S220]-[S244].

HOW TO READ THE CONFIDENCE TAGS HERE

Most Mayer Brown deal facts come from the firm's own press releases. They are reliable on who did what, but they are marketing. Where independent coverage exists it is cited; where it does not, the story is tagged **Confirmed** only for the fact that the firm says it, not for any claim of being "landmark" or "leading".

A. Mayer Brown itself

1 · New London managing partner: Chris Harvey, from 1 October 2026

Mayer Brown, 28 Sep 2026 [S222]

What happened. Chris Harvey, a real estate partner who joined in 2012 and co-leads the firm's global Real Estate group, became London Managing Partner on 1 October 2026. He succeeds Dominic Griffiths, a structured finance partner who ran London from 2022 and now joins the firm's global Management Committee. The firm says London had "record revenue growth of 20.5%" in 2025 and marked 130 years in the City [S222] **Confirmed (firm source)**.

Why it matters to the firm. The office head moves from finance to real estate as the firm hires real estate and private equity partners in London (story 3). Chair Jon Van Gorp: "London is central to our international platform and to the strategic growth priorities" [S222].

Why it matters to you. The managing partner shapes intake, seat options and investment. He took office one month before the masterclass; he may even speak.

Question to ask. "With a real estate partner now leading London after a finance-led period of record growth, how do you see the balance between finance and real estate and private capital developing?"

2 · FY2025 results: about \$2.17bn revenue, profit per equity partner \$3.196m

American Lawyer via Mayer Brown, 25 Mar 2026 [S220]

What happened. Revenue rose nearly 10% to \$2.17bn; profit per equity partner (PEP) rose 14.5% to \$3.196m; revenue per lawyer rose 11.6% to \$1.25m. Billable hours fell (about 2.8m from 2.91m) and clients billed fell from 7,600 to 6,316, while billing rates rose by more than 10%. London, with about 264 lawyers, grew revenue roughly 20%, led by structured finance and private credit [S220]

Confirmed .

Plain English. Revenue is total fees. PEP is profit divided among the owning partners; the market uses it to compare firms. Higher revenue from fewer hours and fewer clients means higher prices and bigger relationships. Van Gorp called it "a concerted effort by us to go deeper with fewer clients" [S220].

Why it matters to you. Fewer, bigger, institutional clients means complex work and high expectations from day one.

Question to ask. "The firm billed fewer clients in 2025 but grew revenue. How does London decide which relationships to deepen, and does that change what juniors work on?"

3 · Lateral team hires: leveraged finance and high yield from Baker McKenzie

Mayer Brown, 1 Sep 2026 [S226]

What happened. Three partners (Rob Mathews, David Becker, Ben Bierwirth) joined London Banking & Finance from Baker McKenzie, covering high yield bonds, term loan B and leveraged finance, with restructuring and liability management experience [S226] **Confirmed .** Earlier in 2026: a leveraged finance partner from Kirkland & Ellis (April) [S228], an export finance partner from Baker McKenzie (August) [S227], and two real estate and private equity partners (February) [S229] **Reported .**

Plain English. Leveraged finance is lending to companies that already carry a lot of debt, often to fund private equity buyouts. High yield bonds are the bond-market version, usually under New York law. A "liability management exercise" is refinancing or reshaping debt without going to court.

Why it matters. It is the firm's chosen way to grow: hire teams, don't merge (story 8).

Question to ask. "How do the new leveraged finance hires work with the private credit and restructuring teams?"

4 · Pension risk transfer: Royal London buy-ins in a £10.2bn half-Mayer Brown, 30 Jul 2026 [S223]; Pensions Age, 22 Sep 2026 [S237]

What happened. Mayer Brown advised insurer Royal London on a £208m bulk purchase annuity with the Hickson UK Group Pension Scheme (1,250+ members), after a £213m Royal London deal in January [S223][S224] **Confirmed (firm source) .** Hymans Robertson put first-half 2026 UK risk transfer volumes at £10.2bn across 135+ deals, against £9.8bn and 161 deals a year earlier [S237] **Confirmed .**

Plain English. A company with a final salary pension scheme pays an insurer a lump sum to take over paying the pensions. In a "buy-in" the policy sits inside the scheme; in a "buy-out" members become the insurer's policyholders. Higher gilt yields since 2022 made schemes better funded, so many can now afford to insure.

Why it matters. Van Gorp calls insurance "always been a really strong brand for us" [S220]. London's pensions and insurance teams together are a distinctive Mayer Brown offer (Part 4).

Question to ask. "With deal counts down but values up, is buy-in documentation becoming standardised, and where does that leave the lawyer?"

5 · A mandatory GenAI curriculum for about 1,800 lawyers

Mayer Brown, 14 Apr 2026 [S230]

What happened. A compulsory 2026 programme for lawyers and business services staff covering responsible use (human review of every output, citation checks, data security), the firm's tools (Harvey and Microsoft Copilot are named), practice scenarios, partner training and "AI Champions". Van Gorp: "Our approach is focused on amplifying lawyer capabilities and judgement, not replacing them" [S230] **Confirmed .**

Why it matters. Document-heavy work (loan documents, securitisation documents, diligence) is where AI helps most. Fewer hours at higher rates (story 2) fits that future.

Why it matters to you. Expect AI training from day one and the duty to check everything it produces.

Question to ask. "If AI does more first drafts, how do trainees build the judgement to review them?"

6 · Deals across offices: Nigeria ports (£746m) and an AI infrastructure loan (up to \$3.1bn) Mayer Brown, 25 Mar and 10 Sep 2026 [S225][S231]

What happened. London advised Citibank and UK Export Finance on a £746m UKEF-guaranteed financing for Lagos's Apapa and TinCan Island ports, with a trainee named on the team [S225]. Singapore led a senior loan of up to \$3.1bn for Zankore's AI cloud infrastructure, with a London partner on hedging and Washington and Dubai lawyers on sanctions and export controls [S231]

Confirmed (firm source) .

Plain English. Export credit agencies like UKEF guarantee loans so foreign buyers can buy UK goods. GPUs and data centres are now financed like infrastructure.

Question to ask. "How do lenders handle the risk that GPUs become obsolete before the loan is repaid?"

B. The legal sector

7 · NQ pay: £150k is now the City benchmark, and Mayer Brown is there Legal Cheek, 21 Jul 2026 [S235]; Jul 2025 [S234]

What happened. Baker McKenzie moved its newly qualified (NQ) salary to £150k in July 2026, matching the Magic Circle and Macfarlanes; Ashurst Perkins Coie and Norton Rose Fulbright sat at £140k; Quinn Emanuel led at £189k [S235] **Confirmed** . Mayer Brown moved London NQ pay from £135k to £150k from 1 July 2025 [S234] **Reported** .

Why it matters. Mayer Brown pays at Magic Circle level, below the top US payers. That is a positioning choice (Part 4).

DON'T SAY THIS

Never give pay as a reason for applying. If asked, talk about it as market positioning.

8 · The transatlantic merger wave, including a direct rival Non-Billable, 1 Jul 2026 [S240]; Above the Law, 14 Apr 2026 [S239]

What happened. Hogan Lovells and Cadwalader launched as Hogan Lovells Cadwalader on 1 July 2026 with about 3,200 lawyers; reported combined revenue varies between about \$3.6bn and \$3.9bn [S240] **Confirmed launch** **Reported revenue** . Ashurst and Perkins Coie partners approved a merger to form Ashurst Perkins Coie (about 3,000 lawyers) [S239]. Winston & Strawn and Taylor Wessing went live as Winston Taylor on about 1 June 2026 [S241] **Reported** . These follow A&O Shearman (2024) and Herbert Smith Freehills Kramer (2025).

Why it matters. Cadwalader is one of Mayer Brown's closest rivals in US and transatlantic structured finance. Mayer Brown's chair says the firm is "pretty focused on executing our strategy" of laterals and organic growth [S220].

Question to ask. "Several rivals chose transatlantic mergers for scale, including Cadwalader. What does a firm of Mayer Brown's size gain by staying independent?"

9 · SQE1 pass rate falls to 42% Legal Cheek, 6 Oct 2026 [S238]

What happened. 42% of 6,315 candidates passed SQE1 in July 2026, down from 53% in January; first-time takers 47% [S238] **Confirmed** . Separately, the SRA has proposed that firms notify it before merging [S247] **Reported** .

Why it matters to you. Firms sponsor SQE preparation. The pass rate makes the quality of that support a fair question.

Question to ask. "How does the firm support future trainees through the SQE?"

C. Markets that drive Mayer Brown's work

10 · UK securitisation rules are being loosened, while the Bank of England worries about private credit

Mayer Brown, 24 Feb 2026 [S232]; BoE, Jul 2026 [S243]

What happened. On 17 February 2026 the FCA and PRA consulted on loosening UK securitisation rules: more proportionate investor due diligence, a new "L-shaped" option for the 5% risk retention, dropping prescribed reporting templates for most asset classes. Consultations closed 18 May 2026; FCA final rules were expected in the second half of 2026 and PRA implementation around the second quarter of 2027, according to Mayer Brown's own note, co-written by Dominic Griffiths [S232] **Confirmed**. The Bank of England's Financial Policy Committee named private credit as a key stability risk [S243] **Reported**.

Plain English. Securitisation pools loans and sells bonds backed by them. "Risk retention" makes the originator keep 5% of the risk. Private credit is lending by funds rather than banks.

SOURCE UNCERTAIN

Whether the FCA has published final securitisation rules by 8 October 2026 was not confirmed. Check fca.org.uk before the event.

Question to ask. "Is there a tension between loosening securitisation rules for growth and the Bank's warnings on private credit?"

11 · Bank Rate held at 3.75% on a 6-3 vote; inflation heading towards 4%

Bank of England, 17 Sep 2026 [S236]

What happened. Three members voted to raise rates to 4%. CPI inflation was 3.1% in August and is forecast at about 3¾% in Q4 2026 and slightly above 4% in Q1 2027. The Bank links higher energy prices to "Protracted conflict in the Middle East". The next decision is due on 5 November 2026, three days after the masterclass [S236] **Confirmed**.

Why it matters. Rates touch almost every practice: higher for longer means more stress for leveraged borrowers (restructuring work), better pension scheme funding (more buy-ins), slower IPOs and pressure on property values.

Question to ask. "If the Bank hikes in November, which London practices feel it first?"

12 · Basel 3.1 arrives on 1 January 2027; London listings recover from a low base

[S242] [S244]

What happened. The PRA confirmed that Basel 3.1 bank capital rules take effect on 1 January 2027, with internal models for market risk deferred to 1 January 2028 [S242] **Reported**. EY counted seven London listings raising £577m in the first half of 2026, up 215% on a weak 2025 [S244] **Reported**.

Why it matters. Higher capital requirements push banks to transfer credit risk to investors through "significant risk transfer" deals and synthetic securitisations, which is structured finance work. Mayer Brown's London capital markets work is mostly debt, so the IPO story matters indirectly.

Question to ask. "Will Basel 3.1 create a lasting pipeline of risk transfer deals for banks in London?"

HANDLE WITH CARE: US POLITICS

In 2025 the US administration issued executive orders against several US law firms, and others agreed pro bono deals [S254]. Bloomberg Law reported in July 2025 that Mayer Brown was not targeted and did not do a deal; Chair Jon Van Gorp said the firm was "being very careful about picking our spots" [S86] **Reported**. Do not raise it. If asked, describe the industry picture neutrally.

Reading list: what to follow, and why

Source	Cost	Good for
mayerbrown.com news and insights	Free	Deals, hires, practice notes. Check weekly before 2 November.
Mayer Brown Futures (graduate site)	Free	Training contract dates, seats, events
Legal Cheek; RollOnFriday	Free	Pay, retention, SQE, trainee-level news
Non-Billable; Global Legal Post; Legal Futures	Free	Law firm business: mergers, hires, AI, regulation, PE investment
The Lawyer; Legal Business; The American Lawyer	Paid	Firm finances and strategy interviews (Mayer Brown reprints some free)
Bank of England; FCA; PRA	Free	Rates, financial stability, securitisation and Basel 3.1

Source	Cost	Good for
Pensions Age; Hymans Robertson, LCP and Aon reports	Free	Pension risk transfer volumes
Financial Times; Reuters	FT often free through universities; Reuters free	Markets, deals, macro
Chambers Student; Legal 500 Future Lawyers	Free	Trainee reviews and practice strengths

Full list with notes: **Reading_List.md**, delivered alongside this pack.

PART 8

Forming your own view

Eight live arguments about the firm and the industry, each with the case for, the case against, the facts on both sides, and a defensible position you could hold under pressure.

Partners don't mark you on agreeing with them. They mark you on having a view, backing it with a fact, and changing it only when given a better fact. For each debate below, pick a side and practise defending it for 60 seconds.

1. Should Mayer Brown merge to keep up?

FOR

Rivals are combining: Hogan Lovells Cadwalader went live on 1 July 2026 with about 3,200 lawyers [S240]. Mayer Brown is the smallest firm in the peer set by revenue (\$2.17bn) [S220]. Scale funds AI and pay.

AGAINST

Mayer Brown grew revenue about 10% and PEP 14.5% in 2025 without merging [S220]. Mergers bring integration risk, conflicts and culture clashes. Lateral teams target gaps precisely [S84].

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

"I think focus is working for now: London grew 20% in 2025. The test is whether lateral hiring can build private equity strength fast enough. If not, a targeted combination might make sense."

2. "Deeper with fewer clients": smart or risky?

SMART

Higher rates, bigger matters, better margins: net income up 19.2% [S220]. Matches what buyers say they value: judgement, not volume [S167].

RISKY

Concentration: losing one big client hurts more. Fewer small matters may mean fewer chances for juniors to run something end to end [Inferred](#).

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

"It's smart for a firm whose strengths are repeat institutional products. For trainees, it raises the bar: you're more likely on big matters, so the skill is learning fast inside a large team."

3. Will AI shrink the trainee intake?

YES

Susskind: AI "reliable for most practical purposes" by the early 2030s [S183]. First drafts and document review are the work trainees used to learn from.

NO

Firms must grow future partners; clients want quality first [S167]; Mayer Brown requires human review of every output [S230]. Mayer Brown's intake is already small (about 15).

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

"AI changes what trainees do faster than how many are hired. The risk is a training gap: if AI drafts, who learns to draft? I'd want to know how the firm trains judgement."

4. Should UK securitisation rules be loosened?

FOR

Regulators say current rules "have led to excessive complexity and high compliance costs" [S194]; UK investors struggle to buy US CLOs; growth agenda.

AGAINST

2008 showed opaque securitisation can amplify a crisis; the Bank of England says private credit vulnerabilities "persist and in some cases have intensified" [S209].

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

"Loosening due diligence for well-understood assets makes sense; I'd keep risk retention strict, because skin in the game is the lesson of 2008."

5. Is matching the Magic Circle on pay, rather than US firms, a weakness?

WEAKNESS

Sidley, Kirkland and White & Case pay £175k NQ [S120]; talent may go there.

STRENGTH

Lower cost base; hours average 9:26am to 8:20pm [S15]; no billable target for trainees [S16]; 80% retention, above Clifford Chance and A&O Shearman [S121].

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

Hold privately; never argue pay in an interview. If pressed: "It's a positioning choice, and it fits a firm that trains a small cohort."

6. The AI push versus a "C" for legal tech

The firm launched a mandatory curriculum for about 1,800 lawyers in April 2026 [S230]; trainees graded legal tech C in Legal Cheek's 2026-27 survey [S13]. Both can be true: a curriculum is about people; a survey grade may reflect tools trainees use day to day. **Good question:** "How has the curriculum changed what a first-seat trainee does?"

7. Is London still the place for international finance law?

YES

UK legal services £52.3bn and growing; more than 200 foreign firms in London [S164]; English law dominates cross-border contracts; Mayer Brown London +20.5%.

NOT SO FAST

Equity listings still weak despite a first-half 2026 rebound from a low base [S244]; inflation and energy shocks [S236].

8. Bank-side strength versus the private capital push

The firm's top-tier rankings are bank-side and product-led; its hiring is sponsor-side (leveraged finance, PE) [S139][S327]. The opportunity: private credit funds need the same documentation skills banks do. The risk: acting for both lenders and sponsors creates conflicts and competes with Kirkland and Latham on their home ground. **Good question:** "How do the new leveraged finance teams fit with the bank-side practices?"

The master diagram: industry, firm, role

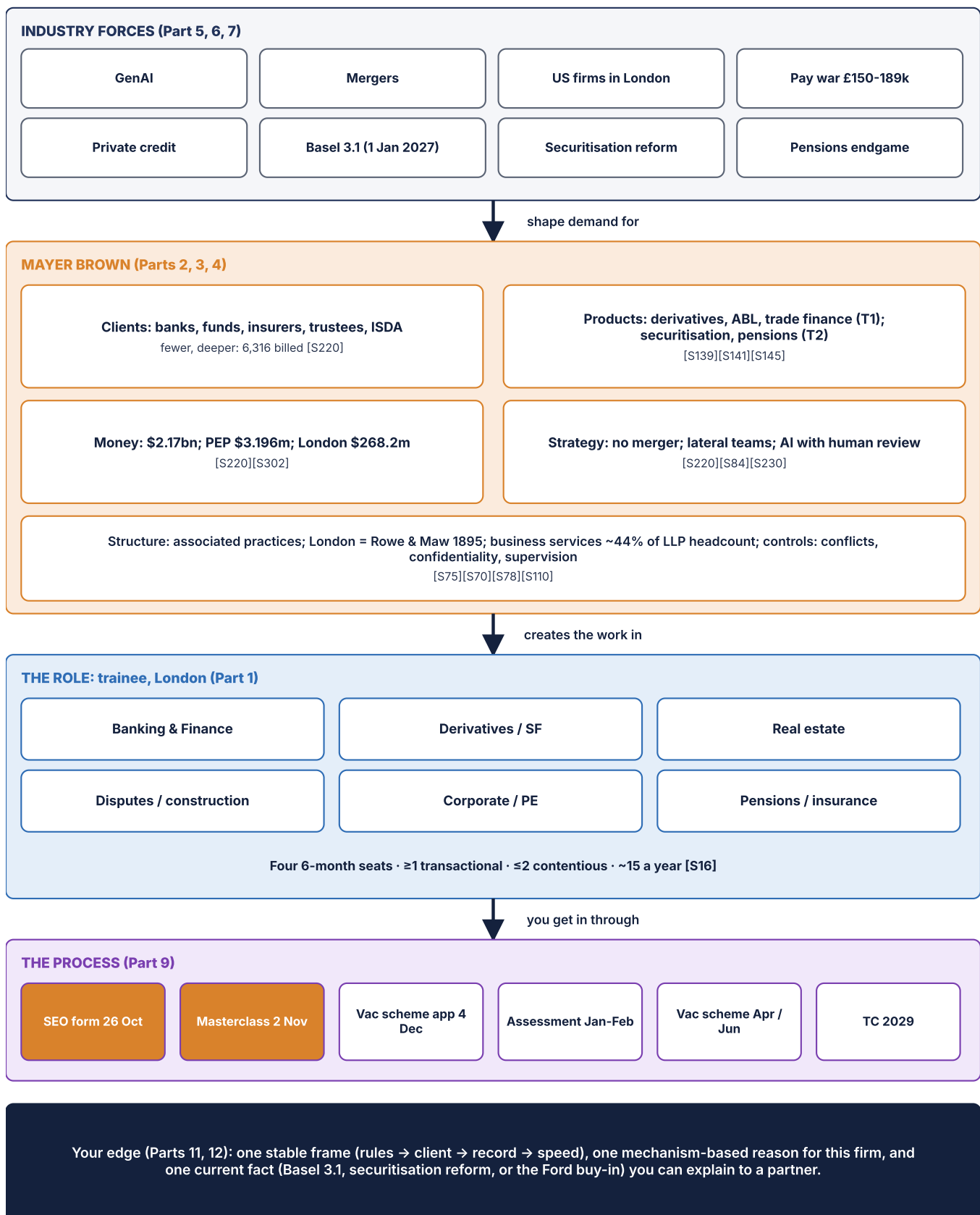


Figure 41. The master diagram: how industry forces create Mayer Brown's work, how that work becomes a trainee's seats, and how you get in. Sources as marked in each box.

PART 9

The interview: process, question bank, questions to ask

What is known about each stage from the SEO form to a training contract offer, a bank of 43 questions with what each really tests, and ten questions only a researcher could ask.

The process, with confidence levels

Stage	What it consists of	When	Confidence
SEO application	SEO's own form. SEO screens on grades (2:1), year and its eligibility rules: UK state school (or means-tested support at a fee-paying school), ethnic minority or low socioeconomic background, graduating 2027 or later [S10][S340].	By 26 Oct 2026, 11:59pm; may close early	Confirmed
Masterclass	Firm overview, trainee panel, practice deep dive, applications overview, networking. 60 places. No assessed element is published [S340].	Mon 2 Nov, 2pm to 6pm	Confirmed agenda; Inferred that networking is informally assessed
Vacation scheme application	Online form: personal details, education, work experience. "Legal experience is not required" [S1]. Exact question wording not public.	Closes 4 Dec 2026	Confirmed
Immersive Assessment	Behavioural (situational judgement), numerical and verbal reasoning, and video questions; "You must meet benchmark scores to progress, and you will receive feedback" [S1]. LawCareers says four video questions on motivation and competencies [S17]. No source names Watson Glaser.	After applying	Confirmed components; Reported detail
Assessment centre	"a written submission, group exercise, fact-finding task and final interview" [S2]. A 2020 forum account: group pitch in threes; one hour to find about 30 errors in an article and summarise it; a fact-find with an assessor; a 50-minute CV-blind interview with two senior associates [S21].	Jan to Feb 2027, London [S1]	Confirmed components; 2020 detail is anecdotal
Vacation scheme	Two weeks; real deal work, skills sessions, social; £650 a week plus £100 travel [S1]. Training contracts "primarily offered to vacation scheme candidates" [S13].	Spring 12-23 Apr; summer 21 Jun-2 Jul 2027 [S13][S18]	Reported dates
Direct TC route	Same assessment day for those who apply directly.	Closes 31 Mar 2027 [S2]	Confirmed

OTHER ROUTES WORTH KNOWING

First Year Insight Event (virtual), 21 April 2027, "exclusively for first-year law and penultimate year non-law students", deadline 31 January 2027 [S3]. Solicitor apprenticeship (six years, one day a week at BPP), deadline about mid-February 2027 [S17][S39]. The firm's Forage "Introduction to Finance" programme takes two to three hours and is recommended on the vacation scheme page [S1][S7]: do it before 2 November.

Your plan from today

By	Action
Now to 26 Oct	Submit the SEO form (early: it may close sooner). Use Part 12's 30-second answer as the spine.
Before 2 Nov	Do the Forage programme. Read Parts 0, 2, 4, 7. Draft the vacation scheme application. Prepare three questions from the table below.
2 Nov	Note names, roles, one thing each speaker said. Ask one question. Two or three conversations at networking.
3 Nov	Thank-you notes naming something specific. Update the application with what you learned.
Before 4 Dec	Submit the vacation scheme application; practise situational judgement and numerical tests; record yourself answering "Why Mayer Brown?" in two minutes.

The question bank

Scaffolds, not scripts. Groups: motivation, firm knowledge, commercial awareness, competency, scenario, case exercises, curveballs. Reported Mayer Brown questions come from a 2020 forum thread [S21] and are marked "Reported question". The same bank is delivered as `Question_Bank.md`.

Motivation

1. Why commercial law?

REALLY TESTING Whether you understand what commercial lawyers actually do, and why you'd choose it over banking or consulting.

STRUCTURE One experience; what it showed you about the work (precision, advising on real money, being trusted with detail); why advising rather than deciding.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN Lawyers sell advice and execution (Part 5).

TRAP "I like problem solving" or "I like reading".

2. Why not the Bar?

REALLY TESTING Whether you understand the solicitor/barrister split.

STRUCTURE Teamwork on a matter from start to finish; long client relationships; transactional work has no Bar equivalent.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN Barristers are mostly advocates instructed by solicitors (Part 5).

TRAP Running down the Bar.

3. Why Mayer Brown?

REALLY TESTING Mechanism, not adjectives.

STRUCTURE Use Part 12: one structural fact, one product, one personal fit.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN Top tier in derivatives, ABL, trade finance [S139]; ~15 trainees [S16]; Ford buy-in [S310].

TRAP "Global firm with a diverse client base" (the event page's own sentence).

4. Why a US firm rather than the Magic Circle?

REALLY TESTING Whether you understand firm types.

STRUCTURE Same pay, smaller cohort, transatlantic platform; but honest that MC firms lead in some areas.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN £150k NQ matches MC [S234]; cohort 15 vs 70-100 [S120].

TRAP Claiming US pay.

5. Why this masterclass?

REALLY TESTING Whether you've read the agenda and the firm.

STRUCTURE Name the agenda item you most want (practice deep dive), the question you'd bring, and the next step (vac scheme by 4 Dec).

FACTS TO WEAVE IN Vac scheme deadline 4 Dec 2026 [S1].

TRAP Treating it as a free day out.

6. Which practice area interests you, and why?

REALLY TESTING Whether your interest is specific and genuine.

STRUCTURE Pick one where the firm is strong; explain the client's problem it solves; show you'd stay open across four seats.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN Derivatives T1, ABL T1, PRT deals [S139][S310].

TRAP Picking M&A (tier 6) as your reason for applying here.

7. What would you do if you didn't get a training contract?

REALLY TESTING Resilience and seriousness.

STRUCTURE Reapply with what you learned; build relevant experience; stay in the profession.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN SQE and QWE routes (Part 6).

TRAP "I'd do banking instead."

Firm knowledge

8. What do you know about Mayer Brown's history?

REALLY TESTING Precision.

STRUCTURE Chicago 1881; Rowe & Maw London 1895; combined 2002; name 2007; JSM 2008 to 2024.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN [S70]

TRAP Saying Brown & Wood.

9. Tell us about a deal the firm has done.

REALLY TESTING Whether you can explain a deal simply and say why it matters.

STRUCTURE What, who, why it mattered, what lawyers did, what it shows about the firm.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN Ford £4.6bn buy-in [S310]; Citi/UKEF Nigeria ports £746m [S225]; StanChart/Apollo CLO [S325].

TRAP Reciting a press release with no 'so what'.

10. How did the firm perform last year?

REALLY TESTING Commercial literacy.

STRUCTURE Revenue \$2.17bn, PEP \$3.196m; fewer hours, higher rates, fewer clients; London +20.5%.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN [S220][S222]

TRAP Confusing PEP with pay.

11. Who leads the London office?

REALLY TESTING Current awareness.

STRUCTURE Chris Harvey, real estate, from 1 Oct 2026; Dominic Griffiths now on the global Management Committee.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN [S222]

TRAP Naming Griffiths as current head.

12. What is the firm's strategy?

REALLY TESTING Whether you've read leadership's words.

STRUCTURE "Repositioning": deeper with fewer clients; lateral teams in lev fin and private capital; no merger; AI with human review.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN [S220][S84][S230]

TRAP Inventing a strategy.

13. What do you think of our AI programme?

REALLY TESTING Balanced judgement.

STRUCTURE What it is; the human-review rule; the trainee tension (legal tech graded C); a question.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN [S230][S13]

TRAP Gushing, or saying AI will replace lawyers.

14. Who are our competitors?

REALLY TESTING Market map.

STRUCTURE By practice: securitisation (CC, Linklaters, Sidley...), derivatives (CC, A&OS, Linklaters, Ashurst PC), PRT (Linklaters, HLC, Sackers).

FACTS TO WEAVE IN [S141][S142][S145]

TRAP Listing only Magic Circle.

Commercial awareness**15. Tell us about a commercial story you've followed.**

REALLY TESTING Can you turn news into legal work?

STRUCTURE Headline; what changes for clients; what legal work it creates; your view; one risk.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN Part 7 stories 10-12.

TRAP Summary without opinion.

16. What does Basel 3.1 mean for banks and their lawyers?

REALLY TESTING Technical link from rule to work.

STRUCTURE Capital up per loan; banks transfer risk; SRT and synthetic securitisation; Mayer Brown SRT award.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN PS1/26: 1 Jan 2027 [S190]; [S148]

TRAP Getting the date wrong.

17. Why are pension schemes buying insurance now?

REALLY TESTING Market mechanism.

STRUCTURE Higher gilt yields improved funding; insurers compete; record 2025; PSA 2026 changes.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN 367 buy-ins, £38.2bn in 2025 [S201]; PSA 2026 [S200].

TRAP Confusing buy-in and buy-out.

18. Is private credit a risk?

REALLY TESTING Balanced view.

STRUCTURE Growth (\$3tn to \$11tn); BoE stress exercise; benefits to borrowers; opacity and leverage risks.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN [S208][S243]

TRAP One-sided answer.

19. Should UK securitisation rules be loosened?

REALLY TESTING Opinion with both sides.

STRUCTURE For: compliance cost, competitiveness, US CLO access. Against: 2008 memory, private credit warnings. Your view.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN CP26/6 and CP2/26, 17 Feb 2026 [S194].

TRAP Not knowing what risk retention is.

20. London is the financial hub of the world. Discuss.

REALLY TESTING Reported Mayer Brown interview question.

STRUCTURE English law, time zone, talent; vs New York, listings drain, post-Brexit. Your view.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN IPO rebound from low base [S244]; UK legal market £52.3bn [S164].

TRAP No view.

21. What are the threats to the UK economy?

REALLY TESTING Reported question.

STRUCTURE Two or three: energy and inflation, debt, growth; link one to legal work.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN Bank Rate 3.75%, CPI forecast ~4% [S236].

TRAP A list with no ranking.

22. What law would you change?

REALLY TESTING Reported question.

STRUCTURE One specific law; the problem; your change; the trade-off.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN Could use failure to prevent fraud [S203] or SQE rules.

TRAP Something vast and vague.

23. Why are law firms merging?

REALLY TESTING Industry structure.

STRUCTURE Scale, US access for UK firms, cross-selling; costs of integration; MB chose not to.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN A&OS 2024; HSF Kramer 2025; HLC 2026 [S174][S175][S240].

TRAP Saying all firms must merge.

24. How will AI change a trainee's job?

REALLY TESTING Nuance.

STRUCTURE Less first-draft volume; more checking and judgement; clients expect it; training must change.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN Susskind vs TR views [S183][S167]; MB human review [S230].

TRAP "Trainees won't be needed."

Competency**25. Tell me about a time you showed attention to detail.**

REALLY TESTING The core trainee skill.

STRUCTURE STAR, with a number; what would have gone wrong; the habit you built.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN GM filing error as why it matters [S102].

TRAP A trivial example.

26. Tell me about working under pressure.

REALLY TESTING Composure.

STRUCTURE Situation, competing demands, how you prioritised, outcome, what you'd change.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN Hours 9:26am-8:20pm average [S15].

TRAP Saying you never feel pressure.

27. Tell me about a mistake.

REALLY TESTING Honesty and learning.

STRUCTURE Real mistake; your share; how you told someone; the fix; the habit.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN SRA Code 7.11 honesty when things go wrong [S342].

TRAP A disguised strength.

28. Tell me about a time you showed initiative.

REALLY TESTING Reported question.

STRUCTURE Something you started without being asked, within limits, and how you checked.

TRAP Initiative that ignored authority.

29. Tell me about a time you disagreed with someone.

REALLY TESTING Handling conflict.

STRUCTURE Facts, how you raised it, outcome, relationship after.

TRAP Badmouthing.

30. Tell me about a team you led or were part of.

REALLY TESTING Teamwork.

STRUCTURE Your specific role; one hard moment; result.

TRAP "We" throughout.

31. What makes an effective or ineffective leader?

REALLY TESTING Reported question.

STRUCTURE Two traits each, with an example you observed.

TRAP Generic list.

32. How would you stand out as a trainee?

REALLY TESTING Reported question.

STRUCTURE Concrete behaviours: reliable checklists, early flags, asking good questions, pro bono.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN Got20 [S16].

TRAP "By working harder than everyone."

33. A task you disliked: how did you handle it?

REALLY TESTING Reported question.

STRUCTURE Do it well anyway; find the learning; never let quality drop.

TRAP Complaining.

Scenario**34. An associate asks you to send documents to the other side before the client has approved them.**

REALLY TESTING Authority and the record.

STRUCTURE Protocol: steady, sort (authority over speed), act (check with associate / partner), close.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN Part 11, tree 1.

TRAP Just doing it.

35. You hear about a client deal at the masterclass drinks.

REALLY TESTING Confidentiality.

STRUCTURE Don't repeat, don't use; tree 2.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN [S343][S344]

TRAP Using it in your application.

36. You realise you sent the wrong version.

REALLY TESTING Honesty under pressure.

STRUCTURE Composure scenario 4.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN [S342] 7.11

TRAP Hiding it.

37. Two associates both need you tonight.

REALLY TESTING Prioritisation.

STRUCTURE Composure scenario 1.

TRAP Saying yes to both.

Case / fact-find**38. A client must choose between two companies to acquire. Ask your questions.**

REALLY TESTING Reported assessment-centre format.

STRUCTURE Ask about objectives, budget, timing, financials, liabilities, litigation, people; then recommend with reasons and risks.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN Fact-find described in 2020 accounts [S21].

TRAP Recommending before asking.

Case / written**39. Proofread a long article and summarise it in one page.**

REALLY TESTING Reported written exercise.

STRUCTURE Skim, then line edit; fix ~30 errors; one-page summary with headings.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN [S21]: "everyone finds the written exercise the hardest".

TRAP Running out of time on errors.

Case / group**40. Plan a pitch to a client in a team of three.**

REALLY TESTING Reported group exercise.

STRUCTURE Agree roles fast; client concerns, service, relationship; include quieter members; time-keep.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN [S21]

TRAP Dominating.

Curveball

41. What's something you've changed your mind about?

REALLY TESTING Intellectual honesty.

STRUCTURE Old view, new fact, new view.

TRAP No real change.

42. What would you do in your first week?

REALLY TESTING Realism.

STRUCTURE Learn systems, meet the team, ask how they like work delivered, keep a checklist.

TRAP Grand plans.

43. Isn't [rival] better than us?

REALLY TESTING Frame-holding under an invitation to badmouth.

STRUCTURE Praise rival precisely; state your fit here.

FACTS TO WEAVE IN Part 4 lines.

TRAP Agreeing, or attacking.

Ten questions only a researcher could ask

#	To	Question	Built on
1	Trainee panel	Chambers Student says you rank up to five seats and must do one transactional seat. How did you decide what to put first, and how much did business need change it?	[S16]
2	Trainee panel	In your finance seat, how much of the work was on repeat programmes for the same banks, and did that change what you were trusted with?	[S16][S220]
3	Trainee panel	The firm made human review of every AI output mandatory. In practice, what do you check, and how did you learn to check it?	[S230]
4	Practice deep dive	Derivatives and structured products reached the Legal 500 top tier this year. How much of that work is transatlantic, and where do trainees fit in?	[S139]
5	Practice deep dive	Basel 3.1 starts on 1 January 2027. Are you already seeing more significant risk transfer work from UK banks?	[S190][S148]
6	Practice deep dive	With deal counts down but values up in buy-ins, is insurer documentation becoming standardised, and where does that leave the lawyer?	[S237]
7	Partner / leadership	The chair talks about going deeper with fewer clients. What does that mean for the London finance group's client mix?	[S220]
8	Partner / leadership	Several rivals chose transatlantic mergers, including Cadwalader. What does a firm of Mayer Brown's size gain by staying independent?	[S240]
9	Partner / leadership	London has hired leveraged finance teams from Dechert, Kirkland and Baker McKenzie. How do they work with the bank-side finance teams?	[S280][S327][S226]
10	Graduate recruitment	What separates vacation schemers who get offers from those who don't, beyond what's on the website?	[S17]

DON'T ASK

Pay, bonuses, holiday, "what's the culture like?", anything on the website, anything about the August 2026 incident or US politics.

PART 10

Interviewer briefing: who may be in the room

The speakers are not published. These are the people most likely to appear, ranked by judgement, with public professional information only. Identity is confirmed against the firm and London unless flagged.

SOURCE UNCERTAIN

No speaker list for the masterclass was found; SEO event pages sit behind a student login [S8]. Everything below is "who is likely", not "who will be". Do not mention having researched someone personally; say you read the firm's website.

The likely speakers

Person	Role	Public professional background	Practitioner or recruiter? How to pitch
Miriam Bruce Most likely	Training Principal, London; partner, Employment & Benefits; leads the Business Protection practice [S62]	Joined Mayer Brown as a trainee in 2005, qualified 2007, partner January 2020. BA Modern Languages (Durham), PgDL (City), LPC (Inns of Court School of Law) [S63]. Chambers UK Band 1, Employment: Employer: High Court Litigation (London) [S57]; The Lawyer Hot 100 2026 [S62]. Recent podcast on restrictive covenants (Sep 2026) [S63]. Quoted: "One of the advantages of a training contract at Mayer Brown is that it is a small cohort" [S16].	Both: a practitioner who runs recruitment. Ask about the training model; she is living proof of trainee-to-partner.
Chris Harvey	London Managing Partner from 1 Oct 2026; global co-leader, Real Estate [S222][S64]	Joined in 2012. Led LKK Health Products' acquisition of 20 Fenchurch Street (the "Walkie Talkie"), which the firm calls the UK's largest office deal. Legal 500 Leading Partner; Chambers Band 2, Real Estate [S64][S55]. "It is a privilege to be asked to lead Mayer Brown's London office" [S222].	Practitioner and leader. Ask about London's direction and how real estate links to finance.
Alex Dell	Global co-head, Banking & Finance [S66][S226]	Asset-based lending, receivables and trade finance; LLB (Leicester); Chambers Band 1 and Legal 500 Leading Partner, ABL [S66][S55]. "Rob, David and Ben's appointments highlight Mayer Brown's continued momentum in the leveraged finance sphere" [S226].	Practitioner. Ask how the new leveraged finance teams fit with ABL.
Dominic Griffiths	Global Management Committee; former London MP (2022 to Sep 2026) [S222]	Banking & Finance and Structured Finance; London and New York. BA (Bristol); Diploma in Law and LPC (College of Law, 1996). Legal 500 Hall of Fame, securitisation; Chambers Band 1, ABL [S65][S55]. Co-author of the firm's 2026 securitisation reform note [S232].	Practitioner. Securitisation reform is the perfect question.
Edmund Parker	Leader, Derivatives & Structured Products [S67]	President of the City of London Law Society 2024-25; author of books on derivatives; LLB (Dundee), LLM (Queen Mary) [S67]. Legal 500 Hall of Fame [S55].	Practitioner. Ask about the new top-tier ranking or SRT.
Kieran Bennett	Graduate Recruitment & Development Coordinator [S61]	Listed as the applications contact. Reported; listing undated .	Recruiter. Ask process questions; be warm and precise.
Trainees and associates	Unknown	Not researched.	Peers. Ask about the work, not the pay.

IDENTITY FLAGS

Two Fishers: Simon Fisher (asset-based lending) and Christopher Fisher (employment). The firm-wide Managing Partner is listed as Jeremy Clay on the leadership page [S74]; one research source could not confirm his current title independently. Mark Dubes held the Graduate Recruitment & Development Manager title in 2022; a 12-month manager role was advertised in March 2026, so do not assume who holds it now [S284][S297].

Reading the interviewer live

PRACTITIONER (PARTNER, ASSOCIATE)

Wants to see how you think about a client's problem. Go one level deeper on content; use the deal or rule they mentioned; accept correction gracefully; ask "what is the lawyer actually checking there?"

RECRUITER (GRADUATE RECRUITMENT)

Wants evidence of fit and process readiness. Be concise, organised and specific about your timeline; show you've read the site; follow up in writing.

TRAINEE

Remembers good questions and often feeds back. Be curious and kind; never compete with other candidates in front of them.

LEADER (MANAGING PARTNER)

Thinks in strategy. One sharp question about direction, then listen.

Signals to adapt to: if they lean in and ask a follow-up, go deeper; if they glance at the room, wrap up in one sentence; if they correct you, thank them and use the correction in your next sentence.

PART 11

The scenario playbook

How to answer any hypothetical without losing your footing, then 39 practice cards, five composure scenarios with decision trees, and a CV grill. This is method, so most of it carries the **Inferred** tag; where it leans on a rule, the rule is cited.

Why scenarios matter at this firm and this event

At the masterclass itself nobody will "interview" you. But three things on the agenda behave like an interview: the trainee panel (where your question is judged by everyone in the room), the practice deep dive (where a partner may throw a hypothetical at the audience), and networking (where every conversation is a two-minute assessment). Then, if the event goes well, the training contract process follows. Law firm assessment centres commonly use a case study, a written exercise and a partner interview, and partners like to push a candidate with "what would you do if" questions to see whether they stay calm and sensible (see Part 9 for what is known about Mayer Brown's own process).

The aim of this part is not to memorise answers. It is to build one stable way of thinking that you can apply to anything: a set order of priorities, and a four-step routine that turns that order into a spoken answer.

The four-step protocol: steady, sort, act, close

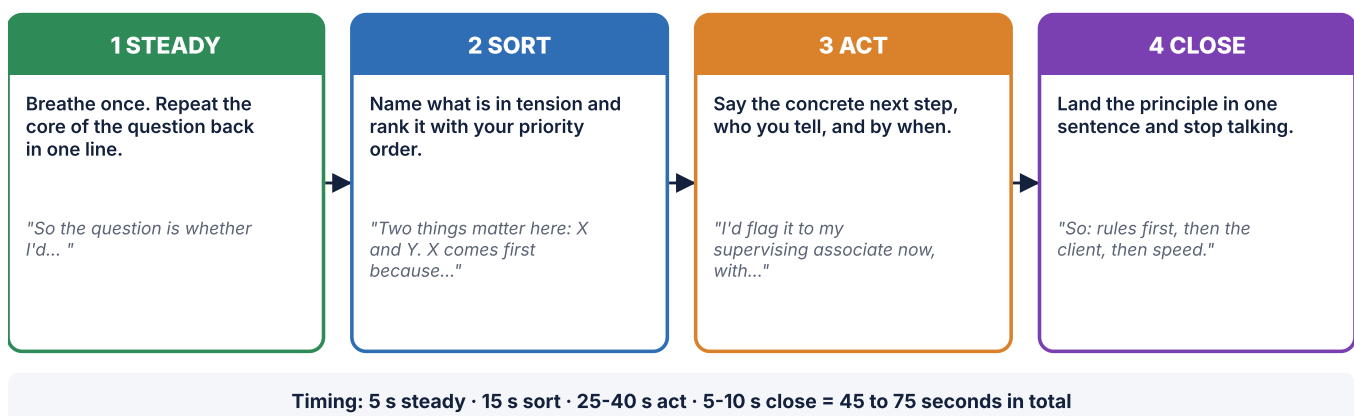


Figure 42. The four-step answer protocol for any scenario or hypothetical. **Source:** author's method [Inferred].

1. Steady (about 5 seconds)

Take one breath. Then restate the question in one line. This buys time and proves you heard the actual question, not the one you prepared for.

"So I've got a signing tonight, the associate is unreachable, and the other side wants the documents now."

2. Sort (about 15 seconds)

Name the two or three things in tension, then rank them using the priority order below. Saying the ranking out loud is what interviewers mark.

"Two things matter: getting the deal signed on time, and not releasing anything I'm not authorised to release. The second comes first."

3. Act (25 to 40 seconds)

Give the concrete next step: who you call, what you send, by when. Trainees are judged on initiative within limits, so show both halves: you move, and you escalate.

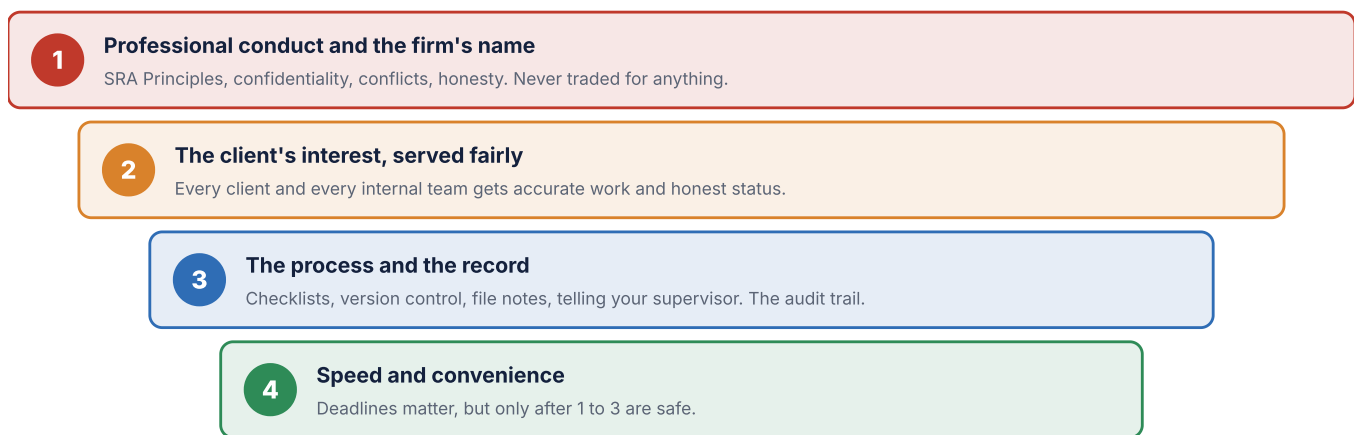
"I'd try the associate on phone and Teams, then the supervising partner. Meanwhile I'd get everything else ready so we lose no time once someone says yes."

4. Close (5 to 10 seconds)

One sentence of principle. Then stop. Silence after a good answer is fine (see tactic 3).

"So: authority first, then speed, and nobody is surprised."

The priority order when good things collide



"I'd protect the rules and the client first, keep the record straight, and then go as fast as that allows."

Figure 43. The priority order when good things collide in a trainee seat, and the one sentence that holds every frame. **Basis:** the SRA Principles put integrity, independence and acting in the client's best interests above convenience; see Part 6 [Inferred ordering].

Every hard trainee scenario is a clash between good things: helping the client, pleasing a senior colleague, hitting a deadline, following the process. The order above settles almost all of them. It mirrors the way the solicitors' regulator, the Solicitors Regulation Authority (SRA), frames a solicitor's duties: the seven SRA Principles require you to act with honesty and integrity, in a way that upholds public trust, and in the best interests of each client, and where Principles conflict, those that safeguard the wider public interest take precedence over an individual client's interests [S341] **Confirmed**. Speed and convenience are not Principles at all.

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"I'd protect the rules and the client first, keep the record straight, and then go as fast as that allows."

Eight ways interviewers break a frame, and the counters

1. Interruption They cut you off mid-answer. Counter: Stop. "Sure." Answer the new point, then: "To finish my earlier point in one line..."	2. Flat contradiction "That's wrong." Counter: "Which part? ...If X is true, then I'd change my view to Y." Update on facts, not on pressure.
3. Silence They say nothing after you finish. Counter: Do not fill it with a new answer. "Happy to go deeper on any part of that."	4. Escalation "Now the client is shouting and it's 11pm." Counter: Same priority order, faster action. Name who you call and what you send.
5. Authority squeeze "The partner says just do it." Counter: "I'd do it, and I'd also raise the concern with them directly first."	6. False choice "Client or firm: pick one." Counter: "I don't think those conflict here, because... if they truly did, the rules decide."
7. Knowledge trap A fact or term you don't know. Counter: "I don't know that yet. My guess from first principles is... and I'd check X."	8. Invite to badmouth "Isn't [rival firm] better?" Counter: Praise the rival precisely, then say what fits you here. Never knock anyone.

Figure 44. Eight ways an interviewer or networking contact breaks your frame, and the counter to each. **Source:** author's method [Inferred].

Partners test whether a view survives pressure. A good candidate changes their mind when given a new fact, and holds it when given only pressure. Say which one is happening: "If that's the case, I'd change my answer to..." versus "I understand the pressure, but I'd still..."

Staying calm physically

- **Breathe out longer than you breathe in** before you speak (four in, six out). It slows the heart rate and stops the rushed first sentence.
- **Feet flat, hands still and visible.** At networking, hold your drink in your left hand so your right is free to shake.
- **Pause before the answer, not during it.** A two-second pause reads as thought. Fillers ("um, like") read as panic.
- **Have a written fallback line** for a blank: "Can I take ten seconds to think about that?" Then use all ten.
- **Lower your pitch at the end of the sentence.** Rising endings sound like questions.

The scenario ladder

The "job description" for this pack is two documents read together: the SEO London event page, which sets out what happens on 2 November, and Mayer Brown's own description of what trainees do (Part 1). Each line becomes three practice scenarios.

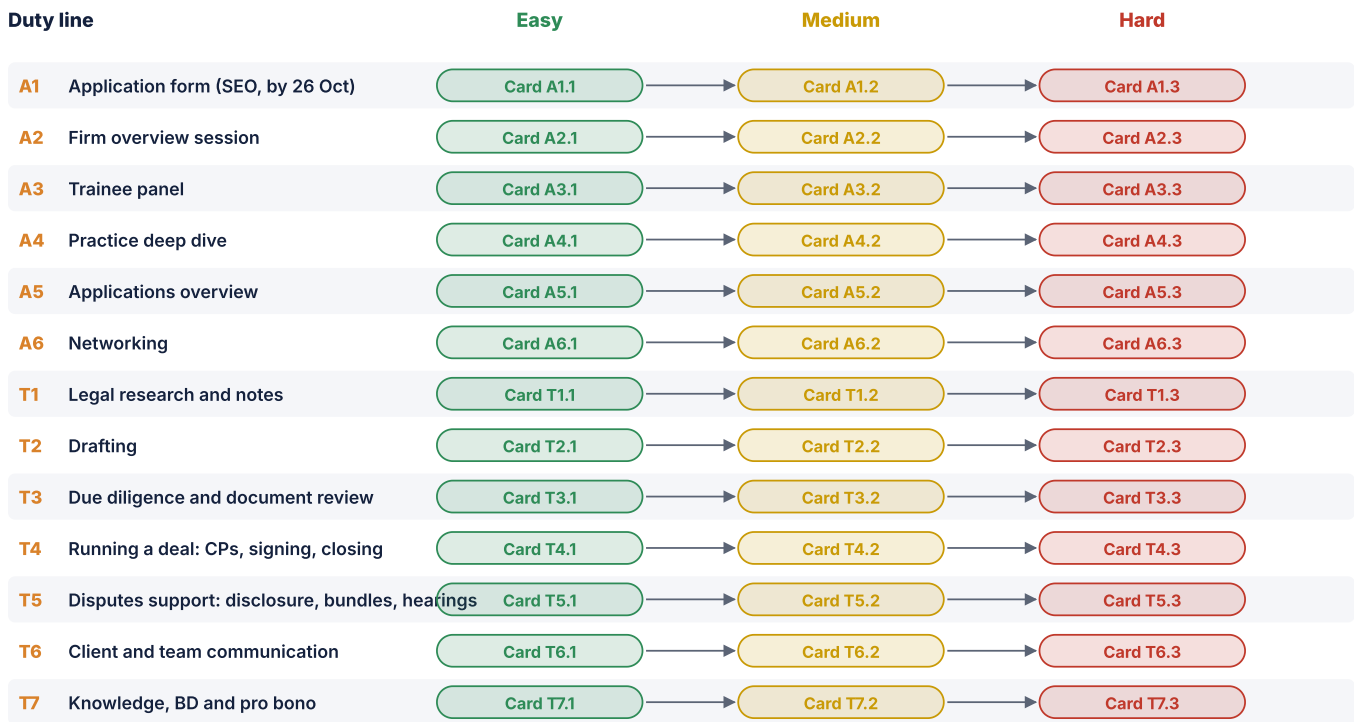


Figure 45. The scenario ladder: every duty line from the event page and the trainee role, three rungs each, easy to hard. The cards follow in the same order. **Source:** duty lines from the SEO event page and Mayer Brown's trainee description (Part 1).

A. The event lines

A1.1 · Application: "Why this masterclass?"

Easy

Setup: The SEO application asks why you want to attend the Mayer Brown masterclass.

Trap: Writing about "a global firm with a diverse client base". That is the event page's own sentence. The reader wrote it.

Say: One mechanism about the firm (for example, its depth in finance work for banks and its structured finance heritage; Part 4), one thing you want to learn on the day (a specific agenda item), and one honest reason it fits you.

Why it works: SEO's event is for 60 candidates [S340]; readers sort hundreds of forms. Specifics are the only thing that separates.

Twist: Word limit is tight. Hold: cut adjectives first, never the mechanism.

A1.2 · Application: grades below the line

Medium

Setup: You had a weak first-year module or a 2:2 in one year.

Trap: Hiding it, or writing a paragraph of apology.

Say: State the facts in one line, any mitigating circumstance in one line (the event page says mitigating circumstances will be considered [S340]), and the evidence of recovery.

Why it works: Eligibility is "predicted or achieved 2:1"; the form is checking honesty and trajectory as much as the number.

Twist: "Why should we pick you over someone with a first?" Hold: "Grades are one signal. Here's another one that matters for a trainee: [specific example of sustained, careful work]."

A1.3 · Application: "Tell us about a commercial issue affecting the firm"

Hard

Setup: A commercial awareness question with a short word count.

Trap: Summarising a headline. That shows reading, not thinking.

Say: Headline in one sentence, then the chain: what changes for Mayer Brown's clients, what work that creates or removes, and which practice does it. Use one story from Part 7.

Why it works: Commercial awareness at a law firm means seeing how a market event becomes legal work.

Twist: Asked about it again at the event. Hold: give the same view and add one thing you've learned since.

A2.1 · Firm overview: the speaker asks the room a question**Easy****Setup:** "Does anyone know when Mayer Brown came to London?"**Trap:** Silence, or guessing a year.**Say:** If you know it from Part 2, say it in one line with the mechanism (the merger and what it brought). If not: "I know it came through a merger with a UK firm, but not the year."**Why it works:** Being right matters less than being precise about what you know.**Twist:** Follow-up: "And what did that bring?" Hold with one practice name, not a list.**A2.2 · Firm overview: a number you've read differs from the slide****Medium****Setup:** The slide says one revenue or headcount figure; your pack says another.**Trap:** Correcting the presenter in public.**Say:** Nothing in the session. Later, if natural: "I'd seen a different figure in the legal press. Is that a different year or a different basis?"**Why it works:** Firm figures vary by financial year and by what is counted (lawyers versus total staff). Asking about basis shows numeracy without point-scoring.**Twist:** "Where did you read that?" Hold: name the outlet and date.**A2.3 · Firm overview: "What would you change about our strategy?"****Hard****Setup:** A partner asks this in a Q&A.**Trap:** Either flattery ("nothing") or a lecture.**Say:** "I'm not in a position to change it, but the question I'd be watching is..." then one tension from Part 8 (for example: how a firm strong in bank finance positions itself as private credit grows).**Why it works:** It shows a view and humility in one move.**Twist:** "And your answer?" Hold: give a tentative view and the fact that would change it.**A3.1 · Trainee panel: asking a good question****Easy****Setup:** The chair asks for questions from the floor.**Trap:** "What's the culture like?" Everyone asks it; every answer is "friendly".**Say:** A question only research could produce, from the list in Part 9. Example: "In your finance seat, how much of the work was on repeat programmes for the same clients, and how did that change what you were trusted with?"**Why it works:** Trainees remember the good questions and often feed back to graduate recruitment.**Twist:** The trainee gives a short answer. Hold: one follow-up, then let someone else in.**A3.2 · Trainee panel: a trainee says something negative****Medium****Setup:** A trainee says the hours in one seat were tough.**Trap:** Pouncing on it, or pretending you didn't hear.**Say:** Later, in networking: "You mentioned the hours in that seat. What helped you get through the busiest weeks?"**Why it works:** It treats the honesty as useful and asks for the coping skill, which is what you need to learn.**Twist:** "Would that put you off?" Hold: "No. I'd want to know it's coming and how the team shares it."**A3.3 · Trainee panel: "So why do you want to be a lawyer?"****Hard****Setup:** A trainee turns the question on you in front of others.**Trap:** A speech. Or "I like problem solving" (so does everyone).**Say:** Thirty seconds, from your own evidence: one experience, what it showed you about the work (precision, advising someone with money at stake, being trusted with detail), why commercial law and not another job.**Why it works:** It is the same structure you will use at interview, tested early.**Twist:** "Why not the Bar?" Hold: "I want to be part of a team on a transaction or a case from start to finish, and to work for clients over years, not one hearing at a time."

A4.1 · Practice deep dive: you don't understand a term**Easy**

Setup: The partner says "true sale opinion" or "buy-in" without explaining.

Trap: Nodding.

Say: Check the glossary (Part 14) in your notes. If still lost, ask at the end: "You mentioned X. Could you say what the lawyer is actually checking there?"

Why it works: "What is the lawyer actually doing" is the question partners like, because it is the job.

Twist: None. This one is a free point.

A4.2 · Practice deep dive: a hypothetical for the room**Medium**

Setup: "A bank client wants to sell a pool of car loans to investors. What could go wrong?"

Trap: Saying "I don't know law". Nobody expects law.

Say: First principles: "Investors need to know the loans really belong to the new vehicle if the bank goes bust, that the borrowers keep paying, and that someone collects and passes on the money." That is, in plain words, true sale, credit risk and servicing (Part 6).

Why it works: Structured finance is a core Mayer Brown practice (Part 4). Thinking in risks is how lawyers start.

Twist: "And the regulator?" Hold: "There are rules on securitisation in the UK. I know the regime was overhauled in 2024 but not the detail." (Part 6 has the detail.)

A4.3 · Practice deep dive: the partner challenges your answer**Hard**

Setup: You answered A4.2. The partner says: "But the bank still services the loans. So has it really sold them?"

Trap: Folding ("oh, then no") or digging in.

Say: "That's the tension. Legally it can sell the loans and still act as collector for a fee, as long as the money it collects is held for the buyer and not mixed with its own. So the documents and the cash flow have to show that."

Why it works: You updated on a fact and kept the structure. That is the whole frame method.

Twist: "How would you check?" Hold: "Read the sale agreement and the servicing agreement, and follow where the cash goes."

A5.1 · Applications overview: the deadline question**Easy**

Setup: Graduate recruitment explains the vacation scheme and training contract process.

Trap: Asking something that's on the website.

Say: Take notes. Ask only what the site doesn't say, for example how the masterclass connects to the vacation scheme process (Part 9 lists the known facts).

Why it works: Shows you've read the site.

Twist: None.

A5.2 · Applications overview: law vs non-law**Medium**

Setup: You are non-law. A recruiter asks how you'd handle the SQE.

Trap: Over-apologising for your degree.

Say: "The SQE route means law and non-law graduates sit the same exams. I'd do the firm's sponsored preparation course first." (Facts on the route: Part 6.)

Why it works: It shows you know the route since September 2021 is the same for both.

Twist: "Why not convert first?" Hold: "The firm sponsors the course; I'd want to learn it the way the firm trains."

A5.3 · Applications overview: "Which other firms are you applying to?"**Hard**

Setup: A recruiter asks this casually over coffee.

Trap: Saying "only you" (not credible) or listing twenty.

Say: "A handful of firms strong in finance, mostly US and international firms in London. What links them is..." then the mechanism.

Why it works: A coherent list is evidence of a coherent reason.

Twist: "So why us first?" Hold: Part 12's thirty-second answer.

A6.1 · Networking: opening a conversation**Easy****Setup:** A lawyer is standing alone with a drink.**Trap:** Waiting to be approached, or opening with your CV.**Say:** "Hi, I'm [name], I'm at [university]. Thank you for the session. Which part of the deep dive is closest to what you actually do?"**Why it works:** People like talking about their own work. You learn the thing you need.**Twist:** They're a business services person, not a lawyer. Hold: just as interested: "How does your team work with the lawyers?" (Part 3 explains why that question is good.)**A6.2 · Networking: joining a crowded group****Medium****Setup:** One partner, eight candidates.**Trap:** Interrupting to ask your question, or standing silently.**Say:** Listen. Build on someone else's question: "Following on from that..." Then step back and let someone else in.**Why it works:** Generosity is visible. Partners notice who listens.**Twist:** The partner asks you directly. Hold: one short answer and one question back.**A6.3 · Networking: "Ask me anything"****Hard****Setup:** A senior lawyer says: "Go on, what do you really want to know?"**Trap:** Asking about pay, or freezing.**Say:** "What separates the trainees who get kept on from the ones who don't?" or "What did you get wrong in your first year that you'd warn me about?"**Why it works:** These are the questions they enjoy answering and you most need answered.**Twist:** They turn it: "And what will you get wrong?" Hold: one honest weakness and the habit that manages it.**B. The trainee-role lines**

These mirror what Mayer Brown says its trainees do (Part 1) and what is common across City firms. Use them for the assessment centre and partner interview, not just the masterclass.

T1.1 · Research: a quick question from an associate**Easy****Setup:** "Can you find out whether a company can do X under its articles? Need it by four."**Trap:** Disappearing until four and returning with ten pages.**Say:** Confirm the question and the format ("a short email with the answer first?"). Check in at two if it's harder than expected. Lead with the answer, then the source.**Why it works:** Answer first, then reasoning, is how busy lawyers read.**Twist:** You find two sources that disagree. Hold: say so; don't pick silently.**T1.2 · Research: you can't find an answer****Medium****Setup:** Three hours in, no clear authority.**Trap:** Pretending you found one, or saying nothing.**Say:** "I haven't found a direct answer. Here is what I've checked, the closest material, and my view. Shall I ask the knowledge lawyer?"**Why it works:** Firms have knowledge teams (Part 3). Using them is good process.**Twist:** "Just give me your best guess." Hold: give it, and label it as a guess.**T1.3 · Research: you realise your earlier note was wrong****Hard****Setup:** Your note went to the client yesterday. Today you see a later rule change.**Trap:** Hoping no one notices.**Say:** Tell your supervisor now, with the correction drafted.**Why it works:** The Code requires honesty with clients when things go wrong [S342]; early is cheap, late is expensive.**Twist:** "Won't that embarrass us?" Hold: "Less than the client finding it."

T2.1 · Drafting: board minutes**Easy**

Setup: You are asked to draft board minutes approving a loan.

Trap: Starting from a blank page.

Say: Ask for the firm precedent, check names, dates and figures against the term sheet, mark anything you're unsure of in square brackets.

Why it works: Precedents and square brackets are how drafting is done safely.

Twist: The precedent is from another jurisdiction. Hold: flag it.

T2.2 · Drafting: conflicting comments**Medium**

Setup: The associate and the client send conflicting changes to the same clause.

Trap: Picking one.

Say: Make neither; send the associate a short note showing both and ask which applies.

Why it works: The decision belongs to the person responsible for the advice.

Twist: The associate is on leave. Hold: ask the partner, not the client.

T2.3 · Drafting: the wrong version goes out**Hard**

Setup: You sent the other side an earlier draft containing internal comments.

Trap: Asking them to delete it and telling no one.

Say: Tell the associate immediately. They decide how to deal with the other side. Write down what happened.

Why it works: Composure scenario 4 below is this case. Confidentiality and honesty both bite.

Twist: "How will you stop it again?" Hold: name a concrete habit (check the attachment name before sending).

T3.1 · Due diligence: reviewing contracts**Easy**

Setup: Review 60 leases for change of control clauses.

Trap: Reading every word of every lease with no system.

Say: Agree the template for the report, then work through in a table: document, clause, what it says, risk rating.

Why it works: Diligence reports feed the client's decision; consistency is what makes them usable.

Twist: An AI review tool is available. Hold: use it, then check its outputs on a sample.

T3.2 · Due diligence: a missing document**Medium**

Setup: The data room lacks a key contract.

Trap: Assuming it doesn't exist.

Say: Note it as a gap and suggest a request to the seller's lawyers.

Why it works: Gaps are findings.

Twist: Deadline tomorrow. Hold: report with the gap flagged.

T3.3 · Due diligence: a red flag**Hard**

Setup: You see emails suggesting a payment to an official.

Trap: Burying it in row 47 of the report.

Say: Tell your supervisor the same day, outside the report.

Why it works: Possible bribery is a legal risk for the client and may raise anti-money-laundering duties for the firm; that is for seniors and compliance to judge.

Twist: "Should we tell the client?" Hold: "That's a call for the partner and compliance."

T4.1 · Deals: running a CP checklist**Easy**

Setup: You own the conditions precedent (CP) checklist for a loan.

Trap: Updating it only when asked.

Say: Update daily, circulate with what's outstanding and who owes it.

Why it works: The checklist is how everyone knows when the deal can close.

Twist: Twenty parties. Hold: same method, prioritised by what blocks closing.

T4.2 · Deals: a signature page arrives unsigned**Medium**

Setup: Late evening, one page is missing a signature.

Trap: Marking it as received.

Say: Tell the associate; chase the signatory's lawyer.

Why it works: An unsigned page means no binding signature.

Twist: "Just release; they'll sign tomorrow." Hold: composure scenario 2.

T4.3 · Deals: two deals close the same night**Hard**

Setup: Two associates both need you from 6pm.

Trap: Saying yes to both without telling either.

Say: Composure scenario 1.

Why it works: Transparency lets seniors allocate.

Twist: Both say theirs is more urgent. Hold: go to whoever staffs you.

T5.1 · Disputes: preparing a bundle**Easy**

Setup: Prepare a hearing bundle for tomorrow.

Trap: Starting without checking the court's rules on format.

Say: Check the practice direction and the index agreed with the other side.

Why it works: Courts set bundle rules; mistakes waste the judge's time.

Twist: Late document. Hold: ask whether it needs the other side's agreement.

T5.2 · Disputes: a privileged document in a disclosure batch**Medium**

Setup: Reviewing documents for disclosure, you find legal advice to the client.

Trap: Leaving it in the batch.

Say: Flag as potentially privileged and ask.

Why it works: Privilege protects the client; losing it can't be undone.

Twist: It's also harmful to your client. Hold: privilege is the test, not harm.

T5.3 · Disputes: a document hurts the client**Hard**

Setup: A non-privileged email damages your client's case.

Trap: Suggesting it be left out.

Say: It goes in if it's within the disclosure order. Tell the associate so the team can prepare.

Why it works: Solicitors must not mislead the court [s342]; disclosure duties are owed to the court.

Twist: "The client will be furious." Hold: priority order tier 1.

T6.1 · Communication: client calls you directly**Easy**

Setup: A client calls you with a question.

Trap: Answering off the cuff.

Say: "Let me check with [associate] and come back to you by [time]." Then do.

Why it works: Fast, honest, and protects the advice.

Twist: "It's a simple yes or no." Hold: same answer, shorter time.

T6.2 · Communication: an overloaded week**Medium****Setup:** Your supervisor gives you a third task. You can't do all three well.**Trap:** Saying yes and missing one.**Say:** "Happy to. I've also got X and Y due Thursday. Which should move?"**Why it works:** Capacity is information the team needs.**Twist:** "All of them." Hold: ask whether someone else can help on one.**T6.3 · Communication: a cross-border call goes wrong****Hard****Setup:** On a call with colleagues in another office, you realise the two teams are working from different versions.**Trap:** Waiting until after the call.**Say:** "Sorry to interrupt: can we check we're both on version 4?"**Why it works:** Mayer Brown runs cross-border deals across many offices (Part 2); version control is a real risk.**Twist:** A partner is talking. Hold: still say it, briefly.**T7.1 · Knowledge and BD: writing a client alert****Easy****Setup:** Help with a short update on a new rule.**Trap:** Describing the rule without saying who it affects.**Say:** What changed, who it affects, what they should do, by when.**Why it works:** Firms publish insights to stay useful to clients between deals.**Twist:** Word limit. Hold: cut history first.**T7.2 · Pro bono: a deadline clash****Medium****Setup:** A pro bono deadline clashes with fee-earning work.**Trap:** Treating pro bono as optional.**Say:** Tell both supervisors and agree a plan. Pro bono clients are clients.**Why it works:** Same duties apply whether or not the client pays.**Twist:** "Drop the pro bono." Hold: ask who will cover it.**T7.3 · BD: a friend asks about a deal****Hard****Setup:** A friend in finance asks, "Is your firm on the X takeover?"**Trap:** Hinting.**Say:** "I can't talk about client work, sorry." Same answer whether it's true or not.**Why it works:** Decision tree 2.**Twist:** "It's public anyway." Hold: "Then you don't need me to confirm it."

The composure set: five hard scenarios with decision trees

1. Two senior people want you at the same time

Setup: Two associates on different deals each need you tonight. Both say theirs is urgent.**Path:** (1) Don't promise both. (2) Tell each of them about the other, with the facts: what each task is and when it's due. (3) If they can't agree, go to the person who allocates your work (often the supervising partner or a trainee manager). (4) Do what's decided and tell both. **Line:** "I want to get both right, so I'd rather be honest about the clash now than miss one at midnight."

2. A senior person asks you to skip a control

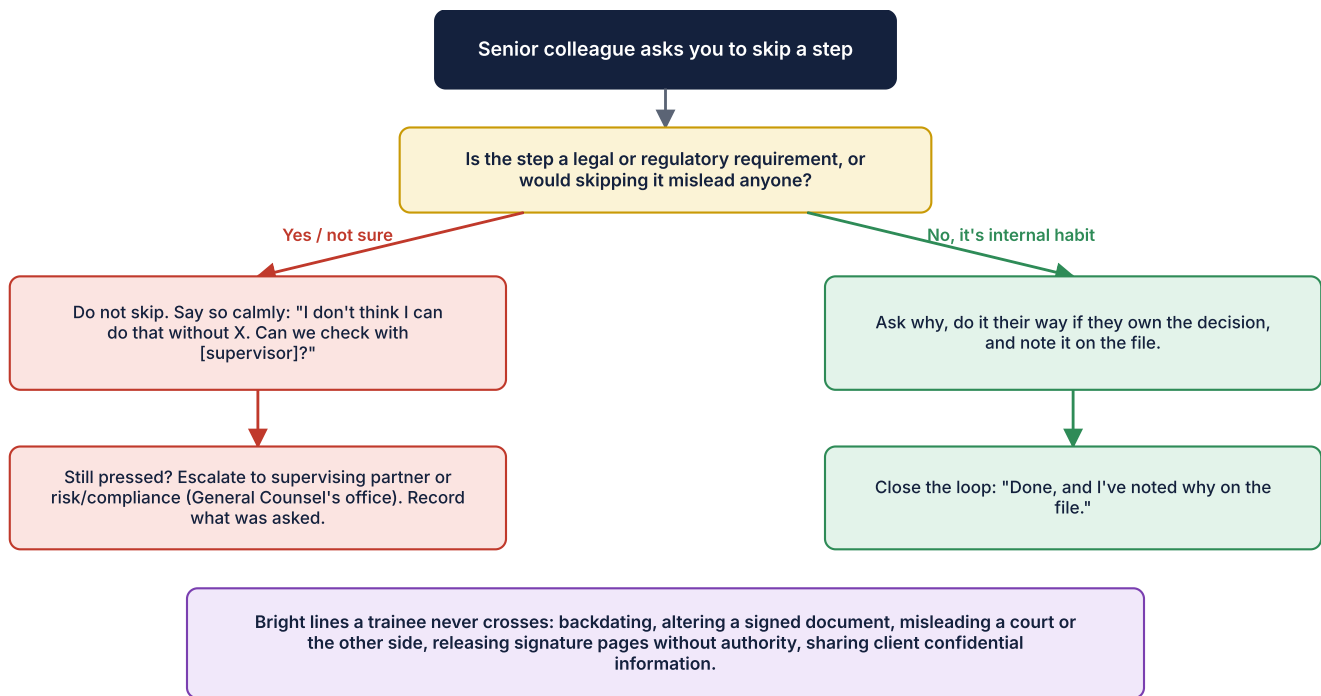


Figure 46. Decision tree 1: a senior person asks you to skip a control. **Basis:** SRA Principles [S341] and Code of Conduct for Solicitors [S342] on integrity, honesty and not misleading others; see Part 6 [Confirmed for the rules, Inferred for the tree].

3. You hear something that might be confidential or inside information

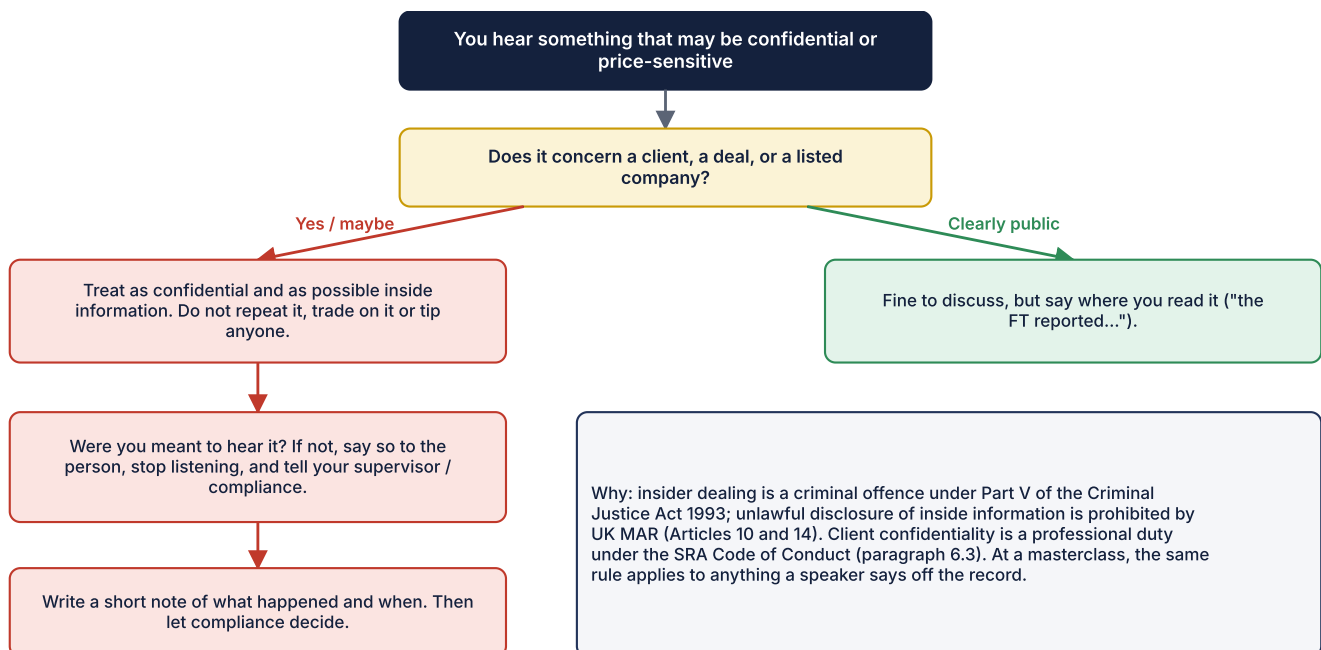


Figure 47. Decision tree 2: hearing something that might be confidential or inside information. **Sources:** Criminal Justice Act 1993 Part V [S343]; UK Market Abuse Regulation Arts 10 and 14 [S344]; SRA Code of Conduct for Solicitors para 6.3 [S342]. See Part 6 and the source table [Confirmed for the law; tree is Inferred].

At the masterclass: if a speaker mentions a live deal "off the record", do not repeat it, post it or use it in your application. Use only what the firm has published.

4. A mistake you made

Path: (1) Stop the damage if you safely can (for example, recall the email). (2) Tell your supervisor within the hour, with facts and a suggested fix. (3) Write a short note of what happened. (4) Change one habit. **Line:** "I'd rather tell you now with

a fix than have you find out later." The SRA Code requires you to be honest and open with clients if things go wrong [S342]; the firm, not the trainee, decides how to handle the client.

5. Acting on incomplete information against a deadline

Path: (1) Identify what is irreversible (filing, sending, signing) and what is not (drafting, preparing). (2) Do everything reversible now. (3) For the irreversible step, get a decision from someone with authority; keep trying different routes. (4) If the deadline passes with no decision, the cost of missing a deadline is usually smaller than the cost of acting without authority, but say so to the person in charge in writing. **Line:** "I'd get everything ready so the decision is the only thing left."

The CV grill

How it works: an interviewer picks one CV line and goes three levels down. Level 1: "Tell me about this." Level 2: "What exactly did *you* do?" Level 3: "What would you do differently, and why didn't you?" Most candidates fail at level 2 by saying "we".

Attack	Frame-holding answer pattern
"What did you personally do?"	Use "I" and a verb: "I built the spreadsheet, I ran the weekly call." Then credit the team in one clause.
"What was the result, in numbers?"	Have one number per bullet ready. If none exists, say what changed and how you know.
"That sounds small."	"It was. What it taught me was X, and that scales."
"Why did you leave / stop?"	Forward reason, not backward: "I wanted to try X."
"What went wrong?"	A real thing, your share of it, the fix.
"How does this relate to law?"	Map to a trainee skill: detail, deadlines, explaining complex things simply, working under supervision.
"Your grade here is low."	Fact, context, trajectory. One sentence each.
"Everyone says they're a team player."	"Fair. Here's a time I put the team's deadline ahead of my own credit..."

FOUR-LINE DRILL FOR EVERY CV BULLET

1. Situation in one sentence. 2. What I did (three verbs). 3. The result (a number or a concrete change). 4. What I'd do differently, and what it taught me that a trainee needs. Write all four lines for every bullet. Say them out loud twice.

SOURCE UNCERTAIN

No candidate CV was supplied with this request, so the grill is generic. Run the drill on your own CV before 26 October.

PART 12

"Why Mayer Brown?" in three lengths

Built from mechanism, not adjectives. Every sentence would need changing to work for any other firm. Fill the bracketed parts from your own experience.

Why Mayer Brown, on one page

The mechanism: a Chicago finance firm built on a 130-year-old London practice, concentrated in finance products for institutions, choosing focus and lateral teams over merger.

STRUCTURE	PRODUCTS	MOMENT
Associated practices: US LLP + English LLP [S75]	Top tier: derivatives, ABL, trade finance [S139]	London revenue +20.5%, record \$268.2m [S302]
London = Rowe & Maw, 1895 [S70]	US ABS firm of the year x6; SRT 2026 [S148]	"Deeper with fewer clients" [S220]
Not merging; hiring teams [S220][S84]	Pensions-insurance one-stop shop: Ford £4.6bn [S310]	Basel 3.1 Jan 2027 → risk transfer work [S190]
~15 trainees, Magic Circle pay [S16][S234]	Construction disputes top band 19 years [S140]	GenAI with mandatory human review [S230]
Three lengths (full text in Part 12)		
30 seconds Finance products for institutions where the firm is top tier; a London practice with real depth; a cohort of 15 where trainees do real work.	2 minutes Add: why focus not merger; one deal (Ford buy-in or Nigeria ports); Basel 3.1 and SRT; what you learned at the masterclass.	The close "The thing I most want to work on is [derivatives / risk transfer / buy-ins], because..." One reason from your own experience.
Most candidates say "Global firm with a diverse client base." "Strong in finance." "Friendly culture." "Great training." "Matches Magic Circle pay." (All true of many firms; one is the event page's own sentence.)	You can say "Top tier in London for both derivatives and asset-based lending, which no other firm I'm applying to is." "London grew 20% by going deeper with fewer clients." "The Ford buy-in needed pensions, insurance and derivatives lawyers in one team." "Basel 3.1 makes risk transfer work grow from January."	

Figure 48. "Why Mayer Brown" on one page: structure, products and moment, the three lengths, and the contrast with what most candidates will say. Sources as marked; synthesis is the author's [Inferred].

Thirty seconds

SAY THIS

"Three things. First, the work: Mayer Brown London is top tier for derivatives and asset-based lending, which are the finance products I find most interesting, because [one line from your experience]. Second, the shape: about fifteen trainees a year, so I'd be doing real work on those deals rather than being one of a hundred. Third, the moment: London grew 20% last year by going deeper with fewer clients, and Basel 3.1 in January will push banks into exactly the risk transfer work the firm is known for."

Sources: [S139][S16][S302][S220][S190][S148].

Two minutes

SAY THIS

"I want to train somewhere where the finance work is the core of the firm, not a side-line, and where a trainee is close enough to the deal to understand why each document exists."

Mayer Brown fits on both. On the work: the London office is top tier in the Legal 500 for derivatives and structured products, asset-based lending and trade finance. Behind that is one of the largest structured finance practices in the world; GlobalCapital has named it US ABS law firm of the year six years running. I like that combination because the regulation is moving right now. The FCA and PRA consulted in February on loosening the UK securitisation rules, and Basel 3.1 starts on 1 January, which makes banks look for ways to transfer risk. That is work this firm already does.

On the structure: I was struck that the Ford pension buy-in last year, the biggest of 2025, was run by an insurance partner with a pensions partner as relationship lead. A product like that needs four teams to work as one, and that's the kind of collaboration I'd want to learn from.

On the shape: about fifteen trainees a year at the same pay as firms that take seventy or a hundred. At the masterclass, [trainee or partner name] told me [one specific thing], which made that concrete.

And it's a firm making deliberate choices. It grew London by 20% last year without merging, while competitors like Cadwalader chose to combine. I'd rather join a firm with a clear strategy than one in the middle of integration."

Sources: [S139][S148][S194][S190][S310][S16][S302][S240].

The close: one thing you want to work on

PICK ONE AND MAKE IT YOURS

Derivatives: "The thing I most want to work on is derivatives: the team acts for ISDA itself, so a trainee sees how the market's standard documents are made, not just used." [S316]

Risk transfer: "I'd most like to see a significant risk transfer deal from the inside. With Basel 3.1 arriving, it's where bank capital rules turn into legal work." [S190][S148]

Pensions buy-ins: "I'd like a seat in the pensions and insurance work. Buy-ins combine contract law, regulation and very human stakes: 35,000 Ford retirees' pensions." [S310]

What most candidates say versus what you can say

Most candidates	You
"A global firm with a diverse client base."	"Top tier in London for derivatives, ABL and trade finance; ISDA is a client."
"Strong in finance."	"London grew 20.5% in 2025, led by structured finance and private credit; 96 deals done jointly with New York."
"Great training, small intake."	"About 15 trainees; the training principal trained here herself, from trainee in 2005 to partner in 2020."

Most candidates	You
"Friendly culture."	"Trainees grade partner approachability A*, and the Ford deal shows partners from different groups leading together."
"Matches Magic Circle pay."	(Don't say it.)
"Interested in AI."	"The firm made human review of every AI output mandatory. I'd like to understand how that's taught."
"It has a long history."	"London is the old Rowe & Maw practice, 130 years in the City, not a US outpost."

Sources: [S139][S316][S302][S16][S63][S13][S310][S230][S70][S222].

The honest counter-case

Know these so a partner can't surprise you, and so you don't overclaim:

- It is the smallest firm by revenue in its peer set, and its London PEP is not top [S220][S78].
- London securitisation and pensions are tier 2, and M&A is tier 6 [S141][S145][S146].
- Hunton overtook it as the leading US ABS issuer counsel by deal count in 2025 [S124].
- Pay is below the top US firms [S120].
- Asia is smaller since 2024 [S70].
- Trainees grade legal tech C [S13].
- A small intake means fewer NQ roles in each practice; retention is 80% [S16].

IF THEY PUSH THE COUNTER-CASE

"That's fair, and I'm not applying because it's the biggest. I'm applying because the things it chose to be best at are the things I want to learn, and the cohort is small enough that I'd actually learn them."

Mayer Brown × SEO Masterclass · cheat sheet

Mon 2 Nov 2026 · 2-6pm · London · Business smart · keep travel receipts (≤£150)

The protocol (45-75 seconds)

1 Steady breathe, restate in one line · **2 Sort** name the tension, rank it · **3 Act** who, what, by when · **4 Close** one principle, stop.

Priority order

1 Rules and the firm's name → 2 the client, served fairly → 3 the process and the record → 4 speed.
"Rules and the client first, keep the record straight, then as fast as that allows."

Never

Say "Brown & Wood" · call Van Gorp managing partner · say Mayer Brown leads London securitisation or pensions (tier 2) · say it pays US rates · claim "biggest in Hong Kong" · mention pay as a motive · repeat anything said off the record · call the Aug 2026 incident a hack · badmouth a rival.

Counters to frame-breaking

Interrupted: "Sure," answer, then finish in one line · Contradicted: "Which part?" update on facts only · Silence: don't fill it · Escalation: same order, faster · Authority: "I'd do it, and raise it with them first" · False choice: "I don't think they conflict here..." · Don't know: "Not yet; from first principles..." · Badmouth: praise rival precisely, state your fit.

Ask one of these

"Derivatives reached the Legal 500 top tier this year: how much is transatlantic, and where do trainees fit?" · "Basel 3.1 starts 1 Jan: are you seeing more risk transfer work?" · "How do the new leveraged finance teams fit with the bank-side practices?"

Why Mayer Brown (30 seconds)

Work: London top tier in derivatives, asset-based lending, trade finance. Shape: ~15 trainees, real work. Moment: London +20.5% by going "deeper with fewer clients"; Basel 3.1 drives risk transfer, where the firm is SRT Law Firm of the Year.

Numbers if asked

Global revenue 2025	\$2.17bn (+~10%)
Profit per equity partner	\$3.196m (+14.5%)
London revenue 2025	\$268.2m (+20.5%, record)
London lawyers	~264; LLP turnover £185.7m (FY Apr 2025)
Clients billed	6,316 (from 7,600)
Trainees / pay	~15 a year; £56k / £61k; NQ £150k; 80% kept
Legal 500 UK 2027	47 areas; 5 top tier
Vac scheme deadline	4 Dec 2026 ; TC 31 Mar 2027
Bank Rate	3.75% (6-3 hold, 17 Sep); next 5 Nov
Basel 3.1	1 Jan 2027
SQE1 pass rate	42% (July 2026)

People

Chair **Jon Van Gorp** · MP **Jeremy Clay** · London MP **Chris Harvey** (real estate, from 1 Oct 2026) · ex-London MP **Dominic Griffiths** (structured finance, now Mgmt Committee) · Training Principal **Miriam Bruce** (trainee 2005, partner 2020) · B&F co-head **Alex Dell** · Derivatives **Ed Parker**

History in one line

Chicago 1881 (Kraus & Mayer) · London Rowe & Maw 1895 · combined 2002 · "Mayer Brown" 2007 · JSM Hong Kong 2008-2024.

Three stories to know

Ford £4.6bn buy-in (Oct 2025): insurance + pensions partners together · Securitisation reform consultation (17 Feb 2026) · Lev fin team from Baker McKenzie (1 Sep 2026).

Sources for every figure: Parts 2, 4, 7 and the source table. Calm: breathe out longer than in; pause before answering, not during.

PART 14

Glossary

Every term used in this pack, in plain English.

Term	Meaning
ABS (asset-backed securities)	Bonds paid from a pool of loans or receivables, such as car loans or credit cards.
ABS (alternative business structure)	A law firm that non-lawyers may own or invest in, allowed in England and Wales since the Legal Services Act 2007.
Acquisition finance	Loans used to buy a company.
AFA (alternative fee arrangement)	Any pricing other than the hourly rate: fixed fees, caps, success fees.
Am Law 100	The American Lawyer's annual ranking of the 100 largest US law firms by revenue.
AML / KYC	Anti-money laundering checks; "know your client" identity checks before taking a client on.
Asset-based lending (ABL)	Loans secured on a borrower's assets such as receivables, inventory or equipment.
Assessment centre	A day of exercises (written, group, interview) used to choose vacation schemers or trainees.
Basel 3.1	The final set of global bank capital rules; in the UK from 1 January 2027 (PRA PS1/26).
Billable hour	Time recorded to a client matter and charged at an hourly rate.
BPA (bulk purchase annuity)	An insurance policy that covers pensions for many members of a scheme; a buy-in or buy-out.
Bundle	The indexed set of documents prepared for a court hearing.
Buy-in / buy-out	A pension scheme insures its pensions with an insurer; in a buy-out members become the insurer's policyholders.
CLO (collateralised loan obligation)	A securitisation of leveraged loans.
CMBS	Commercial mortgage-backed securities: bonds backed by loans on commercial property.
COLP / COFA	The firm's Compliance Officer for Legal Practice and Compliance Officer for Finance and Administration, required by the SRA.
Conditions precedent (CPs)	Things that must be delivered or done before a loan can be drawn or a deal can close.
Conflict of interest	Where acting for one client would harm another or the firm's own interest; firms must not act (SRA Code 6.2).
Counsel	A senior lawyer rank between senior associate and partner.
Derivative	A contract whose value depends on something else, such as an interest rate; used to hedge risk.
Disclosure	In litigation, showing the other side relevant documents.
Due diligence	Investigating a company or asset before a deal to find risks.
Equity partner	An owner of the firm who shares the profit.
Fact-find	An assessment exercise where you question an assessor to gather facts and then advise.
FCA / PRA	Financial Conduct Authority (conduct regulator) and Prudential Regulation Authority (bank and insurer safety, part of the Bank of England).
FLK1 / FLK2	The two multiple-choice "functioning legal knowledge" exams that make up SQE1.
FSMA 2023	The Financial Services and Markets Act 2023, which replaced retained EU financial rules with UK rules.
Gilt	A UK government bond.
High yield bond	A bond issued by a riskier company, paying a higher interest rate.
In-house lawyer	A lawyer employed by a company rather than a law firm; usually the client.
Information barrier	Controls that stop confidential information passing between teams in a firm.
Insider dealing	Trading on price-sensitive information that isn't public; a crime under the Criminal Justice Act 1993.
ISDA	The International Swaps and Derivatives Association, which publishes the standard derivatives contracts.

Term	Meaning
Lateral hire	A partner or lawyer who joins from another firm.
Leverage	(Law firm) lawyers per partner. (Finance) borrowing relative to equity.
Leveraged finance	Lending to companies with high debt, often for private equity buyouts.
Liability management exercise	Reshaping a company's debt outside court.
LIBOR	The old benchmark interest rate, ended 30 September 2024.
LLP	Limited liability partnership: the legal form of most UK law firms; partners are "members".
Lock-up	Time between doing work and being paid for it.
Lockstep	Partner pay by seniority rather than by individual performance.
Magic Circle	Five London-headquartered elite firms: A&O Shearman, Clifford Chance, Freshfields, Linklaters, Slaughter and May.
Mansfield certification	A diversity programme measuring whether firms consider diverse candidates for leadership roles.
NQ	Newly qualified solicitor.
Partner	A senior lawyer who owns (equity) or holds the title of owner (non-equity) in the firm.
PEP	Profit per equity partner: net income divided by the number of equity partners.
PGDL	Postgraduate Diploma in Law: the law conversion course for non-law graduates.
PII	Professional indemnity insurance: covers claims by clients for negligent advice.
Private credit	Lending by investment funds rather than banks.
Private equity (PE)	Funds that buy companies, usually with borrowed money, to sell later.
Privilege	The right to keep legal advice confidential from the other side and the court.
Pro bono	Free legal work for people or charities who can't pay.
PRT (pension risk transfer)	Moving pension obligations to an insurer: buy-ins, buy-outs, longevity swaps.
QWE	Qualifying work experience: two years needed to qualify via the SQE.
Realisation	The share of recorded time that is actually billed and paid.
Retention	The share of trainees kept on as NQs.
Risk retention	The rule that a securitisation's originator keeps at least 5% of the risk.
Seat	A six-month placement in one practice group during a training contract.
Securitisation	Pooling loans and selling bonds backed by them.
Silver Circle	Informal label for elite UK firms just below the Magic Circle.
SPV	Special purpose vehicle: a company set up only to hold assets for a deal.
SQE	Solicitors Qualifying Examination (SQE1 and SQE2), required since 1 September 2021.
SRA	Solicitors Regulation Authority: regulates solicitors and law firms in England and Wales.
SRT (significant risk transfer)	A bank deal that moves credit risk to investors to reduce capital needs.
STS	"Simple, transparent and standardised" securitisation with lighter capital treatment.
Superfund	A consolidator that takes over pension schemes without a full insurance buy-out.
Syndicated loan	A loan made by a group of banks, run by an agent bank.
Trade finance	Financing for buying and selling goods across borders.
Training contract	A firm's two-year trainee programme; counts as QWE.
True sale	A sale of assets that would survive the seller's insolvency.
UCC-3	A US filing that amends or terminates a public record of a lender's security.
UK MAR	The UK Market Abuse Regulation: bans insider dealing, unlawful disclosure and market manipulation.
UKEF	UK Export Finance: the government agency that guarantees loans supporting UK exports.
Utilisation	The share of available time that is billed.
Vacation scheme	A paid placement of one to two weeks that serves as an extended interview.

Term	Meaning
Verein	A Swiss association structure some global firms use; Mayer Brown uses "associated practices" instead.
WIP	Work in progress: time recorded but not yet billed.

PART 15

Source table

Every [Sxx] marker in this pack, 317 sources in all. Accessed 8 October 2026 unless noted.

Status: FETCHED (read in full), SNIPPET (search result text only), PAYWALLED (not read beyond what is stated), SUPPLIED (text given by the candidate).

ID ranges by workstream: S1-S39 role and process; S40-S69 and S280-S299 London office and people; S70-S119 the firm as a business; S120-S149 competition; S150-S219 industry and regulation; S220-S259 live news; S300-S339 why Mayer Brown; S340-S344 scenario playbook. A few facts appear under more than one ID because two workstreams read the same page.

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL	Status	Confidence note
S1	Mayer Brown (mayerbrown.com)	London Vacation Schemes - Program Overview	Undated (2027 cycle)	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/careers/students-and-graduates/europe/london-vacation-schemes	FETCHED	Primary; high confidence
S2	Mayer Brown (mayerbrown.com)	London Training Contract - Program Overview	Undated (2028/2029 intakes)	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/careers/students-and-graduates/europe/london-training-contract	FETCHED	Primary; high confidence; no salary or numbers stated
S3	Mayer Brown (mayerbrown.com)	Our Opportunities - Students and Graduates, Europe	Undated (2026-27)	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/careers/students-and-graduates/europe	FETCHED	Primary; high confidence
S4	Mayer Brown (mayerbrown.com)	London office location page	Undated	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/about-us/locations/london	FETCHED	Primary; marketing text
S5	Mayer Brown (mayerbrown.com)	Mayer Brown Promotes 57 Lawyers to Partners and Counsel	2025-11-20	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2025/11/mayer-brown-promotes-57-lawyers-to-partners-and-counsel	FETCHED	Primary; high confidence
S6	Mayer Brown (mayerbrown.com)	Life of a finance trainee at Mayer Brown: commercial awareness in practice (Zhi Yung Foo)	2026-01-15	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/insights/publications/2026/01/life-of-a-finance-trainee-at-mayer-brown-commercial-awareness-in-practice	FETCHED	Intro only; full text is on LawCareers.Net and was not located
S7	The Forage	Mayer Brown: Introduction to Finance	Undated	https://www.theforage.com/simulations/mayer-brown/introduction-to-finance-du23	FETCHED	Firm-sponsored; high confidence on content
S8	SEO London	Homepage	Undated (2024-25 impact stats)	https://www.seo-london.org/	FETCHED	Primary; no Mayer Brown mention
S9	SEO London	SEO Careers	Undated	https://www.seo-london.org/careers	FETCHED	Primary; general, not firm-specific
S10	SEO London	Programmes / Industries	Undated	https://www.seo-london.org/programmes-industries	FETCHED	Primary; eligibility confirmed
S11	SEO London	Our Sponsors	Undated	https://www.seo-london.org/our-sponsors	FETCHED	Logos mostly unlabelled; absence of Mayer Brown not conclusive
S12	Solicitors Regulation Authority	SRA Code of Conduct for Solicitors, RELs and RFLs	Current version	https://www.sra.org.uk/solicitors/standards-regulations/code-conduct-solicitors/	FETCHED	Primary regulator; high confidence
S13	Legal Cheek	Mayer Brown firm profile (Firms Most List)	2026-27 edition (undated page)	https://www.legalcheek.com/firm/mayer-brown/	FETCHED	Survey-based; training contract deadline 31/01/2027 conflicts with firm's 31/03/2027
S14	Legal Cheek	Mayer Brown matches Magic Circle NQ pay at £150k	2025-07-31	https://www.legalcheek.com/2025/07/mayer-brown-matches-magic-circle-nq-pay-at-150k/	FETCHED	Reported; high confidence on NQ figure
S15	Legal Cheek	Exclusive data: Inside the working hours of junior lawyers at 110 top law firms	2026-09-23	https://www.legalcheek.com/2026/09/exclusive-data-inside-the-working-hours-of-junior-lawyers-at-110-top-law-firms/	FETCHED	Self-reported survey averages
S16	Chambers Student	Mayer Brown - firm profile / True Picture (training contract review 2027)	2026	https://chambers.com/student/law-firm/mayer-brown	FETCHED	Independent trainee interviews; high confidence; "Get Hired" tab body not retrieved
S17	LawCareers.Net	Mayer Brown International LLP profile	2026-27	https://www.lawcareers.net/Solicitors/Mayer-Brown-International-LLP	FETCHED	Firm-supplied content; high confidence
S18	Legal 500 Future Lawyers	Mayer Brown - Survey results and trainee profile	2026-27	https://www.legal500.com/future-lawyers/profiles/mayer-brown/	FETCHED	Firm-supplied plus survey; diversity figures differ from S13
S19	AllAboutLaw	Training contracts - direct training contract route (Mayer Brown)	2026-27	https://www.allaboutlaw.co.uk/law-jobs/job/2609021128/training-contracts-direct-training-contract-route	FETCHED	Job listing; consistent with S2
S20	TARGETjobs	Mayer Brown International LLP organisation page	Undated	https://targetjobs.co.uk/organisations/mayer-brown-international-llp	FETCHED	Firm-supplied text
S21	The Corporate Law Academy (forum)	Mayer Brown Interview 2019-2020	2020-03-27 posts	https://www.thecorporatelawacademy.com/forum/threads/mayer-brown-interview-2019-2020.2288/latest	FETCHED	ANECDOTAL forum; dated; format may have changed
S22	The Corporate Law Academy (forum)	Mayer Brown - Spring Vacation Scheme 2026	2025-09-11/15	https://www.thecorporatelawacademy.com/forum/posts/216786/	FETCHED	ANECDOTAL; 3 posts only

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL	Status	Confidence note
S23	The Lawyer	LIVE: Trainee retention 2025	2025	https://www.thelawyer.com/live-trainee-retention-2025/	PAYWALLED-NOT-READ (403); search snippet only	8 of 10 autumn and 4 of 5 March figures are from snippet; medium-low confidence
S24	Global Legal Post	Mayer Brown pairs demure retention result with NQ pay boost / Mayer Brown struggles to retain NQs in London	Undated in results	https://www.globallegalpost.com/news/mayer-brown-pairs-demure-retention-result-with-nq-pay-boost-47664870	SNIPPET (403 on fetch)	Year of 55% figure unconfirmed
S25	Bright Network	Training Contract London 2029 (Mayer Brown)	2026	https://www.brightnetwork.co.uk/graduate-jobs/mayer-brown/training-contract-london-2029	SNIPPET (403 on fetch)	Seat list and supervision quote from snippet
S26	Bright Network	Vacation Scheme London 2027 / 2025 (Mayer Brown)	2025-26	https://www.brightnetwork.co.uk/graduate-jobs/mayer-brown/vacation-scheme-london-2027	SNIPPET	45-minute simulation detail from 2025 listing; medium confidence
S27	Aspiring Solicitors	Social Mobility with Mayer Brown	2026	https://www.aspiringsolicitors.co.uk/opportunities/social-mobility-with-mayer-brown/	SNIPPET	7 Oct 2026 event at Mayer Brown London office
S28	Law Gazette	City firm announces first articulated apprenticeship	2015	https://lawgazette.co.uk/practice/city-firm-announces-first-articled-apprenticeship/5049134.article	SNIPPET	Historic link to SEO London
S29	Bright Network	Vacation Schemes 2021 (Mayer Brown)	2020-21	https://brightnetwork.co.uk/graduate-jobs/mayer-brown/vacation-schemes-2021	SNIPPET	Names SEO as partner; dated
S30	Nonbillable	Mayer Brown promotes four in London in 36-partner global round	2025-11	https://www.nonbillable.co.uk/news/mayer-brown-partner-promotions-2025	SNIPPET	"three to five" historical range
S31	Clio UK	Climbing the Ladder: Understanding Law Firm Hierarchy and Career Progression in the UK	Undated	https://www.clio.com/uk/blog/law-firm-hierarchy/	SNIPPET (403 on fetch)	Generic, not firm-specific
S32	University of Cambridge talks	SEO London listing	2008	https://talks.cam.ac.uk/talk/index/15217	SNIPPET	Very old
S33	The Corporate Law Academy (forum)	SEO London Corporate Law Programme 2020-2021	c.2020	https://thecorporatelawacademy.com/forum/threads/seo-london-corporate-law-programme-2020-2021.2573/post-111321	SNIPPET	ANECDOTAL
S34	Legal Cheek	In-person workshop and networking evening in London with Bird & Bird, Forsters, Mayer Brown and ULaw	Undated	https://www.legalcheek.com/event/in-person-workshop-and-networking-evening-in-london-with-bird-bird-forsters-mayer-brown-and-the-university-of-law	SNIPPET	Event listing only
S35	Legal Cheek	Mayer Brown trainee pay rise (2022, "Rise for rookies too")	c.2022	https://www.legalcheek.com/?p=171272	SNIPPET	Historic trainee pay; URL/title pairing low confidence
S36	AllAboutLaw	Insight events - London First Year Insight Event (virtual)	2026-27	https://www.allaboutlaw.co.uk/law-jobs/job/2609091617/insight-events-london-first-year-insight-event-virtual-	SNIPPET	Closing 1 Feb 2027 vs firm's 31 Jan
S37	University of Brighton careers blog	City Solicitors Horizon Programme with SEO London	2017-10-16	https://blogs.brighton.ac.uk/careers/2017/10/16/city-solicitors-horizon-programme-with-seo-london	SNIPPET	Dated eligibility
S38	Legal Cheek	Mayer Brown firm profile (2025-26 hours edition, via search)	2025-26	https://www.legalcheek.com/firm/Mayer-Brown/	SNIPPET	Prior-year 09:02-20:42 figures; superseded by S15
S39	AllAboutLaw	Training contracts - London solicitor apprenticeship (Mayer Brown)	2026-27	https://www.allaboutlaw.co.uk/law-jobs/job/2609091609/training-contracts-london-solicitor-apprenticeship	SNIPPET	ABB; Feb 2027 deadline
S40	Companies House	MAYER BROWN INTERNATIONAL LLP overview (OC303359)	live register	https://find-and-update.company-information.service.gov.uk/company/OC303359	FETCHED	Primary; registered office, incorporation, former name, accounts dates
S41	Companies House	MAYER BROWN INTERNATIONAL LLP – People (officers)	live register	https://find-and-update.company-information.service.gov.uk/company/OC303359/officers	FETCHED	Primary; 103 active members counted across all pages; includes non-London members; DOBs deliberately not used
S42	Companies House	MAYER BROWN INTERNATIONAL LLP – Filing history (LLAP01/LLTM01)	live register	https://find-and-update.company-information.service.gov.uk/company/OC303359/filing-history	FETCHED	Primary; joins and leaves are register events, not reasons for moving
S43	Companies House (filed accounts)	MBI LLP Group accounts made up to 30 April 2025 (filed 16 Jan 2026)	2026-01-16	https://find-and-update.company-information.service.gov.uk/company/OC303359/filing-history/MzQ5OTUyNjg2MWFkXkF6a2N4/document?format=pdf&download=0	FETCHED	Primary; scanned PDF read visually (pp. 2-3, 9, 24-25); covers England and Japan
S44	Mayer Brown	Legal and regulatory notices	n/d (live)	https://www.mayerbrown.com/legal-notices/legal-and-regulatory	FETCHED	Firm-primary; SRA 369822
S45	Solicitors Regulation Authority	Scam alert: Mayer Brown International LLP	2024-11	https://www.sra.org.uk/consumers/scam-alerts/2024/nov/mayer-brown-international-llp/	FETCHED	Regulator-primary; confirms authorisation and address (no SRA ID on page)
S46	GOV.UK Gender pay gap service	Downloadable data 2023/2024/2025 (MBI LLP rows)	2024-04-04 / 2025-04-04 / 2026-04-02 submissions	https://gender-pay-gap.service.gov.uk/viewing/download-data/2025	FETCHED	Primary; the "2025" file is the 5 Apr 2025 snapshot; files for 2023 and 2024 also used
S47	Mayer Brown	UK Gender Pay Gap Report: 2025 (PDF)	2026-04	https://www.mayerbrown.com/-/media/files/diversity/gender-pay-gap-2025.pdf	FETCHED	Firm-primary; signed by D Griffiths; employees only

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL	Status	Confidence note
S48	Mayer Brown	Chris Harvey appointed Managing Partner of Mayer Brown's London office	2026-09-28	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/09/chris-harvey-appointed-managing-partner-of-mayer-browns-london-office	FETCHED	Firm-primary
S49	Mayer Brown	London office page	live	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/about-us/locations/london	FETCHED	Firm-primary; office leaders, CSR pillars
S50	Non-Billable	Mayer Brown London revenue jumps 20% to \$268m in bumper year	2026-04-27	https://www.nonbillable.co.uk/news/mayer-brown-london-revenue-jumps-20-percent-million-2025	FETCHED	Trade press; consistent with S48 and S52
S51	Legal Business	'We are not an outpost' – Mayer Brown City head on the firm's plans for London	2026-04-30	https://www.legalbusiness.co.uk/law-firms/we-are-not-an-outpost-mayer-brown-city-head-on-the-firms-plans-for-london/	PAYWALLED	Intro only read (paywalled after the intro); body PAYWALLED-NOT-READ
S52	Solicitors Journal	Mayer Brown London achieves record revenue	2026-05-08	https://www.solicitorsjournal.com/sjarticle/mayer-brown-london-achieves-record-revenue	FETCHED	Trade press
S53	Mayer Brown (reprint of The American Lawyer)	Mayer Brown grew revenue about 10% in year of repositioning	2026-03-25	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/03/mayer-brown-grew-revenue-about-10-in-year-of-repositioning	FETCHED	Reported (Am Law); source of the 264 London lawyers figure
S54	Mayer Brown	The Legal 500 UK 2027 ranks Mayer Brown in 47 practice areas and recognises 74 lawyers	2026-09-30	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/10/the-legal-500-uk-2027-ranks-mayer-brown-in-47-practice-areas-and-recognises-74-lawyers-in-individual-rankings	FETCHED	Firm-primary summary of the directory
S55	Mayer Brown	Legal 500 UK 2027 – full list of rankings (PDF)	2026-10-01	https://www.mayerbrown.com/-/media/files/uploads/legal-500-uk-2027-full-list-of-rankings.pdf	FETCHED	Firm-primary; individual categories; tiers not given beyond Tier 1
S56	Mayer Brown	Chambers UK 2026 ranks 27 Mayer Brown practices and 56 lawyers	2025-10-16	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2025/10/chambers-uk-2026-ranks-27-mayer-brown-practices-and-56-lawyers	FETCHED	Firm-primary
S57	Chambers and Partners	Mayer Brown LLP – UK 2026 firm profile	2025-10 (guide)	https://chambers.com/law-firm/mayer-brown-llp-uk-1:3690	FETCHED	Directory; London tables only; UK-wide tables (e.g. ABL) not shown; 10 of 35 individuals hidden behind "View all"
S58	Mayer Brown	London Training Contract – Program Overview	live (2026 cycle)	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/careers/students-and-graduates/europe/london-training-contract	FETCHED	Firm-primary
S59	Chambers Student	Mayer Brown training contract review 2027	2026 (n/d)	https://chambers.com/student/law-firm/mayer-brown	FETCHED	Directory; names M Bruce as training principal
S60	Legal Cheek	Mayer Brown firm profile	live (2026-27 survey)	https://www.legalcheek.com/firm/mayer-brown/	FETCHED	Directory; diversity and pay figures
S61	LawCareers.Net	Mayer Brown International LLP profile	live (n/d)	https://lawcareers.net/Solicitors/Mayer-Brown-International-LLP	FETCHED	Directory; 98 partners / 550 staff; diversity schemes incl. SEO London; contact K Bennett
S62	Mayer Brown	The Lawyer recognises Miriam Bruce in Hot 100 2026	2026-01-26	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/01/the-lawyer-recognises-miriam-bruce-in-hot-100-2026	FETCHED	Firm-primary
S63	Mayer Brown	People: Miriam Bruce	live	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/people/b/bruce-miriam	FETCHED	Firm-primary; some ranking labels out of date
S64	Mayer Brown	People: Chris Harvey	live	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/people/h/harvey-chris	FETCHED	Firm-primary; no education listed
S65	Mayer Brown	People: Dominic Griffiths	live	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/people/g/griffiths-dominic	FETCHED	Firm-primary
S66	Mayer Brown	People: Alex Dell	live	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/people/d/dell-alex	FETCHED	Firm-primary
S67	Mayer Brown	People: Edmund Parker	live	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/people/p/parker-edmund	FETCHED	Firm-primary
S68	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown further strengthens its market-leading finance team with lateral team hire	2026-09-01	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/09/mayer-brown-further-strengthens-its-market-leading-finance-team-with-lateral-team-hire	FETCHED	Firm-primary
S69	Non-Billable	Mayer Brown continues Baker McKenzie raid with Brussels team hire	2026-09-07	https://www.nonbillable.co.uk/news/mayer-brown-baker-mckenzie-raid-brussels-team-hire	FETCHED	Trade press; lists 2025-26 London laterals
S70	Mayer Brown	Firm history (timeline)	undated, live page	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/information/firm-history	FETCHED	Primary; founding and merger dates
S71	The American Lawyer (reprint on mayerbrown.com)	Mayer Brown Grew Revenue About 10% in Year of 'Repositioning'	2026-03-25	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/03/mayer-brown-grew-revenue-about-10-in-year-of-repositioning	FETCHED	Self-reported Am Law data; high confidence as reported
S72	The American Lawyer (reprint on mayerbrown.com)	Mayer Brown's Revenue Grows to \$1.98B, PEP Rises 14%	2025-04-03	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2025/04/mayer-browns-revenue-grows-to-198b-pep-rises-14	FETCHED	Self-reported Am Law data
S73	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown Chair Jon Van Gorp Reelected to Second Three-Year Term	2024-06-04	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2024/06/mayer-brown-chair-jon-van-gorp-reelected-to-second-three-year-term	FETCHED	Primary; FY2023 figures are the firm's own
S74	Mayer Brown	Leadership	live page	https://mayerbrown.com/en/about-us/leadership	FETCHED	Primary; current leadership
S75	Mayer Brown	Legal notices	live page	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/legal-notice	FETCHED	Primary; entity structure
S76	Mayer Brown	Legal and regulatory information	live page	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/legal-notice/legal-and-regulatory	FETCHED	Primary; SRA no., PII insurer, complaints

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL	Status	Confidence note
S77	Companies House	MAYER BROWN INTERNATIONAL LLP (OC303359) company overview and filing history	live register	https://find-and-update.company-information.service.gov.uk/company/OC303359	FETCHED	Primary statutory register
S78	Companies House	Mayer Brown International LLP, Group accounts made up to 30 April 2025 (38 pp; audited by RSM, signed 28 Oct 2025)	filed 2026-01-16	https://find-and-update.company-information.service.gov.uk/company/OC303359/filing-history/MzQ5OTUyNjg2MWFkaXF6a2N4/document?format=pdf&download=0	FETCHED	Primary audited; read from scanned page images (pp. 2-3, 8-9, 20-21, 24-25)
S79	Mayer Brown	About us	live page	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/about-us	FETCHED	Primary; self-description
S80	Mayer Brown	Chris Harvey appointed Managing Partner of Mayer Brown's London office	2026-09	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/09/chris-harvey-appointed-managing-partner-of-mayer-browns-london-office	FETCHED	Primary
S81	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown further strengthens its market-leading finance team with lateral team hire	2026-09-01	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/09/mayer-brown-further-strengthens-its-market-leading-finance-team-with-lateral-team-hire	FETCHED	Primary
S82	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown launches comprehensive GenAI curriculum to equip all lawyers with advanced AI skills	2026-04-14	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/04/mayer-brown-launches-comprehensive-genai-curriculum-to-equip-all-lawyers-with-advanced-ai-skills	FETCHED	Primary; names Harvey and Copilot
S83	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown launches cross-disciplinary AI task force to advise on business opportunities and risk mitigation	2023-09-07	https://www.mayerbrown.com/de/news/2023/09/mayer-brown-launches-cross-disciplinary-ai-task-force-to-advise-on-business-opportunities-and-risk-mitigation	SNIPPET	Primary but only snippet seen; 60+ lawyers and Raj De via Law360 snippet
S84	vLex/Mondaq (reprint, appears to be Am Law/Law.com reporting)	Intentional, Not Just Opportunistic: Inside Mayer Brown's Lateral Partner Strategy	2026-01-05	https://vlex.com/vid/intentional-not-just-opportunistic-1099653453	FETCHED	Reported; byline metadata unclear
S85	Bloomberg Law	Mayer Brown Splits From Hong Kong Unit Amid US-China Tension (2)	2024-05-02	https://news.bloomberglaw.com/business-and-practice/mayer-brown-to-split-from-hong-kong-office-amid-us-china-tension	FETCHED	Reported; reputable
S86	Bloomberg Law / Bloomberg Government (Mahira Dayal)	Mayer Brown's Van Gorp Is Sitting Out Trump's Big Law Fight	2025-07-11	https://news.bloomberglaw.com/bloomberg-government-news/mayer-browns-van-gorp-is-sitting-out-trumps-big-law-fight	FETCHED	Reported; reputable
S87	ABA Journal	Mayer Brown Merges With Hong Kong Firm	2007-12-21	https://abajournal.com/news/article/mayer_brown_merges_with_hong_kong_firm	FETCHED	Reported; contemporaneous
S88	Law.asia (Asia Business Law Journal)	Johnson Stokes & Master split from Mayer Brown takes effect	late 2024 (exact date not seen)	https://law.asia/johnson-stokes-master-mayer-brown-split/	SNIPPET	403 on fetch; headcounts 125/26 from snippet
S89	Global Legal Post	Mayer Brown exits Mexico City with trio of partners launching new firm	2024 (Oct/Nov)	https://www.globallegalpost.com/news/mayer-brown-exits-mexico-city-with-trio-of-partners-launching-new-firm-2102121408	SNIPPET	Reported
S90	Latin Lawyer	Mayer Brown closes in Mexico	2024	https://latinlawyer.com/article/mayer-brown-closes-in-mexico	PAYWALLED-NOT-READ	Snippet only
S91	Wikipedia	Mayer Brown	live page	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Mayer_Brown	FETCHED	Tertiary; used only where flagged
S92	Wikipedia	Brown & Wood	live page	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Brown_%26_Wood	SNIPPET	Tertiary; corroborates Sidley merger
S93	The Lawyer	Sidleys and Brown & Wood set for merger	2001-02-26	https://www.thelawyer.com/issues/26-february-2001/sidleys-and-brown-wood-set-for-merger/	SNIPPET	Contemporaneous legal press
S94	US Attorney's Office SDNY (DOJ)	Collins verdict press release	2012-11-16	https://www.justice.gov/archive/usao/nys/pressreleases/November12/CollinsVerdictPR.html	FETCHED	Primary (prosecution's account)
S95	US Attorney's Office SDNY (DOJ)	Joseph Collins sentencing press release	2013-07-15	https://www.justice.gov/archive/usao/nys/pressreleases/July13/JosephCollinsSentencingPR.php	FETCHED	Primary
S96	ABA Journal	2nd Circuit Axes Refco Lawyer's Conviction in \$2.4B Fraud Case, Says Judge Erred re Juror Note	2012-01	https://www.abajournal.com/news/article/2nd_circuit_reverses_conviction_for_refco_lawyer_says_judge_erred_in_handling	SNIPPET	Reported
S97	Studicata (case brief)	United States v. Collins, 581 F. App'x 59 (2d Cir. 2014)	2014	https://www.studicata.com/case-briefs/case/united-states-v-collins	SNIPPET	Secondary summary; opinion itself not read
S98	Cleary Gottlieb & Arnold & Porter alerts	Pacific Investment Mgmt Co. v. Mayer Brown LLP, 603 F.3d 144 (2d Cir. 2010)	2010-04/05	https://www.arnoldporter.com/en/perspectives/publications/2010/05/pacific-investment-mgmt-co-v-mayer-brown-the-second-circuit	SNIPPET	Reported; well-known holding
S99	Law360 (Max Stendahl)	Mayer Brown Settles Claims It Aided \$1.5B Refco Fraud	2013-06-19	https://law360.com/articles/451430	PAYWALLED	Lead paragraph read; amount undisclosed
S100	Law360 (Liz McKenzie)	Lawsuits Take Toll On Mayer Brown	2008-11-04	https://law360.com/articles/75486	PAYWALLED	Lead paragraph only; subject of 2005 settlement not visible
S101	WilmerHale client alert	In seminal decision New York Court of Appeals rejects attempt to expand scope of liability for professional service providers (Kirschner v. KPMG, 15 N.Y.3d 446)	2010-10-25	https://www.wilmerhale.com/insights/publications/in-seminal-decision-new-york-court-of-appeals-rejects-attempt-to-expand-scope-of-liability-for-professional-service-providers-october-25-2010	SNIPPET	Reported
S102	US Court of Appeals, 7th Cir. (via vLex)	Oakland Police & Fire Ret. Sys. v. Mayer Brown, LLP, 861 F.3d 644 (No. 16-2983)	2017-06-28	https://case-law.vlex.com/vid/884541849	FETCHED	Primary judgment text (excerpt)

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL	Status	Confidence note
S103	Capitol Services / ABI	A very costly UCC filing error (In re Motors Liquidation Co., 777 F.3d 100 (2d Cir. 2015))	~2015	https://www.capitol-services.com/a-very-costly-ucc-filing-error/	SNIPPET	Secondary summary of 2d Cir. ruling
S104	Courthouse News	Law firm not liable for \$1.5B loan gaffe	2017	https://www.courthousenews.com/law-firm-not-liable-1-5b-loan-gaffe/	SNIPPET	Reported; corroborates S102
S105	Non-Billable (Rachel Scepanovic)	Big Law hackers pocket \$50m in ransoms this year as fresh breaches emerge	2026-08-10	https://www.nonbillable.co.uk/news/big-law-hackers-luna-moth-data-breach-law-firms	FETCHED	Reported; includes firm statement
S106	DeXpose (threat-intel blog)	SilentRansomGroup Breaches Mayer Brown	2026-08	https://www.dexpose.io/?p=40500	SNIPPET	Low reliability; relays group's own claim
S107	Legal Cheek	Exclusive: Extra £15k, Mayer Brown matches Magic Circle NQ pay at £150k	2025-07	https://www.legalcheek.com/2025/07/mayer-brown-matches-magic-circle-nq-pay-at-150k/amp/	FETCHED	Reported
S108	Legal Cheek	Mayer Brown firm profile	live page	https://www.legalcheek.com/firm/Mayer-Brown/	SNIPPET	Reported; trainee pay, TCs, retention
S109	AllAboutLaw	Training contracts: direct training contract route (Mayer Brown)	2026	https://www.allaboutlaw.co.uk/law-jobs/job/2609021128/training-contracts-direct-training-contract-route	SNIPPET	Reported; figures differ from S108
S110	Solicitors Regulation Authority	SRA Code of Conduct for Firms	current	https://www.sra.org.uk/solicitors/standards-regulations/code-conduct-firms/	FETCHED	Primary regulation
S111	The Standard (Hong Kong)	US law firm drops work on HKU statue removal after criticism	2021-10	https://www.thestandard.com.hk/news/article/181582/US-law-firm-drops-work-on-HKU-statue-removal-after-criticism	SNIPPET	Reported
S112	Mayer Brown	Friedrich Merz, Former Partner (profile)	live page	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/people/m/merz-friedrich	SNIPPET	Primary; senior counsel, Düsseldorf, until end-2021
S113	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown expands and strengthens New York presence with major office expansion	2025-02-03	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2025/02/mayer-brown-expands-and-strengthens-new-york-presence-with-major-office-expansion	SNIPPET	Primary, snippet
S114	Mayer Brown / FinanceAsia	Mayer Brown to enter joint law venture with PK Wong & Nair LLC in Singapore	2022-10	https://www.mayerbrown.com/de/news/2022/10/mayer-brown-to-enter-joint-law-venture-with-pk-wong-nair-llc-in-singapore	SNIPPET	Primary, snippet
S115	Original Jurisdiction (David Lat)	Running a global law firm: Chair Jon Van Gorp, Mayer Brown (podcast)	2026-01-14	https://davidlat.substack.com/p/running-a-global-law-firm-chair-jon-van-gorp-mayer-brown	PAYWALLED	Topics only (strategy plan, AI adoption, partner pay, Trump); transcript not read
S116	Legal Business	LLP latest: Mayer Brown sees revenue dip by 9.5% as Pinsents gains £20m from McGrigors merger	~2014-02	https://www.legalbusiness.co.uk/law-firms/blogs/llp-latest-mayer-brown-sees-revenue-dip-by-9-5-as-pinsents-gains-20m-from-mcgrigors-merger/	SNIPPET	Reported; historic UK LLP turnover
S117	LawFuel / The Lawyer	Boston buyout firm (Thomas H. Lee) suing Mayer Brown / MBRM faces action over Refco debt 'cover-up'	2007	https://www.thelawyer.com/issues/30-july-2007/dundas-revisits-shetland-role/	SNIPPET	Reported; outcome of THL suit not established
S118	National Law Review (press release)	2026 Am Law 100: Kirkland Hits \$10B, Wachtell Tops \$12M Partner Pay	2026-04	https://natlawreview.com/press-releases/2026-am-law-100-kirkland-hits-10b-wachtell-tops-12m-partner-pay	SNIPPET	Reported; Am Law 100 averages
S119	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown expands Tokyo office and global corporate & securities practice with the addition of partner Masahisa Ikeda	2026-02	https://www.mayerbrown.com/zh-hans/news/2026/02/mayer-brown-expands-tokyo-office-and-global-corporate-securities-practice-with-the-addition-of-partner-masahisa-ikeda	SNIPPET	Primary, snippet
S120	Legal Cheek	Exclusive data: what the UK's top law firms are paying newly qualified solicitors in 2027	Sep 2026 (exact day not shown)	https://www.legalcheek.com/2026/09/exclusive-data-what-the-uks-top-law-firms-are-paying-newly-qualified-solicitors-in-2027/amp/	FETCHED	HIGH; London NQ figures; author not stated
S121	Legal Cheek	Mayer Brown – Firms Most List profile (2026-27)	2026 (survey 2026-27)	https://www.legalcheek.com/firm/Mayer-Brown/	FETCHED	HIGH for pay/intake; financial FY not printed (matches FY2025 per S122)
S122	Legal Business	Mayer Brown rides 10% increase to break \$2bn in turnover for the first time (Eliza Winter)	27 Mar 2026	https://www.legalbusiness.co.uk/law-firms/mayer-brown-rides-10-increase-to-break-2bn-in-turnover-for-the-first-time/	FETCHED (opening paragraphs; rest PAYWALLED-NOT-READ)	HIGH for headline figures
S123	Mayer Brown (reprint of The American Lawyer)	Mayer Brown grew revenue about 10% in year of repositioning	25 Mar 2026	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/03/mayer-brown-grew-revenue-about-10-in-year-of-repositioning	FETCHED	HIGH; includes chair quotes and Asia/London headcounts
S124	Asset-Backed Alert (PDF hosted by Hunton)	Asset-Backed Alert law firm rankings 2025	early 2026	https://hunton.sitepilot11.firmseek.com/assets/htmldocuments/Asset-Backed-Alert-LawFirmRankings_Hunton-2025.pdf	SNIPPET	MEDIUM; third-party-hosted copy, read via search snippet only
S125	Sartori & Partners (reprints ALM Am Law 100 2026 via Above the Law)	Am Law 100 2026 table	11 Sep 2026 (underlying data 14–15 Apr 2026)	https://sartoriglobal.com/insights/market/am-law-100-2026-table/	FETCHED	MEDIUM; secondary reprint of Am Law data; rank inferred from order
S126	Legal Cheek	Hogan Lovells Cadwalader mega-merger goes live	1 Jul 2026	https://www.legalcheek.com/2026/07/hogan-lovells-cadwalader-mega-merger-goes-live/	FETCHED	HIGH
S127	law.asia (also Global Legal Post, SCMP)	Johnson Stokes & Master split from Mayer Brown takes effect	2024 (exact date not seen)	https://law.asia/johnson-stokes-master-mayer-brown-split/	SNIPPET (fetch returned 403)	MEDIUM; headcount figures vary by outlet
S128	Legal Cheek	Exclusive: Mayer Brown matches Magic Circle NQ pay at £150k	Jul 2025	https://www.legalcheek.com/2025/07/mayer-brown-matches-magic-circle-nq-pay-at-150k/amp/	FETCHED	HIGH

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL	Status	Confidence note
S129	Legal Cheek	Sidley Austin – Firms Most List profile	2026	https://www.legalcheek.com/firm/Sidley-Austin/	FETCHED	HIGH for pay/intake; financials converted by LC
S130	Legal Cheek	Latham & Watkins – Firms Most List profile	2026	https://www.legalcheek.com/firm/Latham-Watkins/	FETCHED	HIGH
S131	Legal Cheek	Kirkland & Ellis – Firms Most List profile	2026	https://www.legalcheek.com/firm/Kirkland-Ellis/	FETCHED	HIGH; trainee pay differs from Oct 2025 LC table (see Gaps)
S132	Legal Cheek	White & Case – Firms Most List profile	2026	https://www.legalcheek.com/firm/White-Case/	FETCHED	HIGH
S133	Legal Cheek	Clifford Chance – Firms Most List profile	2026	https://www.legalcheek.com/firm/Clifford-Chance/	FETCHED	HIGH; FY to Apr 2026 results (firm release 22 Jul 2026 seen as snippet)
S134	Legal Cheek	Hogan Lovells Cadwalader – Firms Most List profile	2026	https://www.legalcheek.com/firm/Hogan-Lovells/	FETCHED	HIGH; financials are pre-merger HL
S135	Legal Cheek	A&O Shearman – Firms Most List profile	2026	https://www.legalcheek.com/firm/AO-Shearman/	FETCHED	HIGH
S136	Legal Cheek	Norton Rose Fulbright – Firms Most List profile	2026	https://www.legalcheek.com/firm/Norton-Rose-Fulbright/	FETCHED	HIGH
S137	Legal Cheek	Baker McKenzie – Firms Most List profile	2026	https://www.legalcheek.com/firm/Baker-McKenzie/	FETCHED	HIGH
S138	Mayer Brown	Firm history	undated (current)	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/information/firm-history	FETCHED	HIGH (primary)
S139	Mayer Brown	The Legal 500 UK 2027 ranks Mayer Brown in 47 practice areas and recognises 74 lawyers in individual rankings	30 Sep 2026	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/10/the-legal-500-uk-2027-ranks-mayer-brown-in-47-practice-areas-and-recognises-74-lawyers-in-individual-rankings	FETCHED	HIGH (firm release; full PDF not read)
S140	Mayer Brown	Chambers UK 2026 ranks 27 Mayer Brown practices and 56 lawyers	16 Oct 2025	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2025/10/chambers-uk-2026-ranks-27-mayer-brown-practices-and-56-lawyers	FETCHED	HIGH (firm release; full PDF not read)
S141	The Legal 500	London > Finance > Securitisation	edition not printed (live page, 2026)	https://www.legal500.com/c/london/finance/securitisation/	FETCHED	MEDIUM on edition; HIGH on tiers as displayed
S142	The Legal 500	London > Finance > Derivatives and structured products	edition not printed (consistent with UK 2027 per S139)	https://www.legal500.com/c/london/finance/derivatives-and-structured-products/	FETCHED	HIGH
S143	The Legal 500	London > Finance > Trade finance	edition not printed	https://www.legal500.com/c/london/finance/trade-finance/	FETCHED	MEDIUM; extract returned only named firms, not full tier list
S144	The Legal 500	London > Finance > Asset based lending	edition not printed	https://www.legal500.com/c/london/finance/asset-based-lending/	FETCHED	HIGH
S145	The Legal 500	London > Employment > Pensions (non-contentious)	edition not printed	https://www.legal500.com/c/london/employment/pensions-non-contentious	FETCHED	HIGH
S146	The Legal 500	Mayer Brown International LLP – England rankings	edition not printed	https://www.legal500.com/firms/50636-mayer-brown-international	FETCHED	HIGH on tiers displayed
S147	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown earns top rankings in 2025 Asset-Backed Alert league tables	10 Feb 2026	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/02/mayer-brown-earns-top-rankings-in-2025-asset-backed-alert-league-tables	FETCHED	HIGH (firm-reported)
S148	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown secures double victory at 2026 GlobalCapital US Securitization Awards	18 May 2026	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/05/mayer-brown-secures-double-victory-at-2026-globalcapital-us-securitization-awards	FETCHED	MEDIUM-HIGH (firm-reported; GlobalCapital write-up is sponsored)
S149	Chambers Student	Mayer Brown – training contract review 2027 (True Picture)	2026 (2027 edition)	https://chambers.com/student/law-firm/mayer-brown	FETCHED	HIGH
S150	SRA	Becoming a solicitor with the Legal Practice Course (transitional requirements)	Updated 25 Nov 2025	https://www.sra.org.uk/become-solicitor/legal-practice-course-route/transitional-arrangements/	FETCHED	Primary; high
S151	SRA	Qualifying work experience: Questions and answers	Updated 3 Oct 2023	https://www.sra.org.uk/become-solicitor/sqe/qualifying-work-experience/qualifying-work-experience-candidate-sqa	FETCHED	Primary; high (the four-organisation limit comes from search context, not this page)
S152	SRA	News release: SQE approved by LSB	Oct 2020	https://www.sra.org.uk/sra/news/press/2020-press-release-archive/sqe-approved-lsb/	SNIPPET	Primary; high for the 1 Sep 2021 date
S153	SRA	News release: SQE first registration numbers	4 Oct 2021	https://consultations.sra.org.uk/sra/news/press/2021-press-releases/sqe-first-registration-numbers	SNIPPET	Primary; medium-high
S154	SRA	Index of SRA Standards and Regulations	Undated (Code updated 11 Apr 2025)	https://www.sra.org.uk/standards	SNIPPET	Primary; medium
S155	LawCareers.Net	SQE1 pass rate falls to 42% in latest sitting	6 Oct 2026	https://www.lawcareers.net/Explore/News/SQE1-pass-rate-falls-to-42-in-latest-sitting-06102026	FETCHED	Reports SRA statistics; high
S156	SRA	SQE1 January 2026 Statistical Report	31 Mar 2026	https://sqe.sra.org.uk/sqe-results/reports/sqe1-january-2026	SNIPPET	Primary; medium (not fetched)
S157	SRA	News release: SQE annual report 2024/25 (fees)	2025	https://www.sra.org.uk/sra/news/press/sqe-annual-report-24-25/	SNIPPET	Primary; medium

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL	Status	Confidence note
S158	Legal Cheek	SRA announces further SQE fees increase	Apr 2026	https://www.legalcheek.com/2026/04/sra-announces-further-sqe-fees-increase/	SNIPPET	Cites SRA board paper; medium
S159	Legal Cheek	SRA approves AI-driven law firm	6 May 2025	https://www.legalcheek.com/2025/05/sra-approves-ai-driven-law-firm/	FETCHED	Quotes SRA; high
S160	Dechert	Solicitors Regulation Authority authorizes UK's first AI-based law firm	Jun 2025	https://www.dechert.com/knowledge/re-torts/2025/6/solicitors-regulation-authority-authorizes-uk-s-first-ai-based-l.html	SNIPPET	Corroborates 6 May 2025 SRA release; medium-high
S161	Lawyer Monthly / Legal Services Consumer Panel	SRA client money notification consultation 2026; LSCP response	Jun 2026 / Aug 2026	https://www.lawyer-monthly.com/2026/06/sra-client-money-notification-consultation-2026/	SNIPPET	Single news source for June 2026 dates; low-medium
S162	Legal Futures	SRA to keep hands off client account interest – for now	2025	https://www.legalfutures.co.uk/latest-news/sra-to-keep-hands-off-client-account-interest-for-now/print	SNIPPET	Medium
S163	SRA	Population of solicitors in England and Wales	Jul 2026 data	https://www.sra.org.uk/sra/research-publications/regulation-community-statistics/data/population_solicitors/	SNIPPET	Primary but cached versions conflict; medium
S164	TheCityUK	UK legal services deliver record economic contribution and re-enforce global influence	9 Dec 2025	https://www.thecityuk.com/news/uk-legal-services-deliver-record-economic-contribution-and-re-enforce-global-influence/	FETCHED	Industry body; high
S165	Non-Billable (reporting Law Society)	English law demand grows as UK legal exports hit new highs	2025–26	https://www.nonbillable.co.uk/news/english-law-demand-grows-as-uk-legal-exports-hit-new-highs	SNIPPET	Secondary; medium; different measure from S164
S166	Legal Futures	Legal market to grow "in all areas" as PE extends reach	28 Jan 2026	https://www.legalfutures.co.uk/latest-news/legal-market-to-grow-in-all-areas-as-pe-extends-reach	FETCHED	Reports IRN report; medium
S167	Thomson Reuters Institute	2026 State of the UK Legal Market	20 May 2026	https://www.thomsonreuters.com/en/institute/articles/2026-uk-legal-market-report	FETCHED	Primary survey; high (some figures from snippet of PDF)
S168	Canadian Lawyer (reporting The Telegraph / Law.com)	US firms muscle Magic Circle firms off list of London's highest-earning firms	29 Jun 2026	https://www.canadianlawyermag.com/news/international/us-firms-muscle-magic-circle-firms-off-list-of-londons-highest-earning-firms/394290	FETCHED	Secondary of secondary; medium
S169	Legal Cheek	Mayer Brown matches Magic Circle NQ pay at £150k	Jul 2025	https://www.legalcheek.com/2025/07/mayer-brown-matches-magic-circle-nq-pay-at-150k/amp/	FETCHED	High
S170	Legal Cheek	Norton Rose Fulbright ups London NQ salary to £140k	6 May 2026	https://www.legalcheek.com/2026/05/norton-rose-fulbright-ups-london-nq-salary-to-140k/	FETCHED	High
S171	Legal Cheek	Ropes & Gray raises London NQ pay to £170k	Mar 2026	https://www.legalcheek.com/2026/03/ropes-gray-raises-london-nq-pay-to-170k/amp/	SNIPPET	Medium
S172	LawCareers.Net	Macfarlanes and DLA Piper raise NQ salaries as junior lawyer pay war reignites	2026	https://www.lawcareers.net/Explore/News/Macfarlanes-and-DLA-Piper-raise-NQ-salaries-as-junior-lawyer-pay-war-reignites	SNIPPET	Medium
S173	AllAboutLaw	Mayer Brown training contracts – direct training contract route	2026 listing	https://www.allaboutlaw.co.uk/law-jobs/job/2609021128/training-contracts-direct-training-contract-route	SNIPPET	Job board, not official; medium
S174	GlobeNewswire (A&O Shearman release)	A&O Shearman merger successfully completed	1 May 2024	https://www.globenewswire.com/fr/news-release/2024/05/01/2872988/0/en/A-O-SHEARMAN-MERGER-SUCCESSFULLY-COMPLETED.html	SNIPPET	Firm release; high
S175	Creamer Media / Leaders League	Herbert Smith Freehills Kramer officially launches	2 Jun 2025	https://newsletter.po.creamermedia.com/article/herbert-smith-freehills-kramer-officially-launches-2025-06-02	SNIPPET	Medium-high
S176	McDermott Will & Schulte	Merger debuts McDermott Will & Schulte, new legal powerhouse	4 Aug 2025	https://www.mcdermottlaw.com/news/mcdermott-will-schulte-new-legal-powerhouse/	SNIPPET	Firm release; medium-high
S177	Global Legal Post	Winston & Strawn, Taylor Wessing UK announce transatlantic merger	Jan 2026	https://www.globallegalpost.com/news/winston-strawn-taylor-wessing-uk-announce-transatlantic-merger-475014243	SNIPPET	Medium; launch unconfirmed
S178	MLex / Iberian Lawyer	Ashurst, Perkins Coie go live with 950-partner firm	Jun 2026	https://www.mlex.com/pulse/articles/2494733	SNIPPET (MLex PAYWALLED-NOT-READ)	Medium
S179	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown launches comprehensive GenAI curriculum to equip all lawyers with advanced AI skills	14 Apr 2026	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/04/mayer-brown-launches-comprehensive-genai-curriculum-to-equip-all-lawyers-with-advanced-ai-skills	FETCHED	Primary; high
S180	Bloomberg Law	Legal AI startup Harvey raises funds at \$11 billion valuation	Mar 2026	https://news.bloomberglaw.com/bloomberg-government-news/legal-ai-startup-harvey-raises-funds-at-11-billion-valuation	SNIPPET (PAYWALLED-NOT-READ)	Medium
S181	Pulse 2.0	Legora: \$550 million Series D at \$5.55 billion valuation	Mar 2026	https://pulse2.com/legora-550-million-series-d-at-5-55-billion-valuation-raised-for-collaborative-ai-legal-platform	SNIPPET	Medium; later valuations conflict
S182	Legal IT Insider	Latham & Watkins to roll out Harvey globally	2025	https://legaltechnology.com/latham-watkins-to-roll-out-harvey-globally/	SNIPPET	Medium
S183	Legal Futures	Susskind: Judgement will not save lawyers from march of AI	28 Sep 2026	https://www.legalfutures.co.uk/latest-news/susskind-judgement-will-not-save-lawyers-from-march-of-ai	FETCHED	High (opinion accurately reported)
S184	Legal Futures	Robot takeover of lawyers' work unlikely to be as far-reaching or as fast as predicted	5 Jan 2016	https://www.legalfutures.co.uk/latest-news/robot-takeover-of-lawyers-work-unlikely-to-be-as-far-reaching-or-as-fast-as-predicted/print/	FETCHED	Dated (pre-GenAI); medium
S185	Lawyer Monthly	AI breaking the law firm associate pyramid	Jan 2026	https://www.lawyer-monthly.com/2026/01/ai-breaking-law-firm-associate-pyramid/	SNIPPET	Opinion; low
S186	Sidley Austin	Private equity investment in US law firms: current models and recent developments	Nov 2025	https://www.sidley.com/en/insights/newsupdates/2026/03/private-equity-investment-in-us-law-firms-part-ii	SNIPPET	Medium

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL	Status	Confidence note
S187	Fox Rothschild	Private equity investment in law firms: navigating MSO structures	2026	https://www.foxrothschild.com/publications/private-equity-investment-in-law-firms-navigating-mso-structures-in-an-evolving-landscape	SNIPPET	Medium-low
S188	Georgetown Journal of Legal Ethics blog	KPMG's subsidiary law firm approved by Arizona Supreme Court	2025	https://www.law.georgetown.edu/legal-ethics-journal/blog/kpmgs-subsiary-law-firm-approved-by-arizona-supreme-court-to-provide-legal-services/	SNIPPET	Medium
S189	BTI Consulting Group	Law firms absolutely best at client service (Client Service 30, 2026)	2026	https://bticonsulting.com/themadclientist/law-firms-absolutely-best-at-client-service	SNIPPET	Medium; Mayer Brown position unverified
S190	Bank of England / PRA	PS1/26 – Implementation of Basel 3.1: Final rules	20 Jan 2026	https://www.bankofengland.co.uk/prudential-regulation/publication/2026/january/implementation-of-the-basel-3-1-final-rules-policy-statement	FETCHED	Primary; high
S191	Regulation Tomorrow (Norton Rose Fulbright)	PRA announces a delay to the implementation of Basel 3.1	Jan 2025	https://www.regulationtomorrow.com/2025/01/pr-announces-a-delay-to-the-implementation-of-basel-3-1/	SNIPPET	Medium
S192	legislation.gov.uk	The Securitisation Regulations 2024 (SI 2024/102), as made	Made 29 Jan 2024	https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukSI/2024/102/made	FETCHED	Primary; high (first 100k characters read)
S193	Dechert	Countdown to change: UK's new securitisation regime effective from 1 November 2024	May 2024	https://www.dechert.com/knowledge/onpoint/2024/5/countdown-to-change--uk-s-new-securitisation-regime-effective-fr.html	SNIPPET	Medium-high
S194	Mayer Brown	New proposals for reforming the UK securitisation framework	24 Feb 2026	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/insights/publications/2026/02/new-proposals-for-reforming-the-uk-securitisation-framework	FETCHED	Firm analysis of primary CPs; high
S195	Skadden	PRA and FCA consult on reforms to UK securitisation framework	Feb 2026	https://www.skadden.com/insights/publications/2026/02/pr-and-fca-consult-on-reforms-to-uk-securitisation-framework	SNIPPET	Medium
S196	Dechert	UK EMIR reporting changes: need to know with less than a month to go	Sep 2024	https://www.dechert.com/knowledge/onpoint/2024/9/uk-emir-reporting-changes--need-to-know-with-less-than-a-month-t.html	SNIPPET	Medium-high
S197	FCA	LIBOR transition (end of LIBOR)	2024	https://www.fca.org.uk/markets/libor-transition/printable/print	SNIPPET	Primary; high
S198	FCA	Market Watch 84 (UK EMIR Refit implementation)	Sep 2025	https://www.fca.org.uk/publications/newsletters/market-watch-84/printable/print	SNIPPET	Primary; medium
S199	Linklaters (PensionLinks)	Pension Schemes Act 2026	6 May 2026	https://www.linklaters.com/insights/blogs/pensionlinks/2026/may/pension-schemes-act-2026	FETCHED	High
S200	Clifford Chance	UK Pensions Update special edition: Pension Schemes Bill gains Royal Assent	30 Apr 2026	https://www.cliffordchance.com/content/dam/cliffordchance/briefings/2026/04/pension-scheme-bill-gains-royal-assent.pdf	FETCHED	High; source for the 29 Apr 2026 Royal Assent date ("yesterday")
S201	LCP	Record number of buy-ins in 2025 with the busiest H2 ever as competition intensifies	27 Mar 2026	https://www.lcp.com/en/media-centre/press-releases/record-number-of-buy-ins-in-2025-with-the-busiest-h2-ever-as-competition-intensifies	FETCHED	High
S202	Hymans Robertson	Record activity means risk transfer leaps past half a trillion milestone	2026	https://www.hymans.co.uk/media-centre-insights/record-activity-means-risk-transfer-leaps-past-half-a-trillion-milestone	SNIPPET	Medium
S203	GOV.UK (Home Office)	New failure to prevent fraud guidance published	6 Nov 2024	https://www.gov.uk/government/news/new-failure-to-prevent-fraud-guidance-published	FETCHED	Primary; high
S204	Clyde & Co	Failure to prevent fraud guidance published by UK Government	Nov 2024	https://www.clydeco.com/en/insights/2024/11/failure-to-prevent-fraud-guidance-published	SNIPPET	Medium (thresholds)
S205	Regulation Tomorrow	Economic Crime and Corporate Transparency Bill receives Royal Assent	Oct 2023	https://www.regulationtomorrow.com/2023/10/economic-crime-and-corporate-transparency-bill-receives-royal-assent/	SNIPPET	Medium-high
S206	Latham & Watkins	Leeds Reforms set UK government agenda for financial services	Jul 2025	https://www.lw.com/en/insights/2025/07/Leeds-Reforms-Set-UK-Government-Agenda-for-Financial-Services	SNIPPET	Medium
S207	Macfarlanes	The Mansion House Accord and its impact on private capital markets	2025	https://www.macfarlanes.com/insights/102loh5/the-mansion-house-accord-and-its-impact-on-private-capital-markets/	SNIPPET	Medium
S208	Bank of England	Bank of England launches system-wide exploratory scenario exercise focused on private markets	4 Dec 2025	https://www.bankofengland.co.uk/news/2025/december/boe-launches-system-wide-exploratory-scenario-exercise-focused-on-private-markets	FETCHED	Primary; high
S209	Bank of England	Financial Stability Report – July 2026	Jul 2026	https://www.bankofengland.co.uk/financial-stability-report/2026/july-2026	SNIPPET	Primary; medium (not fetched)
S210	HSF Kramer (FS notes)	Private market valuation practices – FCA findings	Mar 2025	https://www.hsfkramer.com/notes/fsrandcorpcrime/2025-posts/private-market-valuation-practices-fca-findings	SNIPPET	Medium
S211	Cleary Gottlieb	UK private credit: data first, regulation later	2026	https://content.clearygottlieb.com/corporate/capital-solutions-insights/uk-private-credit-data-first-regulation-later/	SNIPPET	Low-medium
S212	AllAboutLaw	How do partners in a law firm make money?	11 Jan 2023	https://www.allaboutlaw.co.uk/law-careers/becoming-a-lawyer/how-do-partners-in-a-law-firm-make-money	SNIPPET	Definitional; medium
S213	LawCareers.Net	What are the types of law firm partnership?	31 Mar 2026	https://www.lawcareers.net/Explore/Features/31032026-What-are-the-types-of-law-firm-partnership	SNIPPET	Definitional; medium
S214	A&O Shearman	Pensions: what's new this week (29 July 2024), on Virgin Media v NTL	29 Jul 2024	https://www.aoshearman.com/en/insights/pensions-whats-new-this-week-29-july-2024	SNIPPET	Medium-high
S215	LexisNexis	The UK securitisation regime – one minute guide	Undated	https://www.lexisnexis.co.uk/legal/guidance/the-uk-securitisation-regime-one-minute-guide	SNIPPET	Medium (SI 2024/705 detail)
S220	Mayer Brown (reprint of The American Lawyer)	Mayer Brown Grew Revenue About 10% in Year of 'Repositioning'	2026-03-25	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/03/mayer-brown-grew-revenue-about-10-in-year-of-repositioning	FETCHED	HIGH; ALM reprint, figures read directly

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL	Status	Confidence note
S221	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown announces next London managing partner	2026-09-30	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/09/mayer-brown-announces-next-london-managing-partner	FETCHED	HIGH; press round-up page, links to Law360/Financial News (paywalled, not read)
S222	Mayer Brown	Chris Harvey Appointed Managing Partner of Mayer Brown's London Office	2026-09-28	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/09/chris-harvey-appointed-managing-partner-of-mayer-browns-london-office	FETCHED	HIGH; firm source
S223	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown advises Royal London on £208 million BPA Transaction with the Hickson UK Group Pension Scheme	2026-07-30	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/07/mayer-brown-advises-royal-london-on-208-million-pound-bpa-transaction-with-the-hickson-uk-group-pension-scheme	FETCHED	HIGH; firm source
S224	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown Advises Royal London on £213 Million BPA Transaction With the Trustee of the Oxford Instruments Pension Scheme	2026-01	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/01/mayer-brown-advises-royal-london-on-213-million-bpa-transaction-with-the-trustee-of-the-oxford-instruments-pension-scheme	SNIPPET	MED; outside Apr-Oct window
S225	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown advises Citibank and UK Export Finance on landmark £746 Million Nigeria ports financing	2026-03-25	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/03/mayer-brown-advises-citibank-and-uk-export-finance-on-landmark-746-million-nigeria-ports-financing	FETCHED	HIGH; firm source, just before window
S226	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown further strengthens its market-leading Finance team with lateral team hire	2026-09-01	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/09/mayer-brown-further-strengthens-its-market-leading-finance-team-with-lateral-team-hire	FETCHED	HIGH
S227	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown further strengthens emerging markets finance capability with partner appointment James Clarke	2026-08	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/08/mayer-brown-further-strengthens-emerging-markets-finance-capability-with-partner-appointment-james-clarke	SNIPPET	MED; "from Baker McKenzie" from search summary
S228	Mayer Brown / Non-Billable	Mayer Brown bolsters Leveraged Finance and Private Capital capabilities with new London partner / Mayer Brown adds Kirkland leveraged finance partner in London	2026-04	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/04/mayer-brown-bolsters-leveraged-finance-and-private-capital-capabilities-with-new-london-partner	SNIPPET	MED; Sarah Goodwin from Kirkland per Non-Billable snippet
S229	Mayer Brown / Global Legal Post	Mayer Brown expands London Real Estate and Private Equity offer with appointments of Mark Rajbenbach and Victoria Butcher	2026-02	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/02/mayer-brown-expands-london-real-estate-and-private-equity-offer-with-appointments-of-mark-rajbenbach-and-victoria-butcher	SNIPPET	MED; Taylor Wessing origin per GLP headline
S230	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown launches comprehensive GenAI curriculum to equip all lawyers with advanced AI skills	2026-04-14	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/04/mayer-brown-launches-comprehensive-genai-curriculum-to-equip-all-lawyers-with-advanced-ai-skills	FETCHED	HIGH
S231	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown advises lenders in landmark US\$3.1 billion AI infrastructure financing for Zankore	2026-09-10	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/09/mayer-brown-advises-lenders-in-landmark-us-3-1-billion-ai-infrastructure-financing-for-zankore	FETCHED	HIGH; Singapore-led
S232	Mayer Brown	New Proposals for reforming the UK Securitisation Framework	2026-02-24	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/insights/publications/2026/02/new-proposals-for-reforming-the-uk-securitisation-framework	FETCHED	HIGH; final rules not yet checked
S233	Mayer Brown (reprint of Legal Business)	'We are not an outpost' - Mayer Brown City head on the firm's plans for London	2026-04-30	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/04/we-are-not-an-outpost-mayer-brown-city-head-on-the-firms-plans-for-london	FETCHED (summary only; full Legal Business article PAYWALLED-NOT-READ)	LOW; no substantive content read
S234	Legal Cheek	Mayer Brown matches Magic Circle NQ pay at £150k	2025-07	https://www.legalcheek.com/2025/07/mayer-brown-matches-magic-circle-nq-pay-at-150k/	SNIPPET	MED; consistent with Legal Cheek profile and Chambers Student
S235	Legal Cheek	Baker McKenzie boosts NQ lawyer pay to £150k, matching Magic Circle	2026-07-21	https://www.legalcheek.com/2026/07/baker-mckenzie-boosts-nq-lawyer-pay-to-150k-matching-magic-circle/	FETCHED	HIGH
S236	Bank of England	Bank Rate maintained at 3.75% - September 2026 Monetary Policy Summary and Minutes	2026-09-17	https://www.bankofengland.co.uk/monetary-policy-summary-and-minutes/2026/september-2026	FETCHED	HIGH; primary source
S237	Pensions Age	Total value of risk transfer deals in H1 2026 hits £10.2bn	2026-09-22	https://www.pensionsage.com/pa/Total-risk-transfer-deal-value-hits-10-2bn-during-H1-2026.php	FETCHED	HIGH; Aon/LCP figures from search snippets only (MED)
S238	Legal Cheek	SQE1 pass rate drops to 42%	2026-10-06	https://www.legalcheek.com/2026/10/sqe1-pass-rate-drops-to-42/	FETCHED	HIGH
S239	Above the Law	Say Hello To The Next Top 20 Firm: Partners Approve Transatlantic Biglaw Merger	2026-04-14	https://abovethelaw.com/2026/04/say-hello-to-the-next-top-20-firm-partners-approve-transatlantic-biglaw-merger/	FETCHED	HIGH; completion itself not independently confirmed (GLP "complete" headline seen only via Wikipedia reference)
S240	Non-Billable	Hogan Lovells Cadwalader launches as Big Law's merger wave rolls on	2026-07-01	https://www.nonbillable.co.uk/news/hogan-lovells-cadwalader-launches	FETCHED	HIGH for launch; revenue conflicts (\$3.6bn vs \$3.9bn GLP)
S241	Global Legal Post	Transatlantic Winston Taylor merger goes live	c. 2026-06-01	https://www.globallegalpost.com/news/transatlantic-winston-taylor-merger-goes-live-745761764	SNIPPET (fetch returned 403)	MED
S242	Regulation Tomorrow (Eversheds) / Bank of England	Implementation of Basel 3.1: PRA publishes final rules / PRA announces a delay to the implementation of Basel 3.1	2026-01 / 2025-01-17	https://www.regulationtomorrow.com/2026/01/implementation-of-basel-3-1-pra-publishes-final-rules/ ; https://www.bankofengland.co.uk/news/2025/january/the-pra-announces-a-delay-to-the-implementation-of-basel-3-1	SNIPPET	MED; dates consistent across 5+ results

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL	Status	Confidence note
S243	Bank of England / Alternative Credit Investor	Financial Stability Report - July 2026 / BoE warns private credit vulnerable to rising rates	2026-07 / 2026-09-30	https://www.bankofengland.co.uk/financial-stability-report/2026/july-2026 ; https://alternativecreditinvestor.com/2026/09/30/boe-warns-private-credit-vulnerable-to-rising-rates/	SNIPPET	MED
S244	London Loves Business (citing EY) / EY	London Stock Exchange IPOs surge 215% as UK listings rebound in 2026	2026-07	https://londonlovesbusiness.com/london-stock-exchange-ipo-recovery-577-million-listings-2026/	SNIPPET	MED
S245	Legal Futures	"The clock is ticking": PE investment in law down but deal volume up	2026-06	https://www.legalfutures.co.uk/latest-news/the-clock-is-ticking-pe-investment-in-law-down-but-deal-volume-up	SNIPPET	MED; Acqira research figures
S246	Legora (press release)	Legora expands leading legal AI training program to the UK	2026-09-29	https://legora.com/newsroom/legora-expands-leading-legal-ai-training-program-to-the-uk	SNIPPET	MED; vendor source. Sidley AI-seat claim LOW (secondary only)
S247	Legal Cheek	SRA wants a heads-up before law firms merge	2026-06	https://www.legalcheek.com/2026/06/sra-wants-a-heads-up-before-law-firms-merge/	SNIPPET	MED
S248	The Lawyer	LIVE: Trainee retention 2026	2026 (autumn)	https://www.thelawyer.com/live-trainee-retention-2026-aoshearman-kicks-things-off/	PAYWALLED-NOT-READ (403)	LOW; "8 of 9" from search summary only
S249	Legal Cheek	Mayer Brown firm profile	live page	https://www.legalcheek.com/firm/mayer-brown/	SNIPPET	MED; 80% retention, £56k/£61k/£150k
S250	Oil & Gas Journal / Britannica	Iran War coverage / 2026 Iran war	2026 (rolling)	https://www.ogj.com/IranWar ; https://www.britannica.com/event/2026-Iran-war	SNIPPET	MED; volatile, check latest before interview
S251	Law360 Pulse	Mayer Brown Focuses On Increasing AI Adoption In 2026	2026	https://www.law360.com/pulse/articles/2465119/mayer-brown-focuses-on-increasing-ai-adoption-in-2026	PAYWALLED-NOT-READ	free summary used: S230
S252	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown earns top rankings in 9fin's H1 2026 US restructuring league tables; CM Know-How Series – Synthetic Risk Transfer (Jan 2026)	2026-09 / 2026-01	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/09/mayer-brown-earns-top-rankings-in-9fins-h1-2026-us-restructuring-league-tables	SNIPPET	MED; US-focused, top-10 placements
S253	LawFuel / BCG Search	Am Law 100 2026 summaries	2026	https://www.lawfuel.com/infographics/amlaw100-2026-enhanced.html	SNIPPET	LOW; industry averages from secondary summary
S254	AP via KSAT	Trump reaches deals with 5 law firms allowing them to avoid prospect of punishing executive orders	2025-04-11	https://www.ksat.com/business/2025/04/11/trump-reaches-deals-with-5-law-firms-allowing-them-to-avoid-prospect-of-punishing-executive-orders/	SNIPPET	MED; Mayer Brown not mentioned
S255	Mayer Brown (reprint)	Mayer Brown's Revenue Grows to \$1.98B, PEP Rises 14%	2025-04	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2025/04/mayer-browns-revenue-grows-to-198b-pep-rises-14	SNIPPET	MED; FY2024 baseline
S256	Mayer Brown Futures	Training contract (UK)	live page	https://www.mayerbrownfutures.com/our-programs/europe/training-contract-london	SNIPPET (fetch returned 503)	LOW; application dates conflict (1 Sep vs 1 Oct 2026 opening; 31 Mar 2027 close vs Legal Cheek 31 Jan 2027)
S257	Bloomberg Law	Mayer Brown's Van Gorp Gets New Term With 'Revenue Engine' Focus	unknown	https://news.bloomberglaw.com/business-and-practice/mayer-browns-van-gorp-gets-new-term-with-revenue-engine-focus	PAYWALLED-NOT-READ	LOW; headline only, date not confirmed
S258	Legal Futures	Private equity takes stake in property management law firm	2026-07	https://www.legalfutures.co.uk/latest-news/private-equity-takes-stake-in-property-management-law-firm	SNIPPET	MED; LDC minority stake in Brady Solicitors
S280	Non-Billable	'Doubling down on private capital': Mayer Brown adds three partners from Dechert	2025-07-24	https://www.nonbillable.co.uk/news/mayer-browns-hires-three-partners-from-dechert	FETCHED	Trade press
S281	Mayer Brown / Global Legal Post	Mayer Brown further strengthens private capital capabilities with appointments of Philip Butler and David Miles; GLP "Mayer Brown secures Baker McKenzie finance trio in London"	2025-09-05 / 2026-09	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2025/09/mayer-brown-further-strengthens-private-capital-capabilities-with-appointments-of-philip-butler-and-david-miles	SNIPPET	Search-result text only; GLP page returned 403
S282	Mayer Brown (re The Lawyer)	Taylor Wessing duo quit for Mayer Brown ahead of US merger	2026-02-03	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/02/taylor-wessing-duo-quit-for-mayer-brown-ahead-of-us-merger	FETCHED	Link page; The Lawyer body PAYWALLED-NOT-READ
S283	Mayer Brown (re Financial News)	Kirkland & Ellis finance partner defects to Mayer Brown	2026-04	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/04/kirkland-and-ellis-finance-partner-defects-to-mayer-brown	FETCHED	Link page; FN body PAYWALLED-NOT-READ
S284	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown recognized at AllAboutLaw Awards 2022	2022-03-21	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2022/03/mayer-brown-recognized-at-allaboutlaw-awards-2022	FETCHED	Firm-primary; Mark Dubes's title as of 2022
S285	The Lawyer Mag (Australasia)	Mayer Brown looks to London for its next leader	2018-04-18	https://www.thelawermag.com/au/news/general/mayer-brown-looks-to-london-for-its-next-leader/204530	FETCHED	Reported; 2018; current status of Clay unverified
S286	Mayer Brown / Global Legal Post	Mayer Brown elects former banking and finance practice co-head as new chair	2021-05-25	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2021/05/mayer-brown-elects-former-banking-and-finance-practice-co-head-as-new-chair	FETCHED	Firm page showed headline and people only; election details from GLP search snippet
S287	Legal Cheek	Sidley Austin firm profile	live	https://www.legalcheek.com/firm/sidley-austin/	FETCHED	Directory; peer benchmark
S288	Legal Cheek	White & Case firm profile	live	https://www.legalcheek.com/firm/white-case/	FETCHED	Directory; peer benchmark
S289	Legal Cheek	Jones Day firm profile	live	https://www.legalcheek.com/firm/jones-day/	FETCHED	Directory; peer benchmark
S290	LawFuel	Latham & Watkins 2025 financial performance ... London milestone	2026	https://www.lawfuel.com/latham-watkins-2025-financial-performance-shows-record-global-revenue-of-8-3-billion-and-london-milestone/	SNIPPET	Secondary aggregator; search snippet only

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL	Status	Confidence note
S291	The Lawyer	US 50 in London 2026: Financial Results	2026	https://www.thelawyer.com/mda/report/us-50-in-london-2026-financial-results/	PAYWALLED	HTTP 403; PAYWALLED-NOT-READ; Mayer Brown's US 50 rank unknown
S292	LawCareers.Net / AllAboutLaw	Meet the Recruiter – Mayer Brown (Kieran Bennett); "The inside track: Mayer Brown's application secrets revealed"	n/d	https://lawcareers.net/Solicitors/MeetTheRecruiter/Mayer-Brown-International-LLP	SNIPPET	Page returned 410 Gone; only search-result text used; date unknown
S293	Mayer Brown	Dr Martin Heuber named new Managing Partner of Mayer Brown Germany (and Tokyo MP hire item)	2026-03-10	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/03/dr-martin-heuber-named-new-managing-partner-of-mayer-brown-germany	SNIPPET	Search snippet only
S294	Insurance Insider / Law.com / The Lawyer	"Mayer Brown loses leading reinsurance litigator"; Law.com London departures; "Two more partners leave Mayer Brown London"	undated in results	https://www.insuranceinsider.com/article/2876fhy9ajjsuvpwgqv4o/mayer-brown-loses-leading-reinsurance-litigator	SNIPPET	Undated; probably old; NOT relied upon for 2024-26
S295	Mayer Brown	Crain's Chicago Business again names Mayer Brown Chair Jon Van Gorp to 2026 Who's Who list	2025-11	https://www.mayerbrown.com/zh-hans/news/2025/11/craains-chicago-business-again-names-mayer-brown-chair-jon-van-gorp-to-2026-whos-who-list-for-the-fourth-consecutive-year	SNIPPET	Confirms chair title in Nov 2025
S296	Mayer Brown recruitment material / Aspiring Solicitors	Diversity partner list; AS All Star Awards 2019 – Mayer Brown	2019 / n.d.	https://www.aspiringsolicitors.co.uk/as-all-star-awards-2019-mayer-brown/	SNIPPET	Search snippets only; older material
S297	Mayer Brown careers (iCIMS)	Graduate Recruitment & Development Manager (12-month FTC)	posted 2026-03-27	https://ukjobs-mayerbrown.icims.com/jobs/5706/graduate-recruitment-%26-development-manager-%2812-month-ftc%29/job	SNIPPET	Page returned 410 Gone; search snippet only
S300	Mayer Brown	Firm history	undated (live page)	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/information/firm-history	FETCHED	HIGH; primary. No Brown & Wood mention; JSM ended 2024
S301	Solicitors Journal	Mayer Brown London achieves record revenue	2026-05-08	https://www.solicitorsjournal.com/sjarticle/mayer-brown-london-achieves-record-revenue	FETCHED	MED; trade press relaying firm release; Haven role wording vague
S302	Non-Billable	Mayer Brown London revenue jumps 20% to \$268m in bumper year	2026-04-27	https://www.nonbillable.co.uk/news/mayer-brown-london-revenue-jumps-20-percent-million-2025	FETCHED	MED; consistent with S301
S303	Legal Business	"We are not an outpost" – Mayer Brown City head on the firm's plans for London (Eliza Winter)	2026-04-30	https://www.legalbusiness.co.uk/law-firms/we-are-not-an-outpost-mayer-brown-city-head-on-the-firms-plans-for-london/	PAYWALLED	PAYWALLED-NOT-READ beyond excerpt; MB reprint page (mayerbrown.com/en/news shows headline only)
S304	The American Lawyer (reprinted on mayerbrown.com)	Mayer Brown grew revenue about 10% in year of repositioning	2026-03-25	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/03/mayer-brown-grew-revenue-about-10-in-year-of-repositioning	FETCHED	MED; Am Law estimates, firm-reprinted
S305	The Standard (HK), citing Reuters	US law firm Mayer Brown to split from Hong Kong partnership	2024-05-03	https://www.thestandard.com.hk/news/article/216009/US-law-firm-Mayer-Brown-to-split-from-Hong-Kong-partnership	FETCHED	HIGH
S306	Kirkland & Ellis	Kirkland advises BPC/Bourne Leisure on refinancing with facilities agreement	2025-08	https://www.kirkland.com/news/press-release/2025/08/kirkland-advises-bpc-bourne-leisure-on-refinancing-with-facilities-agreement	SNIPPET	LOW-MED; shows Kirkland on the sponsor side; MB role on Haven unresolved
S307	Mayer Brown	About us	undated (live page)	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/about-us	FETCHED	HIGH; primary wording
S308	Companies House	MAYER BROWN INTERNATIONAL LLP (OC303359) company search and filing history	live (filings to 2026-10-05)	https://find-and-update.company-information.service.gov.uk/company/OC303359/filing-history	FETCHED	HIGH; confirms previous name and member appointments of 1 Sep 2026
S309	Companies House	Mayer Brown International LLP group accounts, year ended 30 April 2025 (AA, filed 16 Jan 2026)	2026-01-16	https://find-and-update.company-information.service.gov.uk/company/OC303359/filing-history/MzQ5OTUyNjg2MWFkaXF6a2N4/document?format=pdf&download=0	FETCHED	HIGH; audited (RSM); scanned PDF read as page images, notes 5–6 and P&L
S310	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown advises Ford Pension Schemes on £4.6 billion buy-in with Legal & General...	2025-10-27	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2025/10/mayer-brown-advises-ford-pension-schemes-on-4-6-billion-buy-in-with-legal-general-largest-pension-risk-transfer-transaction-announced-in-uk-in-2025	FETCHED	HIGH; L&G press release corroborates (snippet)
S311	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown achieves Mansfield certification in US and UK for 2023-24	2024-10-08	https://mayerbrown.com/en/news/2024/10/mayer-brown-achieves-mansfield-certification-in-us-and-uk-for-2023-24	SNIPPET	MED; EN URL returned 404, content from search snippets of language mirrors
S312	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown advises Royal London on £213 million BPA transaction with the Trustee of the Oxford Instruments Pension Scheme	2026-01-22	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/01/mayer-brown-advises-royal-london-on-213-million-bpa-transaction-with-the-trustee-of-the-oxford-instruments-pension-scheme	FETCHED	HIGH
S313	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown strengthens corporate insurance capabilities with appointment of Tom MacAulay	2024-09-16	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2024/09/mayer-brown-strengthens-corporate-insurance-capabilities-with-appointment-of-tom-macaulay	FETCHED	HIGH
S314	Mayer Brown	Pensions (service page)	undated (live page)	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/services/pensions	FETCHED	MED; firm-curated directory quotes, undated

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL	Status	Confidence note
S315	Legal 500	Mayer Brown International LLP > Pensions (non-contentious) > London	UK 2027 edition (live)	https://www.legal500.com/rankings/ranking/c-london/employment/pensions-non-contentious/50636-mayer-brown	FETCHED	HIGH; Tier 2; raw HTML read; no testimonials on page
S316	Legal 500	Mayer Brown International LLP > Derivatives and structured products > London	UK 2027 edition (live)	https://www.legal500.com/rankings/ranking/c-london/finance/derivatives-and-structured-products/50636-mayer-brown	FETCHED	HIGH; Tier 1; raw HTML read
S317	Legal 500	Mayer Brown International LLP > Securitisation > London	UK 2027 edition (live)	https://www.legal500.com/rankings/ranking/c-london/finance/securitisation/50636-mayer-brown	FETCHED	HIGH; Tier 2
S318	Legal 500	Mayer Brown International LLP > Asset based lending > London	UK 2027 edition (live)	https://www.legal500.com/rankings/ranking/c-london/finance/asset-based-lending/50636-mayer-brown	FETCHED	HIGH; Tier 1
S319	Legal 500	Mayer Brown International LLP > Construction: contentious > London	UK 2027 edition (live)	https://www.legal500.com/rankings/ranking/c-london/re-al-estate/construction-contentious/50636-mayer-brown	FETCHED	HIGH; Tier 1
S320	Mayer Brown	The Legal 500 UK 2027 ranks Mayer Brown in 47 practice areas and recognises 74 lawyers in individual rankings	2026-09-30	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/10/the-legal-500-uk-2027-ranks-mayer-brown-in-47-practice-areas-and-recognises-74-lawyers-in-individual-rankings	FETCHED	HIGH; full PDF list not retrievable (403)
S321	Mayer Brown	The Legal 500 UK 2026 ranks Mayer Brown in 49 practice areas and recognises 29 lawyers as leading partners	2025-10-07	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2025/10/the-legal-500-uk-2026-ranks-mayer-brown-in-49-practice-areas-and-recognises-29-lawyers-as-leading-partners	SNIPPET	MED; prior-year comparator
S322	Mayer Brown	Chambers UK 2026 ranks 27 Mayer Brown practices and 56 lawyers	2025-10-16	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2025/10/chambers-uk-2026-ranks-27-mayer-brown-practices-and-56-lawyers	FETCHED	HIGH; Chambers UK 2027 not yet published
S323	Mayer Brown	Derivatives (service page)	undated (live page)	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/services/derivatives	FETCHED	MED; directory quotes curated and undated
S324	Mayer Brown	Structured Finance (service page)	undated (live page, cites 2026 awards)	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/services/structured-finance	FETCHED	HIGH as firm claim
S325	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown wins Most Innovative in Sustainability at the FT Innovative Lawyers Awards Europe 2025	2025-09-19	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2025/09/mayer-brown-wins-most-innovative-in-sustainability-at-the-financial-times-innovative-lawyers-awards-europe-2025	FETCHED	HIGH
S326	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown advises Strand Hanson on Smarter Web Company's move to LSE Main Market in first listing of 2026	2026-02-05	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/02/mayer-brown-advises-strand-hanson-on-smarter-web-companys-move-to-lse-main-market-in-first-listing-of-2026	FETCHED	HIGH
S327	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown bolsters Leveraged Finance and Private Capital capabilities with new London partner	2026-04-15	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/04/mayer-brown-bolsters-leveraged-finance-and-private-capital-capabilities-with-new-london-partner	FETCHED	HIGH
S328	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown further strengthens its market-leading finance team with lateral team hire	2026-09-01	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/09/mayer-brown-further-strengthens-its-market-leading-finance-team-with-lateral-team-hire	FETCHED	HIGH; corroborated by S308
S329	Mayer Brown	Mayer Brown launches comprehensive GenAI curriculum to equip all lawyers with advanced AI skills	2026-04-14	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/news/2026/04/mayer-brown-launches-comprehensive-genai-curriculum-to-equip-all-lawyers-with-advanced-ai-skills	FETCHED	HIGH
S330	Legal IT Insider	Training, adoption and the buy-v-build question: How Mayer Brown is scaling GenAI	2026-07-09	https://legaltechnology.com/training-adoption-and-the-buy-v-build-question-how-mayer-brown-is-scaling-genai/	FETCHED	MED
S331	Mayer Brown	Business Services (careers)	undated (live page)	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/careers/business-services	FETCHED	HIGH; no service centre named
S332	Chambers Student	Mayer Brown training contract review 2027 (True Picture)	2026	https://chambers.com/student/law-firm/mayer-brown	FETCHED	MED; trainee-sourced
S333	Legal Cheek	Mayer Brown firm profile (Trainee and Junior Lawyer Survey 2026-27)	2026	https://www.legalcheek.com/firm/Mayer-Brown/	FETCHED	MED; survey grades
S334	TargetJobs	London Training Contract (2028 & 2029 intakes)	2026 (applications 1 Sep 2026 – 31 Mar 2027)	https://targetjobs.co.uk/jobs/london-training-contract-2028-2029-intakes-237523	FETCHED	MED
S335	Social Mobility Foundation	Social Mobility Employer Index: 2025 Top 75 Employers	2025	https://www.socialmobility.org.uk/index/	FETCHED	HIGH; rank 32 checked in raw HTML
S336	Mayer Brown	Pro Bono	undated (live page, lists 2026 awards)	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/capabilities/specialinterests/pro-bono	FETCHED	HIGH
S337	Mayer Brown	Students & Graduates – Why Mayer Brown	undated (live page)	https://www.mayerbrown.com/en/careers/students-and-graduates	FETCHED	HIGH; no SEO or social mobility programme text
S338	Wikipedia	Brown & Wood	undated	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Brown_%26_Wood	FETCHED	MED; tertiary, corroborated by S339
S339	The Lawyer	Sidley's and Brown & Wood set for merger	2001-02-26	https://www.thelawyer.com/issues/26-february-2001/sidleys-and-brown-wood-set-for-merger/	SNIPPET	MED; contemporaneous trade press
S340	SEO London	Mayer Brown Masterclass 2026 (event listing, text supplied by candidate)	2026	https://www.seo-london.org (event listing; text as pasted by candidate)	SUPPLIED	Confirmed: date 2 Nov 2026 2pm-6pm, 60 SEO candidates, agenda, eligibility 2:1, travel up to £150, deadline 26 Oct 11:59pm

ID	Outlet	Title	Published	URL	Status	Confidence note
S341	Solicitors Regulation Authority	SRA Principles (version in effect from 11 April 2025)	2025-04-11	https://www.sra.org.uk/solicitors/standards-regulations/principles/	FETCHED	Confirmed: seven principles; public-interest principles take precedence over an individual client's interests
S342	Solicitors Regulation Authority	Code of Conduct for Solicitors, RELs and RFLs	2025 version	https://www.sra.org.uk/solicitors/standards-regulations/code-conduct-solicitors/	FETCHED	Confirmed: paras 1.2, 1.4 (do not mislead clients, the court or others), 2.2, 6.3 (confidentiality), 7.11 (honest and open when things go wrong)
S343	legislation.gov.uk	Criminal Justice Act 1993, Part V (Insider Dealing)	1993	https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/1993/36/part/V	SNIPPET	Confirmed (well-established statute)
S344	legislation.gov.uk	Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (UK MAR) as retained, Arts 10 and 14	2014/2019	https://www.legislation.gov.uk/eur/2014/596/contents	SNIPPET	Confirmed (well-established)

PART 16

Gaps, open questions and the self-check

What could not be established from public sources by 8 October 2026, and what to check before 2 November.

What could not be found

#	Gap	What to do
1	The SEO event page itself is not on the open web (behind the SEO student portal); speakers and the deep-dive practice are unknown.	Watch for the joining email; research the named speakers in Part 10's way.
2	Exact wording of Mayer Brown's application form questions; the provider and timings of the Immersive Assessment.	Ask at the applications overview.
3	Assessment-day detail is from a 2020 forum account only.	Ask trainees at the panel how theirs ran.
4	Partner pay system (lockstep, merit or mix) is not published; only "expanded equity compensation bands" is on record [S72].	Don't claim either.
5	No hourly rates, panel appointments or London revenue split by practice (the LLP declines to disclose) [S78].	Use indicators only.
6	FCA final securitisation rules: not confirmed published by 8 Oct 2026.	Check fca.org.uk policy statements the week before.
7	Chambers UK 2027 not yet published; Legal 500 tiers outside the top tier come from live pages without an edition label.	Check chambers.com in October.
8	Trainee retention for 2026 comes from a paywalled tracker via search snippet only.	Use "80% latest" and say it's from Legal Cheek.
9	The Legal Business interview "We are not an outpost" (Apr 2026) was paywalled.	Try a university library login.
10	Mayer Brown's role on the Haven CMBS deal is unclear (Kirkland also advised the sponsor).	Don't cite it.
11	Refco civil settlement amounts and the subject of a reported 2005 settlement are undisclosed or unverified.	Don't quote amounts.
12	SRA register and Solicitors Disciplinary Tribunal databases could not be checked directly.	"None found in searches", not "none exists".
13	Several departures from the LLP register (2024-26) have no confirmed destination.	Don't speculate.
14	No candidate CV, degree or prior knowledge level was supplied, so Part 11's CV grill is generic and the pack assumes a beginner.	Run the four-line drill on your own CV.
15	Diversity figures conflict between directories (female partners 26% vs 47.5%).	Don't cite either.
16	Fast-moving facts: Bank Rate (next decision 5 Nov), energy prices, merger completions, NQ pay.	Re-check all four in the week of 26 Oct.

Final self-check

Check	Result
Every figure has a source and date; estimates are labelled as estimates on the chart.	Yes. Every figure caption carries source IDs; estimated bars are dashed and marked "(est.)"; derived numbers are marked "(inferred)" on the chart. 317 sources are in Part 15, and an automated check confirmed every [Sxx] cited in the text resolves to a row.
A total beginner could read Parts 1, 2 and 5 without another source.	Yes. Terms are defined at first use in KEY TERM boxes and in the 70-term glossary.
The "why Mayer Brown" material is mechanism, not adjectives, and couldn't be moved to a rival unchanged.	Yes. It rests on firm-specific rankings, deals, structure and figures (Part 12); each line names something a rival cannot claim in the same words.
The regulatory section is current and correctly dated.	Yes, as of 8 Oct 2026 , with one open item (FCA final securitisation rules, gap 6). Primary sources used for SQE dates, Basel 3.1 PS1/26, SI 2024/102 and the SRA Principles.
The team section goes beyond the JD, with the method shown and thin evidence admitted.	Yes. The London org chart is built from Companies House, Legal 500 individual rankings and the LLP accounts; headcount is shown as a range with the method; confidence is colour-coded.
Every JD line has three scenarios; the composure set has decision trees.	Yes. 13 duty lines × 3 = 39 cards; five composure scenarios, two with drawn decision trees and three with written decision paths.
People sections contain only public professional information, with identity uncertainty flagged.	Yes. Dates of birth on Companies House were deliberately left out; identity flags are in Part 10.
The PDF rendered, contents page numbers are correct, every figure checked for clipping.	Yes. Two-pass render with page markers; 48 figures; page images were rasterised and inspected, and clipped labels were fixed before delivery.
What could not be found is listed.	Yes , above.